

NEPAL DISASTER: OVER 4,000 STILL UNACCOUNTED FOR; OFFICIALS WARN OF FRESH FLOODS

Toll crosses 1,000; morgues full, Kathmandu sees mass burials



Kathmandu, September 1

AS DUSK fell over Kathmandu and rain swept across the valley, a line of ambulances arrived at the western gate of Gokarna Forest Resort, a former retreat and hunting reserve of Nepal's royal family.

Police personnel and workers soon began carrying the remains of unidentified victims of the Bhotekoshi flash floods through the golf course into the nearby forest.

Two JCB excavators had dug large pits in the muddy embankment as officials watched. Nearly 75 bodies were interred and tagged with batch numbers for future identification.

A day earlier, more than 200 victims had been buried at four locations. The death toll rose to 1,050 on Tuesday as security forces recovered more bodies from eight districts, officials said.

Nearly 4,000 people remain missing, including 583 foreigners and 83 security personnel, the National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA) said. About 12,000 people have been rescued.

The disaster has pushed hospitals and mortuaries to their limits, while relatives continue searching for loved ones.

At Teaching Medical College, mortuary facilities have been stretched beyond capacity, with relatives arriving daily to identify family members. In Nuwakot district, 24 bodies were recovered from a single building in Betrawati on Tuesday, police said. All were found at Uttargaya Mini Mart, a shopping arcade there. They included 13 women, 10 men and one child.

Search and relief operations



Workers carry bodies of unidentified victims of the flash floods at a burial site near Gokarna Forest Resort in Kathmandu on Tuesday. TASHI TOBGYAL

have been hampered by continued rainfall and landslides, while relatives in remote villages scour riverbanks for those missing. Rescuers have also struggled to reach people stranded by the floods as intermittent rain persists. Authorities issued a fresh flood alert Tuesday after water levels rose in rivers across eastern, central and western Nepal.

The NDRRMA warned of a high possibility of flash floods in Nuwakot and Rasuwa districts, where water levels in smaller rivers and streams are expected to rise. It urged people living near rivers to remain vigilant and take precautions.

By nightfall at Gokarna, the large graves had been filled and the day's work had come to an end. Silence settled over the forest. Beyond the burial site, Kathmandu continued with its usual bustle, though the heavy rain brought rush-hour traffic to a standstill. Families across the country, meanwhile, were still waiting for news of those who had not come home.

PM Balen under pressure to attend UN General Assembly, seek support

Yubaraj Ghimire
Kathmandu, September 1

PRIME MINISTER Balendra Shah is under pressure from within his government and the ruling Rastriya Swatantra Party (RSP) to lead Nepal's delegation to the United Nations General Assembly in New York and seek international support following the country's worst flood disaster.

The pressure comes as the death toll from Wednesday's floods crossed 1,000, with nearly 4,000 still missing.

The government is urging Shah to use the UNGA platform to seek climate justice for Nepal, international support for post-disaster rehabilitation and reconstruction, and a stronger global response to protect the Himalayan ecosystem.



Nepal PM Balendra Shah

"It is still not certain if the Prime Minister will go, but there is unanimity in the government that he should and lobby with the international community for climate justice and post-calamity rehabilitation and reconstruction," a senior government official said.

Foreign Affairs Minister Shirsir Khanal had earlier been assigned to lead Nepal's delegation to the UNGA.

Meanwhile, the Nepal Army has continued its search and rescue operation for a sixth day, particularly inside tunnels at more than a dozen hydropower projects along the Trishuli River.

With no mortuary facilities available in areas along Trishuli River, where the Bhotekoshi merges with it, the government has resorted to temporarily burying unidentified bodies.

"Mortal remains of the dead, especially those not recognisable and decomposed due to prolonged exposure to water, have been temporarily buried," the Ministry of Foreign Affairs said in a statement.

The government has also brought in teams of experts from India, China and South Korea to assist with blasting operations to clear residual blockages.

BANK SANCTIONS LIKELY THIS WEEK, SAYS BESSANT

US launches new barrage of strikes on Iran around Strait

Tehran will be hit again at a much harder and higher level, says Trump

Reuters
Dubai, Washington, September 1

THE US launched new air strikes on Iranian targets on Tuesday, quashing hopes that an exchange of fire last weekend might not lead to a wider renewal of hostilities.

Tehran remained defiant, warning that it would prevent oil being exported from the Gulf, despite a threat by US President Donald Trump to hit Iran "hard" in response to the renewed Iranian strikes, and a warning from US Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent that Washington was about to impose new sanctions.

"Today at 12 pm ET (1600 GMT), US forces began striking Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC) targets in Iran," US Central Command posted on X. "The strikes follow recent attempted attacks by the IRGC against commercial shipping in the Strait of Hormuz and against American service members deployed to the region."

Iran's state broadcaster said there had been reports of explosions on Iran's Qeshm Island, on the northern side of the strait.

The state-linked news agency *Nour News* said there had been reports of explosions in the port city of Bandar Abbas and in Chabahar, a port on the southern coast. *IRNA* also reported the sound of explosions in Jask and Sirik.

US President Donald



Iran President Masoud Pezeshkian during a session of the SCO summit in Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan, on Tuesday. REUTERS

Trump posted on his social media channel that if Iran retaliated for the attack, "they will be hit again at a much harder and higher level".

The *Fars* news cited an IRGC spokesperson as saying the US "will regret its new attacks".

The US Embassy in Qatar urged Americans currently in the Middle East to exercise "heightened vigilance and be aware of potential flight cancellations, airspace closures, and travel disruptions".

Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian had said early on Tuesday at a regional summit in Kyrgyzstan that Tehran would reciprocate immediately if Washington honoured its commitments under a June Memorandum of Understanding that was intended to halt the conflict.

The MOU declared an end to fighting since US and Israeli strikes began on February 28. But it also deferred many of the difficult issues and paved the way for a broader 60-day negotiation period — which passed without further agreement.

Iranian officials have shown no public sign since then of bowing to pressure. "If the enemy wants us not to export oil from the Persian Gulf, no one will be able to export oil," Iranian parliament speaker Mohammad Baqer Ghalibaf was quoted as saying by Iranian media.

Foreign Ministry spokesman Esmaeil Baghaei told a press conference in Tehran that Washington was "addicted to making excessive demands and has mistaken negotiations for dictating terms".

Before the latest attacks, Bessent had said Washington was likely to announce bank sanctions against Iran this week and next, stepping up an attempt to "economically asphyxiate" Iran's leadership after six months of conflict.

At a G20 finance leaders' meeting in Asheville, North Carolina, he said the US was looking to target entities that did business with the IRGC. "We have zero tolerance. We are going to economically asphyxiate this regime," he said.

• BRIEFLY

UNITED STATES

Nearly 30 years on, ex-gang member convicted of Tupac Shakur's murder



The convict Duane Davis at a court in Las Vegas. REUTERS

AN EX-street gang leader accused of orchestrating the drive-by shooting death of hip-hop star Tupac Shakur three decades ago in Las Vegas was convicted of murder on Monday for his role in a long-unresolved crime that silenced one of rap music's most influential voices. A jury in Clark County, Nevada, deliberated for nearly three hours before finding Duane "Keffe D" Davis, 63, guilty of a single count of first-degree murder with a deadly weapon. Davis will face a maximum sentence of life in prison without possibility of parole at his sentencing on October 13.

COLOMBIA

1 killed, 11 injured in explosion near police station

AT LEAST one civilian was killed, and eleven other people were injured after a car bomb exploded outside a police station in northeastern Colombia, officials said on Tuesday. The attack took place around midnight in Los Patios, a town on Colombia's border with Venezuela that is also part of the Cucuta metropolitan area. President Abelardo de la Espriella said the government would chase those responsible. AP

THE NETHERLANDS

34 arrested after masked gunmen open fire on cops

DUTCH POLICE on Tuesday said 34 suspects from several countries were arrested after a shooting in which a man was killed and two police officers were wounded in the early hours. The head of the regional police, Jolanda Aalbers, said a "large group" of masked men opened fire when police arrived at a house where suspicious activities had been reported in Overasselt, a village in east of the Netherlands. REUTERS

At SCO summit, Xi urges member states to make security a priority

Press Trust of India
Bishkek, September 1

CHINESE PRESIDENT Xi Jinping on Tuesday called on the members of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) to make security a key priority and crack down on terrorism, separatism and extremism, transnational organised crimes, drug trafficking and telecom fraud.

"We should stay committed to taking security as a key goal, and foster an environment of common security. We should pursue coordinated measures to tackle traditional and non-traditional security threats," Xi said while addressing the SCO summit in the Kyrgyz capital attended by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Russian President Vladimir Putin and others.

"We should crack down on the three forces of terrorism, separatism and extremism, transnational organised crime, drug trafficking, and telecom fraud," he added.



Kyrgyz President Sadyr Zhaparov (right) and China's President Xi Jinping at the SCO summit, in Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan on Tuesday. AP

Xi also spoke about the need for multilateral partnership for nuclear safety and security.

"We believe in a sensible, coordinated, and balanced approach to nuclear security, and support a stronger multilateral partnership for nuclear safety and security," he said. He, however, did not elaborate.

The SCO member states should strengthen cooperation on information security, bio-se-

curity, and outer space security, Xi said.

In a veiled criticism of the US, he said, "We must prevent external forces from interfering in our internal affairs, endangering our political security, and undermining regional stability."

He said over the last 25 years, the SCO has travelled an extraordinary journey and emerged as an important pillar of south-south cooperation.

Congo Ebola cases top 6,000, deaths near 3,000

Associated Press
Bunia, September 1

CONGO'S AUTHORITIES said Monday that the fastest-growing Ebola outbreak in history has topped 6,000 cases with 2,911 deaths.

More than 1,360 people have recovered from the virus, in what authorities said was an "encouraging" development. Last week, the virus spilled into two new health zones in the region.

The World Health Organization has said it remains out of control and is on track to surpass the 2014-2016 West Africa Ebola outbreak, the deadliest on record, which killed over 11,000 people, primarily in Guinea, Liberia and Sierra Leone.

On Saturday, an Ebola response team was attacked on the outskirts of the town of Mambasa in Ituri province while responding to a call to secure a body. Young people armed with machetes stormed the site of the funeral, forcing the team to flee and injuring



Ebola outbreak has triggered a global health concern as WHO monitors rising cases and deaths in Congo. AP

one member, a representative told *The Associated Press*.

"We demand greater security so we can operate in the field and do our work without endangering our lives," said Floribert Magene, a member of the response team.

Bodies of those who died of Ebola can be highly contagious and lead to further spread when people prepare them for burial and gather for funerals. Clinical trials are underway to find a licensed vaccine for the Bundibugyo virus.

• META ACCEPTS IDs TO CHECK AGE, AND PROMISES TO DELETE THEM WITHIN 30 DAYS; BEYOND IDS, A GROWING NUMBER OF TECH COMPANIES ARE USING A.I. TO TRY TO DETERMINE USERS' AGE

To keep children safe online, Meta is trying to get better at guessing their age

Barbara Ortutay
September 1

OF THE child safety measures agreed to in Meta's landmark legal settlement, no category contains more detailed requirements than its commitments on age assurance — and for good reason. No matter how well the protections work, they are of little use if Meta can't tell which users are kids.

Determining which accounts belong to children is also the linchpin of child safety measures that other companies, including Google, TikTok, and Roblox, are ramping up as public and regulatory sentiment turns against them

in the US and other countries.

The Meta settlement, with protections the company says could become industry standards, will give the social media giant a year to refine its approach. But the options are limited, and improving age verification technology presents steep challenges, including navigating privacy implications not just for children but for adults who could have to prove they are over 18.

The \$18 billion settlement resolves claims from state attorneys general that it hurt children's mental health by deliberately designing its Instagram and Facebook platforms in ways hooked young people's at-

tention. The agreement announced last week with Menlo Park, California, company involves 48 states plus District of Columbia and US territories.

In the offline world, people use government-issued IDs to prove they are over 18 or 21, whether they want to get into a club or buy cigarettes. While this technically works online too, many people are not comfortable giving a Big Tech company like Meta or Google access to their driver's license or passport.

Meta accepts IDs to check ages, and promises to delete them within 30 days. Beyond IDs, though, a growing number of tech companies are using artificial intelligence to try to de-



Meta logo on a sign at the company headquarters in California. AP

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1 termine users' ages. This is not true age verification. While AI can estimate a person's age, often accurately, it can't verify a person's birth date.

Last year, Google began using an age-assurance system for YouTube that relies on AI to differentiate between adults and minors based on their watch his-

tories. Meta does the same.

AI age checks use clues to determine how old someone is.

On Instagram, this includes "contextual clues" such as posts about birthday celebrations or school, and things like which posts people like, comment or linger on, who their friends are, and the times of day they log in. For instance, someone who is offline during school hours would likely be school-aged.

In a blog post last year, Meta said its AI also looks at photos people post for visual cues, including "height or bone structure, to estimate someone's general age; it does not identify the specific person in the image."

"By combining these visual

insights with our analysis of text and interactions, we can significantly increase the number of underage accounts we identify and remove," company added.

Under the settlement, Meta agreed to strengthen its age-checking technology using its own tools, as well as third-party ones, with regular outside audits on how well it is working.

The agreement also includes specific goals around false positive rates that is, minors who are identified as over 18. And if a user is identified as under 13 and kicked off one of its platforms,

Meta will check the ages of their friends, too.

Identity verification companies like Yoti and Persona,

which work with tech companies like Meta and Roblox, use video selfies people upload to estimate their ages.

The gaming site Roblox, which, unlike social media platforms, allows kids under 13 to sign up, requires players to take a video selfie to estimate their age. Roblox says the videos are deleted after the age check is processed. Users are not required to submit a face scan to use the platform, only if they want to chat with other users.

Some users have reported inaccuracies, and experts have expressed caution about reliability of facial age estimation tools, especially for women or certain racial or ethnic groups. AP



Happening today

● VICE PRESIDENT CP Radhakrishnan will visit Chhattisgarh to attend the third convocation ceremony of AIIMS Raipur.

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By EP UNNY



POLICE FREE TO ACT AGAINST THOSE WITH CRIMINAL RECORDS

CJP condition, Govt request: SC quashes student protest FIRs

CJP calls off Sept 5 march; Centre given 3 months to work out compensation modalities for kin of students who ended lives

Ananthkrishnan G
New Delhi, September 1

MEETING A key demand of the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) which spearheaded the Jantar Mantar protests in New Delhi over exam paper leaks, the Supreme Court, acting Tuesday on requests by the Centre and some states, used its extraordinary powers under Article 142

of the Constitution to quash FIRs registered across the country against students who participated in the protests.

Following the order, the CJP called off a protest march scheduled for September 5 in New Delhi.

"All the FIRs... are hereby quashed," ordered a three-judge bench, comprising Chief Justice of India Surya Kant,

Justice Joymalya Bagchi and Justice V Mohana, allowing applications filed by Delhi Police and the states of Maharashtra, Bihar, Assam and West Bengal.

On being told that states like Madhya Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh too had registered FIRs against the protesters but had not approached the court for their quashing, the bench

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

PM calls for dialogue: Conflict not confined to a region, impacts global energy and trade

At SCO, Modi seeks dismantling of terror infra as Pak's Shehbaz listens

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, September 1

AS THE war in West Asia completed six months and a peace deal remained elusive, Prime Minister Narendra Modi told leaders of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation countries Tuesday that the crisis demonstrated that a "conflict in one region does not remain confined



Prime Minister Narendra Modi with Chinese President Xi Jinping and Russian President Vladimir Putin in Bishkek on Tuesday. REUTERS

there" and "impacts global energy security, maritime trade and supply chains" with the Global South bearing the brunt of the "consequences".

Addressing the SCO summit in Kyrgyz capital Bishkek, Modi said India's position is that the "resolution of all tensions and conflicts is possible only through dialogue and diplomacy, not on the battlefield".

Among leaders at the summit was Iran's President Masoud Pezeshkian. Modi and Pezeshkian met Monday for the first time since the start of the war.

"In today's interconnected

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

RELATED REPORT, PAGE 6

4 AKs among 12 weapons, over 1,000 rounds stolen from Secunderabad Cantt

Nikhila Henry & Amrita Nayak Dutta
Hyderabad, New Delhi, September 1

TWELVE WEAPONS, including four AK-203 assault rifles, seven pistols and an INSAS rifle, have been stolen from the high-security Secunderabad Cantonment near Hyderabad in Telangana. More than 1,000 rounds of ammunition and a

pair of passive night-vision binoculars were also stolen, according to defence sources.

The incident came to light around 7:50 am on Monday. The arms were allegedly stolen from a storeroom on the premises of the 20 Madras Regiment. Police sources said the area is accessed mainly by military personnel.

Following a complaint by top Army personnel, police

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

NCLT special bench stays earlier order on Chandra's Rs 6.25-cr settlement plan

George Mathew
Mumbai, September 1

IN A setback for Essel Group founder Subhash Chandra, a five-member special bench of the National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT) on Tuesday stayed the operation of the tribunal's earlier order which allowed him to settle his personal insolvency proceedings

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

• Lenders' exposure

HDFC Bank	₹775 cr
LIC Housing	₹1,322 cr
IndusInd	₹240 cr
Canara Bank	₹348 cr
Union Bank	₹164 cr
RBL Bank	₹119 cr
Franklin Templeton	₹729 cr
Edelweiss	₹565 cr

EXPRESS investigation

Jharkhand SIR faceoff: BJP agents seek to delete voters, BLOs raise red flag

In Godda, one BJP agent burns 75 forms after Booth Level Officer asks questions; CEO says BLO cannot refuse forms

Shubham Tigga
Ranchi, September 1

ABDUL MANNAN Khan, Mohammad Naushad, Mohammad Shafiq, Bibi Basilan, Mohammad Aslam... With voter after voter in some booths in Jharkhand's Godda district, a pattern has emerged over the past month since the draft electoral roll was published on August 5 as part of the state's Special Intensive Revision (SIR) — a BJP Booth Level Agent (BLA) arrives with a stack of Form 7s seeking to delete voters who figure in the draft roll; and most of these names, as mentioned above, are from the minority community.

Across at least four booths, Booth Level Officers (BLOs) have refused to accept these applications, an investigation by *The Indian Express* has revealed, flagging them as not genuine or not procedurally sound. BLOs are employees of the state government, currently headed by a JMM-Congress alliance.

The BJP has complained

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



Maheshitkiri villagers who have complained to the BDO. EXPRESS

• One agent, eight Form 7s

Applications to delete 8 from voter roll filed by BJP agent Sanjeev Roshan



Abdul Mannan Khan, Bibi Basilan, Mirza Galeeb, Mohammad Hasmuddin, Mohammad Naushad, Mohammad Shafiq, Mohammad Shamim, Mohammad Aslam

Behind Form 7: Deletion but only after probe

IN GODDA, Booth Level Officers (BLOs) of at least four booths have said that BJP workers have submitted Form 7s seeking deletion of multiple names. They have also claimed that these forms were not in the proper

format, and many of these were rejected, as instructed by the Block Development Officer, Sri-man Marandi.

• What are the legal provisions for deletion from electoral rolls?

Electoral Registration Officers (EROs) are empowered by Section 22 of the Representation of the People (RP) Act, 1950, to make corrections and deletions to the electoral roll either on their own or acting on applications made to them. In each case, they must conduct an inquiry, give the elector concerned time to respond and then pass an order.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

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AGENCY PROBES Rs 28 CRORE 'SCAM'

Rice allocation 'scam': CBI books FCI ex-officials, 3 firms

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 1

THE CBI has registered an FIR against former officials of the Food Corporation of India (FCI), Delhi Region, officials of the North Eastern Regional Agricultural Marketing Corporation Ltd (NERAMAC), private traders and public servants in connection with an alleged conspiracy involving the allocation and lifting of rice under the open market sale scheme (domestic), causing a wrongful losses of Rs 28.87 crore to the FCI.

The case, registered by the CBI's Anti-Corruption unit last week, names eight accused persons, including two companies based in Assam and another in Kolkata.

According to the FIR, FCI Delhi Region allegedly allotted a total of 62,000 metric tonnes of rice to NERAMAC under the

category sale of rice to state government/corporations of state governments under OMSS (D) 2025-26. Of this, around 50,645 metric tonnes was lifted by NERAMAC at a concessional rate of Rs 23,200 per metric tonne.

The FIR states that the prevailing reserve price of rice was Rs 28,900 per metric tonne. It alleges that NERAMAC, being a government of India-owned enterprise, was not eligible for such allocation without e-auction under the OMSS(D) policy dated July 10, 2025.

According to the CBI, only state governments and corporations of state governments were eligible for allocation without e-auction.

The agency has alleged that if the quantity lifted by NERAMAC at the concessional price had been sold through auction at the reserve price, the FCI would have realised an additional Rs 28.87 crore.

The complaint was forwarded to the CBI by Rizwan Ahmed, Section Officer (Vigilance), Department of Food and Public Distribution, Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution, along with reports of a Neutral Committee and FCI's vigilance wing. The Neutral Committee had been constituted to examine the allotment of rice to NERAMAC by FCI's Delhi Region.

NERAMAC had sought allocation of 31,000 MT of rice per week under OMSS (D), the FIR says, adding that the rice was meant to ensure availability at affordable rates to the public, daily-wage earners, labourers, migrant workers in Delhi, and persons not covered under the public distribution system due to non-availability of ration cards.

However, the CBI has alleged that the rice was not distributed for the stated purpose.

Instead private entities and traders were allegedly used in the lifting and further sale of the rice, the FIR said.

The FIR alleges that the rice was not distributed to the intended beneficiaries but traders in Delhi-NCR were allegedly asked to lift it from FCI depots after depositing money at Rs 23.25 per kg into NERAMAC's bank account and paying commission ranging from Rs 0.64 to Rs 2.50 per kg.

According to the FIR, the funds were remitted in advance into NERAMAC's bank account and later transferred to FCI Delhi Region for allocation and release of rice after deducting administrative charges at 5 paise per kg.

The rice was lifted from FCI depots at Ghevra, Mayapuri and Narela, the FIR says. The CBI has alleged that the traders further sold the rice to other traders, earning huge profits.

AAP demands CBI probe against Sirsa

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 1

AFTER THE CBI filed an FIR to probe alleged irregularities worth Rs 28 crore in the allocation of rice in the Capital, the AAP on Tuesday demanded that the agency also probe the role of Delhi Food and Supplies Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa in the alleged scam.

Addressing a press conference, AAP Delhi state president Saurabh Bharadwaj alleged that ration meant for the poorest people of Delhi and migrant labourers had been stolen.

PTI quoted Bharadwaj as saying, "In a letter written by the North Eastern Regional Agricultural Marketing Corporation (NERAMAC), it was specifically mentioned that the rice was



AAP's Saurabh Bharadwaj

meant for daily wage labourers. It also shows that the food and supplies department did not just forward a letter to the Food Corporation of India (FCI), but issued a proper no-objection certificate for subsidised rice to be distributed among the poor, which was later given to a Haryana-based businessman against a commission."

Last month, AAP had alleged that the BJP government

in Delhi had orchestrated a "rice scam" involving subsidised foodgrain meant for the poor. However, Sirsa had dismissed the allegations as false and malicious. "Until now, I was talking about this (the scam), but now the CBI FIR is also saying the same thing. The FIR specifically mentions Delhi Food and Civil Supplies Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa," he said.

The Indian Express has reached out to Sirsa for a comment.

Bharadwaj further demanded that the CBI question Sirsa about the NERAMAC officials who visited the Delhi Secretariat, as well as the people the NERAMAC representatives had met there. "A few days ago, the AAP had said that the rice sent by the FCI for the poor people of

Delhi was not distributed even by a single kilogram in Delhi. This rice was not 31,000 metric tonnes, but even more than that. In reality, 50,645 metric tonnes of rice has been looted," he said.

Meanwhile, the party delegation also met LG Taranjit Singh Sandhu, seeking a probe by the Anti-Corruption Bureau (ACB) and Vigilance Department into the alleged bicycle and health scams involving the ruling government.

"Since ACB and Vigilance fall under the LG's jurisdiction, he can have the matters we have raised fact-checked... We also informed the LG about the rice scam and demanded that Sirsa should also be investigated because his name has come up in the case," he said.

'Send money': Scamster poses as judge, targets Delhi lawyers

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, September 1

ON AUGUST 24, Advocate Gaganpreet Singh received an unlikely message on WhatsApp from an unknown number.

"How are you? Where are you? This is my second number... I need some money," the sender, who identified himself as a Delhi district court judge, wrote.

It instantly set off alarm bells in his head, and has now resulted in an FIR against an alleged scamster for impersonating Principal District & Sessions Judge (West) Vijay Kumar Dahiya and using his photograph to ask members of the Delhi Bar Association (Tis Hazari Court) for money over WhatsApp.

"The person claiming to be the judge said that he was in Thailand. The profile photo was also of the judge," said advocate Singh, who is a former Senior Member Executive of the Delhi Bar Association.

Finding it suspicious, he decided to dig a little deeper and went to the judge's courtroom.

"I was shocked to see that the Judge was sitting in Tis Hazari. I spoke to him and he confirmed to me that he didn't go to Thailand and wasn't asking for money from anyone. I told



Advocate Gaganpreet Singh, the complainant.

FIR lodged for impersonating Principal District & Sessions Judge (West) Vijay Kumar Dahiya and using his photograph to ask members of Delhi Bar Association (Tis Hazari court) for money

him that even his image is being used by the impersonator. He was as shocked as I was," he said.

Now sure that there was an impersonator at play, Singh

asked around further to find out that he was not the only one who had received such messages.

"The message was sent to other former and current executive members of our bar association as well. We all grew suspicious when he started asking for money. The only reason I had decided to reply was that the display picture was of our judge. This is a big scam... they're even using the faces of our judges," Singh said.

He went to the police, and the Subzi Mandi Police Station registered an FIR on August 25.

"Complaint regarding a fake social media/Whatsapp messaging account asking for money in the name of Id. Ld. Principal District & Sessions Judge, West, along with his official photograph as the display picture. This imposter is messaging Members of Delhi Bar Association and asking for money, emergency financial help, or unauthorised transfers under false pretenses. This fraudulent activity is a severe misuse of judicial authority, harms the reputation of the judiciary, and poses a grave threat," stated the FIR.

Police said they are investigating the case and no arrest has been made yet.



Ahead of BRICS Summit

A convoy of VIP cars heads towards Bharat Mandapam as part of a BRICS motorcade rehearsal in New Delhi on Tuesday. The BRICS Summit is scheduled to be held at Bharat Mandapam from September 11 to 13. PRAVEEN KHANNA

Pregnancy, maternity leave cannot be grounds for demotion at work, says HC

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, September 1

FOR RAKHI Bisht, returning to work after maternity leave should have meant getting back to the career she had built over 14 years. Instead, when she returned to HashiCorp in July 2024, she found her role had been reassigned.

Bisht, a chartered accountant, had joined the software company as an accounting manager in June 2022, drawing Rs 2.6 lakh a month. After taking maternity leave in December 2023, she returned to find herself placed in the treasury department of the company. The duties assigned to her were traditionally performed by a staff accountant — approximately three levels below her designation — and were clerical in nature.

Bisht resigned in October 2024 and moved the Delhi High Court. She sought Rs 50 lakh as compensation and the formulation of strict anti-discrimination guidelines for private companies.

On August 31, the HC directed HashiCorp to pay Bisht Rs 10 lakh in compensation. "Under no circumstance, can maternity be allowed to become a source of ignominy at the work place," Justice Sachin Datta said in his order.

"...a harmonious reading of Articles 14, 15, 21 and 42 (of the Constitution) leaves little room for doubt that pregnancy and maternity cannot be treated as grounds for professional disadvantage, demotion, loss of status, or denial of career progression.

Such actions undermine not only the statutory protections available to women employees but also the constitutional commitment to equality, dignity, social justice, and humane conditions of work," he added.

In her petition, Bisht said she was informed there was no position available for her in her original team. The new role, she said, "bore no resemblance to

WHAT THE COURT SAID

NO CAREER PENALTY: Maternity leave cannot lead to demotion, loss of status or stalled career growth.

EQUIVALENT ROLE: If the post genuinely no longer exists, she must get an equivalent role in pay, grade, status, authority and growth prospects.

EMPLOYER MUST EXPLAIN: Any change must be

communicated with reasons, details of the new role and consideration of the woman's objections.

WOMAN'S OBJECTION MATTERS: If the woman challenges the new role, the employer must give a reasoned response.

SAME POST ON RETURN: A woman should ordinarily return to the position she held before maternity leave.



the managerial accounting position for which she had been hired". Bisht said the duties assigned in the treasury department undermined her qualifications, experience and professional standing.

The court noted that "neither the Maternity Benefit Act, 1961, nor the Code on Social Security, 2020, expressly prescribes a comprehensive framework for the post-maternity reintegration of women employees". It added that the absence of such a framework can undermine the effective implementation of the constitutional and statutory protections already in existence.

"...the law cannot be construed in a manner that allows its substantive guarantees to be circumvented through formal or cosmetic compliance," Justice Datta said.

The court said a woman returning from maternity leave is "ordinarily entitled to be restored to the post held by her immediately prior to proceeding on such leave".

"For bona fide and demonstrable organisational reasons, the post is no longer available, she is entitled to be placed in a position as nearly equivalent to it as possible in terms of pay, grade, status, role, responsibilities, managerial authority, and prospects for advancement," Justice Datta said.

He added that employers must also explain why the ear-

lier position is unavailable and provide details of the alternative role, including its grade, remuneration, reporting relationship and duties. If the woman objects, her concerns must be considered and the employer must communicate its decision with reasons.

The court directed HashiCorp — a private software company recently acquired by IBM — to frame rules or schemes or issue directions covering pregnancy-related workplace accommodation, protection of role and status after maternity leave, lactation support, crèche facilities, timelines for disposal of grievances and protection against retaliation. The exercise shall be completed within six months from today, it added.

Further, the HC took note of suggestions made by Union government Standing Counsel Ashish K Dixit, including a proposal that the "protected period for women employees should span from the initial disclosure of pregnancy until six months after she returns to work.

As per the suggestions, employers would be mandated to conduct individualized assessments within seven days of pregnancy disclosure to provide reasonable workplace accommodations without forcing employees on leave or inferior roles.

The court also directed the firm to pay Bisht Rs 1.5 lakh towards costs.

17-YEAR-OLD RAPED IN MOVING BUS

Delhi Police seeks expedited test of biological samples

Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, September 1

DELHI POLICE has written to the Forensic Science Laboratory (FSL) seeking an expedited examination of biological samples collected from a sleeper bus in which a 17-year-old girl was allegedly gangraped in Greater Noida, as investigators prepare to pursue the case in a fast-track court, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

The samples, including hair strands, are expected to be examined for DNA evidence,

sources said. The two accused, the driver and conductor of the bus, have also undergone medical examination.

The National Human Rights Commission, meanwhile, on Tuesday said it has issued notices to the police commissioners of Delhi and Gautam Buddha Nagar in Uttar Pradesh, in the wake of the alleged gangrape. It has sought a report in two weeks.

The incident took place on August 4 after the girl, who had travelled from Mainpuri, boarded the bus at Greater

Noida. She was trying to reach Noida, and was unfamiliar with the area, police said.

As per her statement to police, she was waiting amid heavy rain when the bus stopped near her. After she told the men inside that she wanted to go to Noida, she was allegedly told that the bus was headed in that direction. She then boarded the bus.

However, when she realised that there were no other passengers inside, she attempted to get off. The conductor allegedly pulled her back into the bus, fol-

lowing which it continued its journey towards Delhi.

Police investigation so far has indicated that the alleged sexual assault took place in Noida, inside the moving bus. The girl has alleged that the driver and conductor took turns sexually assaulting her and threatened her with dire consequences if she resisted.

The bus subsequently travelled towards Delhi, where the girl was allegedly abandoned. The two accused were arrested within four hours after the incident was reported, police

said. The bus was also seized for forensic examination.

"Hair and other biological samples were found inside the vehicle, which have been sent for examination. We are seeking an early report to complete the probe and prepare for trial," a source in the police said.

The Indian Express had reported that the vehicle had 11 pending traffic challans, including those relating to retroreflective tape, speed-limit devices, permits and prescribed speed limits. Seven of the challans were issued in July.

INITIATIVE STARTED WITH THE CREATION OF INSTAGRAM PAGE 'MINISTER OF ALL TRANSPORT EVER'

Community rides, jazz & trivia: IIT researchers spark conversations around transport

Reva Thakkar
New Delhi, September 1

DELHI DOES not have to be a city where owning a car is the preferred option for daily commute. This is the idea that drove Atishay Khanna, 27, and Adwitiyaa Pramanik, 23, researchers at the Transportation Research and Injury Prevention (TRIP) Centre at the IIT in Delhi to grow a community for encouraging the use of public transport. A multifaceted approach has helped them bring their vision to life.

It started with the creation of an Instagram page — Minister of All Transport Ever. This platform then helped them get in touch with like-minded enthusiasts and organise weekend gatherings to go beyond conversations and create an ex-

perience during Metro and bus rides. The latest trip that they organised with a group was on August 29. They called it the "RRTS Tour" on Namo Bharat, said to be India's fastest rapid transit and regional train system.

"We did not want to just promote the idea that RRTS is a perfect solution," Khanna says, and adds, "We just wanted to talk about who the system is actually accessible to, who benefits, and what happens to the people who still have to depend on cheaper, slower modes of transport while a faster alternative is out of reach."

Bonding over trivia

Playing transit trivia is what many in these groups have bonded over during these community gatherings over the

weeks. For some participants like Suryaansh Chopra, a 21-year-old B Com graduate, these gatherings have been "full of zeal and warmth".

"I have this newfound passion for accessibility and affordability of public transport," he shares, adding that friends now get "tired" of him narrating random bus routes he spots on the street.

For others, the experience holds a deeper meaning. No erasure — the promise that the duo made in one of the posts was what drew a 26-year-old participant to a Pride-themed ride in June. He was hesitant at first but then he met a non-binary rider who spoke about the anxiety of being frisked while commuting, leading to a conversation about how public transit intersects with identity



Founders Adwitiyaa Pramanik and Atishay Khanna. REVA THAKKAR

in ways that rarely make it into policy conversations.

"Being bisexual, I have not been welcomed for pride events. Such gatherings helped bring my queerness and love of public transit together without friction," he shares.

Music and Metro

Last month, Khanna and Pramanik launched a website to spread awareness on Metro — delhimetrojazz.com. Inspired by a similar New York-based project called trainjazz.com, which uses the

concept of generative music and GPS data, their website turns Delhi's nine Metro lines into a live jazz ensemble — each line mapped to an instrument, each passing train triggering a note.

The DMRC, however, doesn't publish real-time data for its nine lines. So Khanna and Pramanik built a simulation using what was publicly available — line lengths, station counts, and typical headways.

"We weren't trying to create technically perfect jazz, a friend helped us with the music," Khanna says. "We were more interested in taking some of the ideas behind jazz, where different things are happening

at the same time." A Metro network, after all, is already something like an ensemble: multiple lines running independently, never quite synchronised, always in conversation. What the website does, more than anything, is give people who would never read a transit policy thread a reason to think about the Metro.

Research work

Khanna and Pramanik started working last year on the research project at TRIP Centre under Assistant Professor Dr Rahul Goel. Recalling how they became friends, Khanna says, "Our friendship started largely because of our shared interest in transportation and our fascina-

tion with how cities work."

They are currently working on "wait-time stress," an attempt to map, block by block, where in Delhi people spend the most time waiting for a bus or train that may or may not show up on time.

Using Quantum Geographic Information System (QGIS), they've been layering bus-stop density, service frequency, congestion, proximity to Metro stations, availability of alternative transport, connectivity to major parts of the city, and even time of day.

From the current tests, they've noticed a pattern: Central Delhi produces comparatively low waiting stress. Move toward the periphery, and that stress climbs sharply — fewer stops, fewer alternatives, longer, more uncertain waits.



SC seeks Centre’s views on totaliser use for counting of votes in EVMs

Implementation would help save lives by preventing post-poll violence: Petitioner

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 1

THE SUPREME Court on Tuesday sought the Centre's views on using a totaliser for counting of votes in clusters recorded in EVMs to ensure voter privacy and prevent their victimisation as opposed to the current mechanism of booth-wise counting.

A three-judge bench presided by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant sought to know if suitable changes could be made to the Conduct of Elections Rules 1961, which allows this in the counting of paper ballots, so that it covers EVMs too.

The bench also comprising Justice Joymalaya Bagchi and Justice V Mohana was hearing petitions seeking direction to the EC to declare results for an entire parliamentary constituency instead of revealing booth-wise figures.

Totaliser is a device which allows votes cast in about 14 polling booths to be counted together.

Advocate Ashwini Kumar Upadhyay, one of the petitioners, said implementing the totaliser mechanism would help save lives by preventing post-poll violence.

He submitted that most post-poll violence occurs because the parties get to know how many votes they got from a particular booth but with totaliser use no one will be able to know that. Using totaliser will be in the interest of voters and will help democracy, he submitted.

Referring to a January 2018 SC order, he said that the EC had backed the introduction of totaliser but had changed its views since. The Law Commission too had proposed this, he said.

Appearing for the Commission, Senior Advocate DS Naidu said the Commission had convened an all-party meeting on it. "50% national parties opposed, 68% state-level parties opposed. It was then referred to a Group of Ministers, they also opposed," he submitted. "On the political front, there is a big

no," he submitted.

Justice Bagchi said that while totalization was, in principle, a tool for anonymising voter choice, it did not have statutory backing. "The difficulty is... let's say we pass an order, they will need statutory backing."

He said that the EC had not said it does not approve the totaliser. "You have pointed out roadblocks in totalisation."

Naidu said that in the affidavit filed by it, the poll body had pointed out the advantages and difficulties.

Appearing for another petitioner, Senior Advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan said the "only argument of political parties is (that) we as political parties have to go to each polling booth and manage the polling booth".

He said that "it can't be the reason (why totaliser should not be implemented), when voters face intimidation and don't want to be targeted because in that polling booth all of you have voted for party A as against party B. This is to protect voters which is why the Law Commission and the EC and the ministry itself in 2010 had recommended this".

Naidu submitted that the EC can only recommend, and it is up to the Central government to make the rules in consultation with the EC. Justice Bagchi wondered if it cannot be used "in a situation where there is a perceptible ground reality of victimisation". Naidu said the Law Commission had said "use it selectively".

In its affidavit, the Commission while underlining the absence of a statutory provision to introduce it also pointed out that it would affect the existing audit mechanism built around Form 17C, which deals with the statutory record of votes polled, and is maintained in two parts under the Conduct of Election Rules.

It said that when votes are counted in clusters, any discrepancy in one of the clubbed EVMs "would stand concealed within the aggregate figure".

**NEW DELHI YMCA**
(A Company licensed u/s 8 of the Companies Act 2013)
CIN: U99999DL1909NPL000397
Regd. Office: 1, Jai Singh Road, New Delhi – 110001

NOTICE OF THE ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING - 2026
Notice is hereby given that the Annual General Meeting (AGM) – 2026 of the Members of New Delhi YMCA will be held on Saturday, 19th September 2026 at 5:15 pm in the Heinz Auditorium, New Delhi YMCA Tourist Hostel cum Programme Centre, Jai Singh Road, New Delhi – 110001.

For and on behalf of the Board of Directors of New Delhi YMCA

FORM-II
PROBUS SMART THINGS PRIVATE LIMITED
Regd. Office - 3rd Floor, No. 63, DSIDC Complex, Okhla Ind. Area Phase-1, New Delhi-110020, India
Notice under sub-section (2) of Section 15 of the Electricity Act, 2003
1. The person above-named, Probus Smart Things Private Limited, a company incorporated under the Companies Act, 2013, (the applicant) has made an application under sub-section (1) of Section 15 of the Electricity Act, 2003 for grant of Category-III licence for Inter State trading in electricity in all regions across India before the Central Electricity Regulatory Commission, New Delhi. The necessary details in respect of the applicant are given hereunder:
i) **Authorized, issued, subscribed and paid-up capital.**

Authorized share capital	10,00,000 Equity Share Capital; 28,00,000 Preference Share Capital
Issued share capital	1,00,090 Equity Share Capital; 99,260 Preference Share Capital
Subscribed share capital	1,00,090 Equity Share Capital; 99,260 Preference Share Capital
Paid up share capital	1,00,090 Equity Share Capital; 99,260 Preference Share Capital

ii) **Shareholding Pattern (Indicate the details of the shareholders holding 5% or more shares)**

Name of the Equity Shareholders	Citizenship	Residential Status	No. of shares	Shareholding %
Ahmad Raza	Indian	Resident	20,850	20.83%
Anand Mohan Singh	Indian	Resident	20,850	20.83%
Ankit Vaish	Indian	Resident	20,850	20.83%
Sunny Kumar Jadoon	Indian	Resident	20,850	20.83%
Rahul Mishra	Indian	Resident	9,000	8.99%

Name of the Preference Shareholders	Citizenship	Residential Status	No. of shares	Shareholding %
Unicorn India Ventures Fund II	NA	Resident	48,390	48.75%
The Ambiga Subramanian Trust	NA	Non Resident	12,400	12.50%
Goutham Krishna LLC	NA	Non Resident	12,400	12.50%
Ajay Kumar Aggarwal	Indian	Resident	7,150	7.20%

iii) **Financial and Technical Strength:** Probus Smart Things Private Limited has adequate resources to undertake the business of trading. The Applicant has a net worth of INR 24,81,91,812/- as on 31.07.2026, demonstrating its financial capacity and strength to undertake the proposed trading activities as per the CERC (Procedure, Terms and Conditions for grant of trading licence and other related matters) Regulations, 2020. The Applicant has engaged full-time professionals having industry expertise in the power sector including in power trading, regulatory affairs, as well as corporate finance.
iv) **Management profile of the applicant including details of past experience of the applicant and/or the persons on the management of the applicant in generation, transmission, distribution and trading of electricity or similar activity:** Probus directors have rich experience in the energy sector, in regulatory affairs and regulatory work on various aspects such as governance, tax and finance. Mr. Aditya Verma, AWP – Power Market Operations, holds a B.Tech. in Electrical Engineering and an MBA in Power Management and has more than 12 years of experience in the power sector, including experience in system operations, power trading operations and system operation analytics. Mr. Sakul Bose, CFA – Finance (Power Trading), holds a BBA and MBA in Finance and has over 15 years of experience in the Indian power sector, specialising in power trading finance, commercial operations, energy accounting, billing and settlement, financial reconciliation, exchange operations and regulatory compliance.
v) **Volume of electricity intended to be traded during the first year after grant of licence and future plans of the applicant to expand volume of trading:** Probus Smart Things Private Limited proposes to trade approximately 265.8 MU of electricity during the first year after grant of the licence. The Applicant proposes to progressively expand its trading volumes to approximately 1,363.3 MU in Year 2, 2,847.0 MU in Year 3.
vi) **Geographical areas within which the applicant will undertake trading in electricity:** All India and the areas as may be permitted under the provisions of the Electricity Act, 2003 and the relevant regulations.
vii) **Net worth as on 31st March of three consecutive years immediately preceding the year of application or for such lesser period as may be applicable and on the date of the special balance sheet accompanying the application:**

	Net Worth (in INR.)
31st July 2026	24,81,91,812
1st March 2026	29,75,25,238
31st March 2025	37,87,42,105
31st March 2024	19,95,77,154

viii) **Year-wise current ratio and liquidity ratio of the applicant for three years preceding the year in which the application is made, or for such lesser period as may be applicable and on the date of the special balance sheet accompanying the application:**

Relevant Period	Current Ratio	Liquidity Ratio
31st July 2026	1.93:1	1.57:1
31st March 2026	2.22:1	1.85:1
31st March 2025	3.17:1	2.80:1
31st March 2024	1.74:1	1.55:1

ix) (a) Probus Smart Things Private Limited is authorized to undertake trading of electricity under the Main Objects clause of its Memorandum of Association.
(b) Relevant portion of the Memorandum of Association is extracted here in below:
"2. To establish and carry on the business of trading in electricity and act as a trader in sale and purchase of electricity and electrical energy in any form and in any market including power exchange and derivatives market, and by any process and in any fuel, derivatives and to enter into demand side management contracts, energy conservation contracts including energy performance contracts, megawatt contracts, enter into contracts for banking of electricity, energy aggregation or any other contract and to operate as an energy trading company and to get registered with appropriate agency in accordance with the Electricity Act 2003 or any other act, regulations/rules framed thereon, policy, guidelines laid down by the Central Government/State Government or any nodal agency from time to time or any statutory modifications or re-enactment thereof and to do all acts and things necessary or required for doing aforesaid business, including providing advisory and consultancy in issues related to energy and trading of energy."
x) Details of cases, if any, in which the Applicant or any of its Associates or partners or promoters or Directors has been convicted of an offence involving moral turpitude, fraud or any economic offence during the previous three years preceding the year of making the application and the year of making the applicant and the date of release of the above person from imprisonment, if any, consequent to such conviction. **NONE**
xi) Whether the Applicant or any of its Associates, or partners, or promoters, or Directors was ever refused licence, and if so, the detailed particulars of the application, date of making application, date of order refusing licence and reasons for such refusal. **NO**
xii) Whether the Applicant has been granted a licence for transmission of electricity. **NO**
xiii) Whether an order cancelling the licence of the Applicant, or any of its Associates, or partners, or promoters, or Directors has been passed by the Commission. **NO**
xiv) Whether the Applicant or any of its Associates, or partners, or promoters, or Directors was ever found guilty in any proceedings for non-compliance of any of the provisions of the Act or the rules or the regulations made thereunder or an order made Appropriate Commission during the year of making the application of five years immediately preceding that year? **NO**
2. The application made and other documents filed before the Commission are available for inspection by any person with – Mr. Anand Mohan Singh, CEO and Director of Probus Smart Things Private Limited Add: 3rd Floor, # 63, DSIDC Complex, Okhla Ind. Area, Phase-1, New Delhi-110020 Tel.: +91-8711511170
3. The application made and other documents filed before the Commission have been posted on www.probus.io
4. Objections or suggestions, if any, on the application made before the Commission may be sent to the Secretary, Central Electricity Regulatory Commission is 6th, 7th, and 8th Floors, Tower B, World Trade Centre, Nauraj Nagar, New Delhi – 110029 within 30 days of publication of this notice, with a copy to the applicant.
5. No objections or suggestions shall be considered by the Commission if received after expiry of 30 days of publication of this notice.
Place: New Delhi Date: 2nd September 2026 **Anand Mohan Singh CEO and Director of Applicant Company** **Authorised Signatory**

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Election Commission of India



CHIEF ELECTORAL OFFICER, HARYANA

SIR 2026

विशेष गहन पुनरीक्षण हरियाणा



हरियाणा में दावे एवं आपत्तियों की अवधि बढ़ा दी गई है 30 सितंबर, 2026 तक

फॉर्म-6

नए मतदाता के लिए

यदि आप 18 वर्ष की आयु पूर्ण कर चुके हैं और आपका नाम मतदाता सूची में नहीं है, तो फॉर्म-6 भरें



नया नाम जोड़ने हेतु

फॉर्म-7

नाम हटाने के लिए

यदि किसी का नाम मतदाता सूची में है, लेकिन उसकी मृत्यु हो गई है या स्थान परिवर्तन किया है, तो फॉर्म-7 भरें।



नाम हटाने हेतु

फॉर्म-8

विवरण सुधारने के लिए

यदि आपके नाम, आयु, पता, फोटो या अन्य विवरण में कोई गलती है, या फिर स्थान परिवर्तन किया है, तो फॉर्म 8 भरें



विवरण सुधारने हेतु

कृपया फॉर्म 6 व 8 के साथ आवश्यक दस्तावेज एवं घोषणा-पत्र अवश्य संलग्न करें।

फॉर्म के साथ आवश्यक दस्तावेज जमा करने के विकल्प



ऑनलाइन **voters.eci.gov.in** के माध्यम से

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मतदाता सूची देखें **voters.eci.gov.in**

KDA supports citizens' march to mark first anniv of death of civilians in Leh protest

Express News Service
Srinagar, September 1

THE KARGIL Democratic Alliance (KDA) on Tuesday extended its support to a citizens march to be taken out next week to mark the first anniversary of the deaths of four civilians in Leh in September last year.

Organised by the Socialist Party of India, along with a clutch of civil and political outfits, the September 10 march will be held from Kargil to Leh, and will once again raise the call for statehood for Ladakh and for the institution of Sixth Schedule, among other concerns.

KDA leaders met on Monday and announced its decision, with the party co-chairman Asgar Ali Karbalai stating that they will continue its "peaceful and democratic" struggle for the constitutional, democratic and legitimate rights of the Ladakh people.

Meanwhile, the march's convener, Sajjad Kargili said that the Leh Apex Body (LAB), too, has backed the march, assisting with its coordination.

On September 24, the day the march concludes in Leh, the groups will hold a candlelight vigil to mark the tragedy last year, when four civilians died after a protest turned violent in Leh. "We will reiterate solidarity with the victims and their families and reaffirm the demand for justice, accountability and a credible resolution of the issues that led to the tragedy," Kargili said. KDA emphasised that the march is "not directed against any individual or political party, but is a peaceful people's movement for the rights of the people of Ladakh". It underscored that the issues must be resolved through dialogue and democratic engagement.



Careers

**NMDC APOLLO CENTRAL HOSPITAL**
(Managed by Apollo Hospitals Enterprise Ltd., Hyderabad)
Dist. - Dantewada, Bachel - 494 553 (Chhattisgarh)
Ph: 07857-230050, email- nmdcapollo@gmail.com



Employment Notification No. 03/2026 Dated: 01.09.2026

WALK-IN-INTERVIEW FOR DOCTORS

NMDC Apollo Central Hospital, Bachel requires Medical Professionals as per the following details for Bachel, Kirandul and Nagamar Hospitals, which are having latest equipments and excellent infrastructure.

S.No.	Post	Qualification & Experience	Upper Age limit	Annual CTC (in Lakhs)/Pay Scale/ Monthly Consol. Salary (Rs.)	Nature of appointment
1.	Nephrologist	MD, DM / DrNB (Nephrology) with experience		Rs. 48.00 to 60.00	Regular
2.	Specialist (Medicine)	MD/DNB with experience	55yrs.**	MD/MS/DNB : Rs. 28.20 to Rs. 38.00	
3.	Specialist (Gen. Surgery)	MS with experience		PG Diploma : Rs. 23.00 to Rs. 31.00	
4.	Specialist (Radiology)*	MD/DNB/DMRD with experience		Rs. 12.00 to 18.00	
5.	GDMO	MBBS with minimum one year experience	45 yrs.	/Rs.100000/-	

*** Additional payment up to Rs.1.00 lakh p.m. can be considered for Specialist (Radiology) having good experience.**

**** Relaxation in age may be considered for suitable and experienced Specialist/Super Specialist doctors.**
Note:- Higher CTC may be considered for experienced and deserving Specialist doctors as per rules.

CTC for doctors' is under revision

1) Date of Walk-In-Interview : 10.09.2026 (Thursday)
Time : 9.30 AM to 12.30 PM
Place : NMDC Office (GEC), Housing Board Colony, Borriyakala, Shejbahar, Raipur (Chhattisgarh) 492015.

2) Date of Walk-In-Interview : 13.09.2026 (Sunday)
Time : 9.30 AM to 12.30 PM
Place : HR Department, Apollo Health City, Visakhapatnam (AP) 530040.

Important Note: For detailed advertisement kindly visit website: www.nmdc.co.in

Chief Medical Administrator

epaper.indianexpress.com



Global Outreach

THE RSS centenary celebrations appear to have put Sangh's global outreach into overdrive. As Mohan Bhagwat addresses gatherings in the US and Canada, RSS media and communication head Sunil Ambekar has reached the UK ahead of the Sangh chief's September visit. Ambekar will take questions from the press at a briefing in London on September 4. Bhagwat's UK visit is being billed as part of a "global civilisational dialogue", with engagements planned with intellectuals, policymakers, think tanks and community organisations. Earlier this year, RSS general secretary Dattatreya Hosabale, too, undertook an international outreach tour covering the UK, the US and Germany as part of the centenary celebrations.

Meeting Mystery

DURING THE last meeting of the INDIA bloc in June, all parties had decided to meet every two months. It was also decided that the next meeting of the bloc will be held in Hyderabad in August. Several top leaders of the bloc are learnt to have waited for a signal from the Congress for the meeting. Congress sources say a meeting of the Opposition bloc may be held some time in September, but there is still no clarity on date and venue.

Pat on the Back

DURING AN inspection of the Shivpuri railway station in Madhya Pradesh, Union Communications Minister Jyotiraditya Scindia praised an RPF official for risking his life to save a 35-year-old woman passenger from falling onto the tracks while trying to board a moving train. Amid cheers and applause from passengers and security personnel, Scindia lauded ASI Birendra Tiwari and presented him a customary pearl necklace, expressing gratitude for putting his own safety at risk to save a citizen's life.

Centre gives nod for NSD campus in Bihar

Patna: Bihar CM Samrat Choudhary on Tuesday said the Centre has approved the establishment of a National School of Drama (NSD) campus in the state. "The state government is taking steps to provide suitable land for the campus and bear 50% of approved construction cost as its share," he said. PTI

SCO declaration: Double standards in fight against terror unacceptable

Member States reaffirm commitment to combat terror, separatism, extremism

Shubhrajit Roy
New Delhi, September 1

STRESSING THAT "double standards" in the fight against terror are unacceptable, leaders at the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) on Tuesday called on the international community to combat terrorism, including the cross-border movement of terrorists.

This is part of the 'Bishkek Declaration' adopted by India, Pakistan, Iran, Russia, China and the Central Asian countries in the SCO grouping. The declaration is important since India has always maintained that Pakistan is responsible for cross-border terrorism in the country. On terrorism, the joint declaration stated: "Member States, reaffirming their firm commitment to combating terrorism, separatism and extremism, emphasise the inadmissibility of attempts to exploit terrorist, separatist, and extremist groups for selfish purposes. They recognize the leading role of sovereign states and their competent authorities in countering terrorist and extremist threats."

"Member states consider attempts to discredit government bodies and structures of SCO member states unacceptable. They emphasize that such actions are contrary to international law and undermine the principles of sovereign equality of states and non-interference in internal affairs enshrined in the UN Charter."

"Member States strongly condemn terrorism in all its forms and manifestations, emphasise that 'double standards'

in the fight against terrorism are unacceptable, and call on the international community to combat terrorism, including the cross-border movement of terrorists, with the UN playing a central role by fully implementing relevant UN Security Council resolutions and the UN Global Counter-Terrorism Strategy in accordance with the UN Charter and the principles of international law, in order to jointly combat all terrorist organizations," the declaration said.

On the war between US-Israel and Iran, the Bishkek Declaration said: "Member states express deep concern over developments in the Middle East and around Iran. They reiterate the SCO's previously stated position condemning military strikes on the territory of the Islamic Republic of Iran, which have resulted in numerous civilian casualties and significant damage to the country's economy."

"Such actions violate the principles and norms of international law and the UN Charter and create serious risks to international peace, security and stability," it said.

This is important since India has strong ties with Israel, and the criticism of the US and Israel is not the norm for Delhi.

"Member States express their sincere condolences to the people and Government of the Islamic Republic of Iran on the tragic death of Supreme Leader Seyed Ali Khamenei, and to the families of the victims," it said.

It also said, "Member States, reaffirming their support for the sovereignty and territorial integ-



External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar and Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi on the sidelines of the SCO Summit in Bishkek on Tuesday. ANI

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+42RvD_RGf9mJmZg1 principles of international law enshrined in the UN Charter and emphasize the need to strengthen its role as a guarantor of international peace and security, sustainable development, and the construction of a representative, democratic, and equitable multipolar world order. They make an increasing contribution to the common efforts to qualitatively improve the global order." This is also important since Russia has invaded Ukraine, China regularly threatens neighbours, including in the South China Sea and the border standoff with India.

On the West's criticism of human rights "violations" in China, Russia and Iran among others, the declaration said, "Member States emphasize the indivisibility, interdependence and interrelatedness of all human rights and recall the uni-

Sharif's office crops out Modi from SCO group photograph

Pakistan Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif's office had cropped out Prime Minister Narendra Modi from the group photograph at the SCO leaders' Summit in Bishkek and posted it on X. Facing backlash on social media, they later restored the original photograph on X. ENS

versal nature of the obligation to respect human rights and fundamental freedoms, oppose the application of "double standards", particularly in matters of human rights, and oppose interference in the internal affairs of sovereign States."

Indian officials pointed out that SCO reaffirmed the "idea of One Earth, One Family, One Future" for developing dialogue. This was the catchphrase during the 2023 G20 Summit in Delhi.

"Taking into account the views of member states, they reaffirmed the relevance of initiatives to promote cooperation in building a new type of international relations in the spirit of mutual respect, justice, equality and mutually beneficial cooperation, as well as to develop a shared vision of creating a community with a shared destiny for humanity and developing dialogue on the idea of 'One Earth, One Family, One Future'," the Declaration said. They said India's initiatives in SCO were accepted, as it said, "Strengthening scientific, technical and innovative cooperation through active involvement of young people, and through the regular holding of the SCO Young Scientists Forum."

Amid row over 'purification', Uttarakhand BJP holds 'buddhi shuddhi' for Rahul, Cong leaders

Lalmani Verma
Lucknow, September 1

THE POLITICS over the 'purification' of a Haldwani ground following a rally by Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge intensified on Tuesday with the Uttarakhand BJP unit performing a 'buddhi shuddhi' (intellect cleansing) of Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi and his party leaders at a temple in Dehradun.

BJP's SC wing state president Balbir Ghuniyal said, "Rahul Gandhi and Kharge ji have made Haldwani shuddhikaran [purification] programme a major issue despite knowing that a Valmiki community person had participated in that programme. They are spreading lies." He claimed the 'buddhi shuddhi' ritual was performed Tuesday in the hope that Gandhi and other Congress leaders attain wisdom and stop spreading lies.

Hitting back, Uttarakhand Congress general secretary Amarjeet Singh said that the party will take out a march to



Congress leaders protest outside Haldwani Kotwali over FIR against Lok Sabha Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi on Tuesday. PTI

the chief minister's residence on September 7, demanding an FIR against those who performed a purification ritual at Haldwani ground and to protest the FIR lodged against Gandhi on August 30.

Ghuniyal said the BJP's 19 organisational districts in Uttarakhand have filed separate police complaints against Gandhi.

One of the complaints lodged by BJP SC wing district president Neetu Singh Mandawar at Roorkee police station al-

leged that Gandhi in his public statements had linked Haldwani's 'shuddhikaran' programme with the caste of Kharge and the Dalit community.

"The persons associated with the programme have denied any caste bias, and there is information that SC community persons, too, participated in it. Hence, this is a serious matter to investigate on what basis Rahul Gandhi publicly presented the incident as caste-based discrimination and an

insult to Dalit community," the complaint said.

An FIR was registered against Gandhi in Haldwani following a complaint by Amit Kumar, a local resident who claimed to belong to the Valmiki community. In his complaint, Kumar questioned on what basis Gandhi had connected the "cleanliness drive and religious ritual" by him and other SC members at the Ram Lila ground, Haldwani, on August 11 an "act related to 'chhuachhut' (untouchability)" and a "crime against Scheduled Castes".

He maintained that the ritual had no connection with any individual or caste.

At a press conference in New Delhi last week, Gandhi called the 'purification' a "crime" that illustrated the "untouchability" Dalits face across India and one which exposed "BJP-RSS mindset". BJP on Monday filed police complaints against him. A senior officer in Uttarakhand police headquarters said no fresh FIR was filed against Gandhi on BJP's complaints so far.

Progress of youth is govt's priority: Nadda welcomes CJP decision to call off Sept 5 march

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 1

Union Minister J P Nadda on Tuesday welcomed the Cockroach Janta Party's decision to call off their proposed march on September 5 in the heart of Lutyens' Delhi and said the success and progress of the nation's youth is the biggest priority of the BJP-led NDA government.

Nadda and his Cabinet colleague Jitendra Singh had multiple meetings with CJP representatives at the peak of protests at Jantar Mantar last month over the latter's demands.

His statement followed the Centre's submission to the Supreme Court that the government would not pursue criminal cases lodged against students over the July 20 protests, which also saw clashes between protesters and security personnel.

"On 25 July 2026, my colleague Shri Jitendra Singh and I had a conversation with the student representatives regarding the ongoing protest at Jantar Mantar. Keeping the students' future in mind, we had assured on behalf of the Government of India that the cases registered against the protesting students would be withdrawn and no harsh action would be taken against them in the future either," Nadda said. "In this regard, we held discussions with the governments of BJP-ruled states as well, and now we are moving forward in the direction of fulfilling that promise. We welcome the decision to call off the September 5 protest announced by the CJP's spokesperson... For the government, the progress and development of the youth is its top-most priority," he said.

BJP hits out at Rahul over 'falsehood' on economy

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 1

WITH THE economy growing at a robust 7.8% year-on-year in the April-June quarter despite headwinds caused by the West Asia conflict and high energy prices, the BJP on Tuesday hailed the nation's "strong economic management" and stable governance by the PM Narendra Modi-led Centre.

Former Union Minister Ravi Shankar Prasad said the GDP growth reflected strong economic management in the face of global challenges and that India, under PM Modi's leadership, was moving from "Fragile Five" economy of UPA days to becoming a major world economy.

Demanding that Congress leader Rahul Gandhi apologise for calling the Indian economy "dead" and spreading falsehood that a big economic tsunami was on its way, Prasad said, "Now, a growth rate of 7.8% is in front of you. Do you have some shame?"

"Rahul Gandhi doesn't do his homework. He relies on cheat-speak. He simply reads out whatever has been written for him... Has Rahul Gandhi taken a contract to compromise and weaken the morale of the people of India?" Prasad said, addressing a press conference at the BJP headquarters.

"BJP condemns outright the irresponsible, false, baseless and mischievous contention of Gandhi..." Prasad said

Prasad said that the GDP figure has a "special significance", because "in the period being discussed from April to June before that in January-February the entire Gulf crisis had started. There was the problem of oil, the problem of supply chain, and uncertainty in the world. Despite this, India's economy remained at 7.8%."

"In the same period, Canada was at 1.5%, Germany at 1%, the UK at 2.1%, Malaysia at 6%, and South Korea at 3.7%. America too was around 2%. Everywhere in the world there were problems due to the Gulf crisis, war, and the issue of Hormuz, and oil movement was disrupted. Despite all these, where India stands and where others stand."

Vijay opens Mettur dam after 80 days; extend release beyond 45 days: farmers

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, September 1

AT 11.30 AM on Tuesday, after an 80-day wait, the sluice gates of the Stanley Reservoir at Mettur opened and Cauvery water began flowing towards the delta, an annual passage that, for generations of farmers, has marked the beginning of an agricultural season.

CM C Joseph Vijay released the water for samba cultivation, scattering flowers and grains into the current as it gushed from the reservoir. The initial discharge of 3,000 cusecs was to be gradually increased to 7,000 cusecs by Tuesday evening.

The government has initially planned the release only for 45 days, until October 15, with the discharge to be regulated according to water availability and irrigation requirements.

At 8 am on Tuesday, the reservoir stood at 91.56 feet against its full level of 120 feet. Storage was 54.45 thousand million cubic feet (tmc ft), a little over

half its capacity of 93.47 tmc ft. Inflow had declined to 10,857 cusecs from 11,501 cusecs. The numbers explain both the significance of Tuesday's opening and the anxiety surrounding it.

Mettur's significance

From Mettur reservoir, water travels downstream to sustain agriculture across the Cauvery delta. About 16.05 lakh acres in 12 districts — Tiruchi, Thanjavur, Tiruvarur, Cuddalore, Nagapattinam, Erode, Pudukkottai, Ariyalur, Perambalur, Karur, Mayiladuthurai and Namakkal — benefit from the release.

In a normal year, the dam is opened on June 12 and closed on January 28, providing a 230-day irrigation window. An estimated 330 tmc ft is required for irrigation during the period. This year, inadequate storage prevented the customary June opening, pushing the release to September 1.

It is only the fourth time that a delta irrigation release has begun in September, after simi-



Tamil Nadu CM C Joseph Vijay at Mettur in Salem on Tuesday. ANI

lar delays in 2002, 2012 and 2016. In the dam's 93-year history, water has been released on June 12 only 20 times and before that date on 11 occasions. Tuesday marked the 62nd instance of a delayed opening.

Farmers who met Vijay at Mettur urged him to extend the release beyond the announced 45 days and sought measures to divert surplus Mettur water to water bodies in the Thalaivasal region.

The government said the release would be closely managed. Agriculture and Farmers Welfare, Water Resources, and Revenue and Disaster Management departments have been asked to coordinate with district administrations. Joint teams involving Water Resources, Revenue, Police and electricity officials will monitor illegal pumping and unauthorised extraction. Farmers have also been advised to use medium-

duration paddy varieties and water-saving techniques, including direct seeding.

The government attributed the difficult water position to the southwest monsoon deficit and the impact of El Niño. It also reiterated that TN would continue legal and administrative efforts to secure its share of Cauvery water from Karnataka under the Cauvery Water Disputes Tribunal's final award and the Supreme Court's 2018 judgment.

The political and agricultural importance of Mettur is inseparable from its history. Construction began in 1925 and was completed in 1934, with about 17,000 workers involved. Several villages were evacuated for the reservoir. When its waters retreat sufficiently, remnants of the submerged landscape — including an old church and the Nandhi of the Jalagan-deeswarar temple — become visible again.

The dam, 1,700 metres long, was built across the Cauvery for irrigation and hydroelectric

generation. It receives water from its own catchment as well as flows associated with the Kabini and Krishna Raja Sagar reservoirs in Karnataka.

Water's path

There is another geography tied to Mettur. Canal releases, normally beginning on August 1, irrigate nearly 45,000 acres in Salem, Namakkal and Erode. A separate Rs 565-crore surplus-water scheme, launched in 2020, was designed to carry excess water when the reservoir reaches 120 feet to lakes and tanks in Mettur, Omalur, Edappadi and Sankari. By 2025, surplus water had been pumped to 60 lakes, though the project remains incomplete.

Tuesday's ceremony also brought crowds along the roughly 40-km route from Salem airport to Mettur. TVK workers and residents had begun gathering from 8 am, and more than 3,800 police personnel were deployed for the CM's visit.

SC closes suo motu case over NCERT textbook chapter on judiciary

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, September 1

THE SUPREME Court on Tuesday closed suo motu proceedings pertaining to the contents of the Class 8 NCERT textbook referring to corruption in the judiciary after it was informed that the chapter was withdrawn.

A bench comprising CJI Surya Kant and Justices Joymaya Bagchi and V Mohana said that the controversial chapter has been replaced based on the revisions suggested by an expert panel constituted by the Centre. Solicitor General Tushar Mehta informed the SC that the textbooks with the new chapter are in circulation.

The SC clarified that a statement recorded in its May 22 order, that the curriculum had not been placed before the panel at all levels and so could not be termed a collective decision. It was hearing a suo motu case concerning NCERT's Class 8 Social Science book, which contained "offending" contents on corruption in the judiciary.

3 shortlisted for Ram temple CEO post, announcement likely today

Maulshree Seth
Lucknow, September 1

RETIRED BUREAUCRATS are among the top contenders for the first Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of the Shri Ram Janmbhoomi Teerth Kshetra, sources said, with the search committee recommending a panel of three candidates for the post on Tuesday.

The names of the three have not been disclosed. Ahead of the Wednesday meeting of the Trust, the three-member committee submitted its final report after sifting through 5,585 applications.

"Based on its comprehensive evaluation, the Search Committee has recommended a panel of three highly qualified professionals to the Ram Janmbhoomi Trust. These candidates represent the highest caliber of institutional leadership, management expertise, integrity and vision required to serve as Chief Executive Officer



Members of the selection committee and Ram Janmbhoomi Trust with the final recommendation report, in Ayodhya on Tuesday. PTI

of an institution of national and international significance," said committee secretary Sameer Panda. "The Trust will take the final decision on the appointment and announce the selected candidate in due course."

Sources said the name of the CEO is likely to be announced after the Trust meeting on Wednesday. The decision to appoint a full-time CEO came after alle-

gations of embezzlement of donations at the Ram temple led to increased scrutiny of the Trust's financial management. Eight accused have been arrested in the case, while three officials, including former Trust general secretary Champat Rai, have stepped down from their posts.

The committee had laid down eligibility criteria: Applicants must be between 50 and

70 years of age, have at least 20 years of administrative experience, and be willing to reside in Ayodhya. It also said the applicant must be a "practising Hindu" with "devotion to Lord Ram" and should be proficient in both Hindi and English.

The screening process

The committee said the selection process was conducted through a multi-tiered evaluation combining AI-enabled technology with manual assessment. According to a statement from the panel, teams worked simultaneously across Delhi-NCR, Pune and Sambalpur to screen and shortlist candidates in a "rigorous" and "transparent" process.

After the initial screening, the names were narrowed down to 16. They participated in online interactive sessions between August 3 and 6, followed by face-to-face interactions in Ayodhya on August 11 and 12. The committee said the

final three candidates were recommended after a "comprehensive evaluation", taking into account institutional leadership, management expertise, integrity and vision required to head an institution of "national and international significance".

The committee comprises retired Supreme Court judge Justice Pramod Kohli, retired Lieutenant General Vishnukant Chaturvedi, and retired nuclear scientist and former chairperson of the Shri Saibaba Sansthan Trust in Shirdi Suresh Haware. Panda was appointed its secretary on July 14.

"During the submission of the report, Treasurer and Trustee Govinddeo; Trustee Sant Dinendra Das; Secretary General and Trustee Krishna Mohan; Ayodhya District Magistrate Shashank Tripathi; Special Invitee Member Dinesh; Secretary Jagdish Afle; and Jagannath Gulve and Bajrang Bagada were present," the statement said.

BRIEFLY



A submerged area near Assi Ghat in Varanasi on Tuesday. PTI

UTTAR PRADESH

Heavy rainfall hits life in Varanasi; Mandakini breaches danger mark

INCESSANT RAINFALL on Tuesday led to heavy waterlogging in Lakhimpur Kheri and Varanasi districts of Uttar Pradesh, disrupting normal life, while the Mandakini river in flood-hit Chitrakoot was flowing around four metres above the danger mark on Tuesday, officials said. The deluge forced authorities in Lakhimpur to close all educational institutions up to Class 8 for the day, while in Varanasi, cremations at the Manikarnika and Harishchandra ghats were being carried out on rooftops and bylanes. Rising water level in the Sharda river in Lakhimpur also disrupted train service on the Mailani-Nanpara section. North Eastern Railway PRO Mahesh Gupta said train service between Mailani, Bichhia and Nanpara would remain suspended until further orders. PTI

2 jawans missing in boat capsize during training

TWO ARMY jawans of Special Forces are reported to be missing at Hathnikund barrage near Yamunanagar in Haryana after their boat capsized in Yamuna river during a training exercise on Tuesday. Army troops belonging to 1 Parachute Battalion (Special Forces), which is based at Nahan in Himachal Pradesh, were carrying out a routine training exercise when the mishap took place. According to Rohitash Kumar, SHO of Pratap Nagar Police Station, they received the information about the accident at 6 pm. "A search operation has been launched by the SDRF of Haryana as well as Uttar Pradesh," he said. IAF helicopters too have been pressed into service. ENS

Differently-abled woman dies in Mizoram blaze

A 21-YEAR-OLD differently-abled woman was charred to death after a house

caught fire in Mizoram's Khawzawl district on Tuesday, officials said. The deceased, identified as Lalhriatzuali of Khawhai village, was the only person inside the house when the fire broke out at around 1 pm, they said. People staying at a nearby sub-centre noticed the fire and rushed to the spot to douse the flames. Although the fire was doused before it completely gutted the house, the victim could not be rescued, officials said. The cause of the fire is yet to be ascertained. PTI

Cough syrup cases: No HC relief for accused

THE ALLAHABAD HC Tuesday rejected the bail pleas of 19 alleged masterminds in cases involving illegal storage, transportation and sale of codeine-laced cough syrups, while granting bail to truck drivers, helpers and small retail sellers, saying they merely transported sealed parcels or were unaware that cough syrups were concealed inside the cartons. PTI

Firecracker factory blast in UP: Owner of illegal unit held

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, September 1

POLICE ON Tuesday arrested the owner of an illegal firecracker factory in Uttar Pradesh's Kaushambi after an encounter, following an explosion at the unit that killed 11 people, including eight children, who lived in the vicinity.

Kaushambi Circle Officer Shivank Singh said they were informed early Tuesday that the key accused, Naushad, was in the Charwa area and was attempting to flee. A police team rushed to the location and cordoned off the area. Police said Naushad opened fire when he spotted the team, prompting the policemen to retaliate. He sustained a bullet injury to his leg and was hospitalised. Police said his condition is now stable.

An inspector and six sub-inspectors have been suspended so far. The explosion occurred at the factory on Monday, which was running out of a house in Manauri village, located on the border of Kaushambi and Prayagraj districts.

Sensors to risk maps, J&K draws up shield against floods in the light of Nepal disaster

Arun Sharma
Jammu, September 1

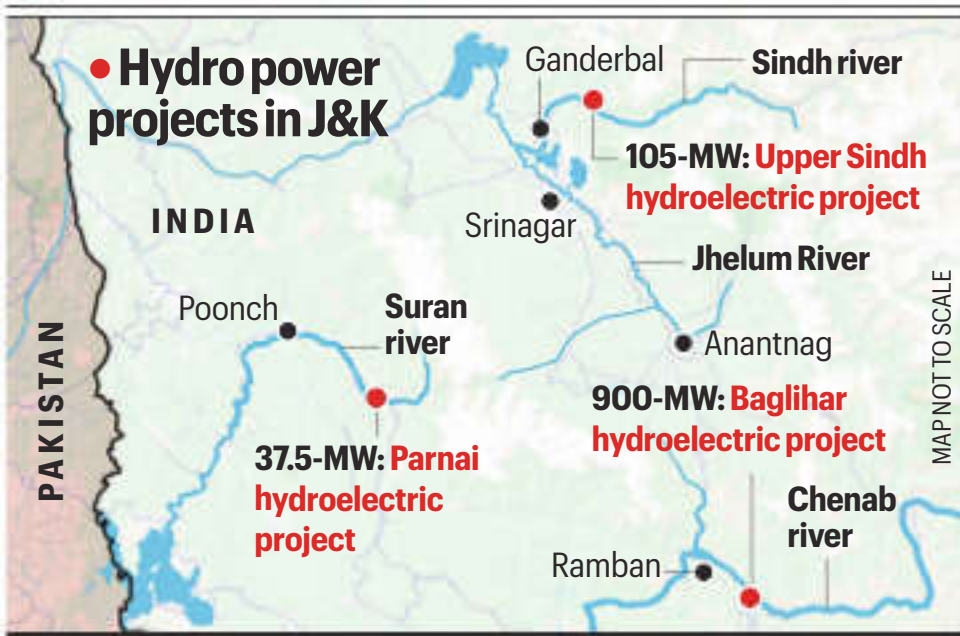
EARLY FLOOD warning systems at three hydroelectric projects, a GIS-based multi-hazard risk atlas, and stronger disaster-risk planning and regulation—these are some of the major measures the Jammu & Kashmir government is planning as part of its early flood warning systems as it considers ways to ensure sufficient response time in the event of a natural disaster.

Rahul Yadav, Managing Director of the Jammu Kashmir Power Development Corporation (JKPDC), told *The Indian Express* that tenders have been floated for installation of these early warning systems at the 900-megawatt (MW) Baglihar hydroelectric project over Chenab river in Ramban district, the 105-MW Upper Sindh hydroelectric project over Sindh river in Ganderbal district, and the 37.5-MW Parnai hydroelectric project built on Suran river near Bafliaz in border Poonch district.

The decision forms part of the UT administration's multi-pronged strategy to strengthen disaster resilience after cloudbursts and floods in J&K, especially in the Chenab Valley region. It assumes significance in view of the large-scale deaths and widespread devastation caused by recent floods in Nepal.

The system will involve identifying strategic locations for installing sensors and communication equipment upstream of dams and barrages, providing 1-2 hours of response time, sources said.

Significantly, all three hydroelectric projects are located in mountainous regions, highly vulnerable to flash floods triggered by cloudbursts, avalanches and glacial lake outbursts at high altitudes.



Kishtwar Deputy Commissioner Pankaj Sharma, under whose jurisdiction the Paddar area falls, said that after last year's Chishoti flash floods, several studies were conducted by experts from the Department of Disaster Management, Relief, Rehabilitation and Reconstruction (DMRRR). While the teams initially conducted studies on landslide-prone areas, they later studied GLOFs. Kishtwar, Doda and Ramban districts were placed in the highly vulnerable category for landslides.

As far as high-altitude glacial lakes are concerned, the studies have categorised Mundiskar lake in the district as "highly vulnerable". Sharma said the Kishtwar district administration sent a Rs 35-crore proposal to the DMRRR for disaster mitigation measures nearly a fortnight ago. The work will start once the DMRRR approves the proposal.

Jammu and Kashmir has seen repeated episodes of flash floods, cloudbursts and landslides in recent years, with the Chenab Valley among the worst affected. Since June 1 this year, nearly 35 cloudburst incidents have been reported across the UT, with Kishtwar, Doda and Ramban among the most vul-

nerable districts.

Last year, the Jammu and Kashmir government, quoting a scientific study by researchers from Kashmir University's Department of Geo-informatics, had said that five glacial lakes in the Kashmir Himalayas fall in the "very high susceptibility" class for potential glacial lake outburst floods. Identifying these lakes as Bramsar, Chrisar, Nundgol, Bhagsar and Gangabal, it added, as per the study, their high susceptibility together threatens over 2,700 buildings, 15 key bridges, segments of road infrastructure and one hydroelectric power plant.

Officials said the DMRRR, in a major push to strengthen disaster preparedness in the UT, is implementing a five-pronged strategy across the UT. This includes creating a GIS-based multi-hazard risk atlas using digital terrain and elevation modelling in vulnerable areas, enforcing building safety codes, updating district disaster management plans and integrating risk reduction into master plans.

Apart from establishing a dedicated disaster management training institute, it also intends to sign an MoU with the Geological Survey of India for forecasting landslides.

Mamata's niece found dead at Birbhum home; police suspect suicide

Ravik Bhattacharya & Atri Mitra
Kolkata, September 1

FORMER WEST Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee's niece, Bristy Mukherjee, was found dead at her home in Birbhum district, police said Tuesday. She was the daughter of the Trinamool supremo's maternal cousin and local TMC leader, Nihar Mukherjee.

Police said the 28-year-old was found hanging by her family members at around 10am on Tuesday on the first floor of her Kusumba village-based house in Birbhum. The body has been sent for an autopsy to the Rampurhat Government Medical College and Hospital, and the Rampurhat police have started an investigation into her death.

A senior police officer of Birbhum district police said, "Primarily it seems to be a suicide case. However, we are considering every ground of unnatural death, and a probe is being conducted." While the cause of her death is yet to be ascertained, her family said the young woman had been batt-



Bristy Mukherjee, 28, was the daughter of the TMC leader from Birbhum Nihar Mukherjee

ling depression for the past few years and was receiving medical treatment for the same.

Her father said, "She was suffering from depression for the last few years. We took her to a doctor, too. In the morning when she was not coming down from her room, we went up and saw her hanging from the ceiling fan." Bristy was also fighting a divorce case with her husband.

Her mother, Pampa Mukherjee, said, "Her marriage did not work out. They (her family) frequently sent her back here. We had filed for a divorce. We are shattered now..."

163 Indians rescued from Nepal so far, says MEA

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 1

THE NUMBER of Indian nationals rescued in the wake of the devastating flash floods in Nepal stands at 163, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said on Tuesday, as India sustained its relief and rescue efforts.

MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal shared the update on X. He also shared updates on a 19-member specialised forensics team from India that began functioning in Kathmandu on Sunday, as well as updates on a

tunnel rescue team deployed in Chilime.

"Using innovative methods and improvised floats, the [tunnel rescue] team was able to move deeper in the tunnel. Its efforts will continue tomorrow to try and rescue any individuals that may be trapped inside," the statement said.

"As of 1930 hrs on 01 Sept 2026, number of Indian nationals rescued: 163 (with the addition of 5 new individuals since yesterday). Number of Indian nationals who have left China today: 151," Jaiswal posted.

10 OF 22 PEOPLE REPORTED MISSING FROM UTTAR PRADESH AFTER NEPAL'S AUGUST 26 FLOODS HAVE RETURNED

'People rushed onto streets, calls failed': How 4 from UP made it home from Nepal

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, September 1

FOR 23-YEAR-OLD Ashutosh Mani Upadhyay, his first flight was also his way out of flood-hit Nepal. He had travelled to Nepal just two months ago to work as a junior pipeline fitter at a factory in Rasuwa district.

But before he could settle into his new job, he found himself being evacuated by helicopter along with five other Uttar Pradesh residents.

Rasuwa was among the worst-hit areas, though Ashutosh said he was away from the area when the floods struck. "There was a sense of fear and uncertainty everywhere in Nepal," he recounted. "I was told to board a helicopter that would take us to a safer place. I was ex-

cited because I had never travelled by air before. The flight lasted a few minutes but I will remember for the rest of my life."

The six were flown to a cantonment area, where they completed the necessary formalities before hiring a vehicle to travel to Gorakhpur in Uttar Pradesh. Ashutosh reached his hometown of Mureri Gadwa village on Monday.

For families across Uttar Pradesh, the wait for news from relatives stranded in Nepal has begun to ease.

The Uttar Pradesh Relief Commissioner's emergency helpline received calls about 22 people whose families had lost contact with them. Families of 10 of them have since told authorities that their relatives are home and safe, an official said.

Some were evacuated with the help of the Nepal government and officials stationed there, while others made their own way back. *The Indian Express* spoke to those who made it home about the fear, uncertainty, and scramble to get out of the country.

'I was afraid borders could be sealed'

Krishna Pratap Singh, 45, had travelled from Aligarh to Nepal on August 21 in search of work. Five days later, the floods hit.

"I was terrified after hearing that a large number of people had been killed and property damaged just a few kilometres from where I was staying. There was a huge rush in Kathmandu, with people from outside the



Photos of unidentified bodies in Kathmandu, Tuesday. TASHI TOBGYAL

city struggling to find a way back home. There was no local government official or organisation to help us," said Singh, who

works in the wood business.

He said he tried to contact his family but couldn't reach them. "I decided to return...

The family with whom I was staying also pressured me to go home. I was also afraid that the borders could be sealed." Singh said Nepalese authorities later flew him to the India-Nepal border, from where he travelled by road and entered India.

'Come back home immediately'

On August 27, when Raj Kumar Gautam, 44, finally managed to call his family in Maharajganj from Kathmandu, they had only one thing to tell him: Come back home immediately. Gautam had been working with a local contractor involved in making wooden furniture in Kathmandu for the past year. He has been travelling to Nepal for work regularly for the past two decades.

He said panic had spread across Nepal after reports of flooding and widespread damage emerged.

"There was widespread chaos. Phone calls were not going through and even the WiFi was not working. I knew my family would be worried, and I was desperately trying to contact them to tell them that I was safe." Gautam said people had rushed onto the streets, desperately looking for any possible way to leave Nepal. "I somehow managed to find a vehicle carrying other passengers and made my way to Maharajganj via Bihar," he added. "When I finally reached home, my three daughters and son surrounded me, relieved to see me back," said Raj Kumar, a resident of Jagannathpur vil-

lage in Maharajganj.

'His cellphone had been stolen'

For Deepak Gupta's family in Bareilly, the fear began when his phone stopped connecting. The 33-year-old travels to Nepal for six to seven months every year to sell artificial jewellery and gemstones sourced from Delhi. He was in Kathmandu when the floods hit. "We became worried when we could not reach him on his phone," said his elder brother, Vijay Gupta.

The next day, Deepak managed to call. "He said his phone had been stolen amid the rush and panic. He was in Kathmandu," said Vijay. "I asked him to return home immediately. He came back two days ago along with four others."

AFT reinstates Agniveer who was discharged from Army for suppressing info

Man Aman Singh Chhina
Chandigarh, September 1

THE ARMED Forces Tribunal (AFT) has set aside the Army's decision to discharge an Agniveer and ordered his reinstatement with consequential benefits, holding that he could not be penalised for not declaring a pending criminal case arising from an incident that occurred when he was a minor.

The Principal Bench of Chairperson Justice Rajendra Menon and Member (Administrative) Rasika Chaube allowed the petition of Anas Chauhan, on August 17 and quashed the discharge order of the Army dated January 20, 2026.

The Army discharged Chauhan under Item IV of Rule 13(3) of the Army Rules, 1954, alleging that he suppressed information in his enrolment form.

Chauhan was selected as an Agniveer in the 2024-25 recruitment rally after clearing physical tests. Police verification later produced an adverse report referring to an FIR registered in Meerut on October 3, 2020, against 16 people, including Chauhan, under Indian Penal Code sections 353, 332, 307, 147, 148, 149 and others.

A show-cause notice followed on September 12, 2025, and the Commanding Officer then discharged him on January 20, 2026.

Chauhan's counsel submitted that he was about 17 years old at the time of the alleged village quarrel and that the FIR contained only general allegations. He relied on an order of the Allahabad High Court dated April 10, 2025, in a petition under Section 528 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita.

Punjab moves SC, says can't pay Rs 14,191 cr DA dues in 15 days

Ananthakrishnan G & Kanchan Vasdev
New Delhi, Chandigarh, September 1

THE PUNJAB government on Tuesday moved the Supreme Court challenging Punjab and Haryana High Court order directing it to release within a fortnight the pending dearness allowance (DA) and dearness relief (DR) to the employees and pensioners, contending that the financial obligation works out to Rs 14,191 crores and "compliance within the time allowed is not lawfully possible".

The Special Leave Petition (SLP), filed by Additional Chief Secretary, Finance, seeks an interim stay on the HC's August 3 judgment as well as on any contempt proceedings likely to arise due to its non-implementation.

The Punjab employees have already filed a caveat in the Supreme Court. Separately, the high court will take up for hearing on September 27 a contempt petition filed by employees against the Punjab government.

Seeking the top court's leave to appeal against the HC judgment, Punjab has argued that payment of the entire amount would have serious fiscal and constitutional implications. The State has also contended that money cannot be withdrawn from the Consolidated Fund without following the prescribed appropriation process.

"Expenditure of this order cannot be met without a supplementary statement of expenditure under Article 205(1)(a), a demand for a grant, which by Article 203(3), may be made only upon the recommendation of the Governor, the assent of the House under Article 203(2), and an Appropriation Act under Article 204, without which, by Article 204(3), no money may be withdrawn from the Consolidated Fund of the State at all," read the plea. It adds that



Employees protest outside Punjab Secretariat demanding the release of DA arrears in Chandigarh. KAMLESHWAR SINGH

"every one of those steps presupposes a sitting of the Legislative Assembly summoned by the Governor under Article 174."

A division bench of the high court had asked the State to release, within a fortnight, every pending installment of DA and DR "to every State employee and pensioner at the rates applicable to officers of the All India Services serving in connection with the affairs of the State". It had also directed that the State would have to pay 6 per cent simple interest in case of default. It also "restrained" the State government "from 'unproductive' expenditure until all dues are cleared. The high court had also quashed a liquidation plan submitted by the State government "as it staggers the admitted arrears of approximately Rs 14,191 crore."

The State, in its plea, said the directions produce a "disproportionate outcome".

In its plea, the Punjab government argued that its rules do not mandate payment of DA to State employees at the rate fixed by the Centre for its employees. It said the Punjab Civil Services (Revised Pay) Rules, 2021, prescribe no specific index, for-

mula, rate or interval for DA and leave the matter to the State government's discretion.

It further submitted that the State pays DA to All India Services officers at the central rate because they are governed by Union law and the State has no power to determine their service conditions.

It pointed out that the Sixth Punjab Pay Commission had revised the State's pay by a multiplication factor of 2.59, rising to 2.72, against the 2.57 adopted by the Seventh Central Pay Commission, "so that Punjab's basic pay is higher than the corresponding Central basic pay across most of the matrix". It said that DA being a percentage applied to basic pay, "an identical percentage upon a higher base does not produce an identical emolument but a larger one."

It submitted that "in five categories — clerk, driver, stenographer, ETT teacher, and constable — of the seven, the Punjab employee already draws more at the existing 42 per cent (DA) between Rs 1,832 and Rs 17,852 a month" and it was only in two categories — Superintendent and Police Inspector — that it fell short.

The plea said the State "offered upon oath to cure it, undertaking in principle to raise DA so far as required to extend to its employees parity with analogous Central categories in absolute carry home salary... Yet the impugned judgment did not advert to the undertaking, even though the application was on the file from 28.07.2026, six days before pronouncement."

On the fiscal stress that the order puts on the state, it said, "upon the material compiled by the Cabinet Sub-Committee constituted on 07.04.2026, committed expenditure upon salaries and pensions is approximately 51% of the petitioner's revenue receipts, the highest among the major States against an all India average of about 38%, and committed liabilities including interest consume about 82%". It adds that the "impugned order does not remedy an under payment, it compounds an over payment, from one of the fiscally most constrained major State in India."

Its aid that clearing Rs 14,191 crore in one go would amount to roughly three months of the State's entire wage and pension bill. "Such an expenditure," according to the government, "cannot be undertaken without disturbing welfare and other essential spending" and "cannot be withdrawn from the Consolidated Fund without following the constitutional appropriation process".

The government said its Cabinet had approved a liquidation plan in February 2025 under which arrears of around Rs 14,191 crore were to be paid in phases over five financial years, but this was quashed by the HC.

The plea also challenges the high court's direction restraining the state from incurring unproductive expenditure, arguing that no such expenditure was pleaded or supported by evidence before the court.

Maharashtra doctor who attempted suicide dies days later; family alleges pressure, seeks SIT probe

Anuradha Mascarenhas & Apoorva Agashe
Pune, Mumbai, September 1

ON AUGUST 27, Dr Rajendra Rupnavar climbed an electrical tower near Sion railway station and told the police below he was facing action at his workplace and had been removed from his job. As fire brigade personnel persuaded him to come down, the 28-year-old doctor, who had travelled from Satara to Mumbai two days earlier, allegedly attempted to hang himself outside one of Mumbai's busiest suburban train stations.

He was brought down and taken to Sion Hospital. Four days later, he died of cardiac arrest.

The death of the young doctor from a farming family and his attempt to kill himself outside one of Mumbai's busiest railway stations are now the subject of a police probe. His family has demanded an SIT probe. His brother and colleagues allege Rupnavar had been under pressure after refusing to issue a medical fitness certificate required for a firearm licence, and that his subsequent suspension and departmental inquiry pushed him further into distress.

The allegations have also brought scrutiny on the administration of the Sub-District Hospital in Phaltan, where Rupnavar worked as a contractual medical officer.

His brother Sagar Rupnavar alleged that trouble began on July 27, when a man identified by the family as Prasad Kondeshmukh allegedly came to the Phaltan hospital with a bouncer and sought a medical fitness certificate required for obtaining a gun licence. Rupnavar allegedly refused to issue the certificate, citing technical difficulties. "My brother refused to issue the fitness certificate as there were



Dr Rajendra Rupnavar

some technical difficulties. The person threatened him, saying he was a former minister's personal assistant," Sagar alleged.

A verbal altercation allegedly followed. Sagar alleged Kondeshmukh subsequently approached Rupnavar's senior, Dr Leela Madane, and obtained the certificate. The next day, July 28, Rupnavar was suspended and a departmental inquiry was initiated against him, Sagar alleged.

For Rupnavar's family, the timing of the action was significant. They say he believed he was being punished for refusing to issue the certificate.

Dr Amol Bansude, a medical intern at Pune's Sassoon General Hospital and a friend of Rupnavar, said he had spoken to him. "I told him to forget the episode and move on," he said.

Bansude said he had even asked him to leave the Phaltan job and come to Pune, where there were openings at Kamala Nehru Hospital. "But he refused. He believed in justice and was determined that justice be done," Bansude said.

Rupnavar came from a poor family and had worked his way through medical education, eventually gaining admission to Grant Medical College in Mumbai. He had been working at the Phaltan hospital for around one-and-a-half years.

NIA court rejects bail plea of J&K man accused of backing Hizbul terrorists

Arun Sharma
Jammu, September 1

DENYING BAIL to an alleged terror associate booked on charges of providing food, shelter and other logistics to terrorists in J&K's Kishtwar district, an NIA court said Tuesday that "if this yardstick" of delay in trial "is adopted, by and large, no person accused of committing the offence under the special enactment could be detained in prison after the expiry of certain specified period".

A bail application was filed by Tanvir Ahmed Malik of Doda district's Tanta area. He was arrested by the NIA on March 1, 2021, on charges of providing food, shelter and logistics to Hizbul Mujahideen terrorists, Haroon Abbas Wani and Tahir Ahmed Bhat, at his home from June 2019 until Haroon Abbas Wani was killed in an encounter on January 15, 2020.

According to the application, the applicant has been in jail for five years and that a speedy trial is the fundamental right of the petitioner. However, Special Judge of the NIA Court, Prem Sagar, said that "trial is already underway as the charge was framed on March 3, 2022 and 30 witnesses are examined out of 101 cited by prosecution".

On March 8, 2019, Haroon Abbas Wani and another terrorist Osama Bin Javed were allegedly involved in the snatching of an AK-47 rifle, three magazines and 90 rounds from a police head constable Daleep Singh, escort in-charge of Kishtwar Deputy Commissioner, according to NIA probe.

That weapon was later recovered from the encounter site of Haroon Wani in January 2020, it said.

EXPRESS special

Agra to Chennai to Manipur: Mystery of body in suitcase in train takes cops on 2,000-km trail

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, September 1

AT FIRST, there was little for investigators to work with. A red trolley suitcase abandoned in an unreserved railway compartment, a woman's dismembered and decomposing body inside it, and a train that had travelled hundreds of kilometres before anyone discovered what the luggage contained.

By the end of August, that suitcase had led investigators from a railway platform in Agra through hundreds of CCTV recordings to suburban trains and an autorickshaw in Chennai, then to a locked tiled-roof house in Guduvanchery suburbs, and eventually, over 2,000 kilometres away to Manipur, where police arrested a young couple in their early twenties suspected of killing the woman.

The victim was identified as Hayathun Nisha, 38, an Odisha native who had been living in Guduvanchery, South of Chennai city, and working at a private firm. Police suspect she was killed by Manik Uddin Laskar, 22, after a relationship between them deteriorated over her demand that he marry her, said a senior officer familiar with his in-

terrogation.

Laskar and his wife, Bhagabati Majhi, were arrested in Kashimpur in Manipur's Jiribam district on Saturday.

The probe began on August 5, when passengers aboard the Tamil Nadu Express noticed a foul smell coming from a seemingly abandoned red suitcase in a general compartment after the train reached Agra. Government Railway Police officers opened it and found the headless, dismembered remains of a woman.

There was no immediately obvious way to identify either the woman or whoever had placed the suitcase aboard the train. Investigators turned, instead, to the journey the luggage had made.

More than 350 CCTV recordings scanned

Working with Tamil Nadu police, the Agra Railway Police, Chennai Government Railway Police and the Railway Protection Force began examining CCTV recordings from Chennai Central. Investigators eventually scrutinised hundreds of recordings — more than 350, according to one account — and found images of a man and a woman carrying what appeared to be the same red trolley suitcase through the station



The accused man and his wife, the victim, were captured on CCTV cameras carrying a red trolley suitcase into Tamil Nadu

and onto the Tamil Nadu Express.

The footage provided the first substantial trail. The pair, the officers said, had not travelled with the suitcase. They left it aboard the train and got off before its departure. Cameras then captured them walking towards Park station, taking a suburban EMU and getting off at Guduvanchery, before leaving in an autorickshaw.

Investigators effectively began running that journey backwards. More than 200 cameras in and around Guduvanchery were examined as police reconstructed the pair's movements. The trail eventually led to a rented house near Mosque Street — also referred to

in reports as Masuthi (masjid) Street — where investigators believed the suspects and Nisha had been staying.

Body parts found in cooking vessel

The house was locked. Police broke it open and searched the premises. Inside, the officer said, they found additional human remains, believed to be Nisha's, in a large cooking vessel. Reports from the investigation said three people — a man and two women — had been staying at the property.

By then, the case had changed fundamentally. What had begun as the discovery of an unidentified body aboard a long-distance train now had a suspected crime scene, a victim and possible perpetrators. Police identified the principal suspects as Laskar, from Assam's Cachar district, and his wife Majhi, from Odisha. The couple had disappeared.

Special teams began tracking them through various means, including Call Data Records, (CDRs) across states. The search ended on August 29 in Kashimpur, in Jiribam district of Manipur, where the Guduvanchery police, assisted by local personnel, arrested Laskar and Majhi. They were subsequently brought to Tambaram for inter-

rogation. It was during that questioning, police sources said, that investigators obtained their first account of a possible motive.

Laskar allegedly told investigators that he and Nisha had been in a relationship for about six months. According to the account he gave police, tensions grew when Nisha began pressing him to marry her, resulting in repeated quarrels. Investigators suspect one such confrontation at the Guduvanchery house culminated in her killing.

Police allege that Laskar subsequently dismembered Nisha's body and shaved her head. Parts of her remains were placed in the trolley suitcase that investigators say he and his wife carried all the way to Chennai Central, leaving it aboard a train bound for Delhi — effectively putting hundreds of kilometres between the crime scene and the eventual discovery of the body.

Other remains, police say, were left behind at the house. Some details of what happened inside the Guduvanchery property remain under investigation, and accounts emerging during the probe have contained discrepancies, including over the precise handling and disposal of the remains. Nisha's head has also been reported missing.

IIM ROHTAK VARIABLE PAY ROW

CAG: Establish uniform and fiscally prudent framework for variable pay to IIM directors

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 1

FLAGGING SEVERAL procedural and regulatory irregularities in the approval of variable pay of Rs 3.2 crore to IIM Rohtak director Dheeraj Sharma, the Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) has recommended that the Ministry of Education consider establishing a uniform, transparent and fiscally prudent framework for payment of variable pay to IIM directors.

The CAG in its report said the IIM Act, 2017 entitles the institute's director to variable pay based on performance objectives specified in the regulations and empowers the board to frame regulations, including those that determine performance objectives for variable pay.

It said the regulations of IIM Rohtak became effective only upon publication in the Official Gazette on October 25, 2021.

The regulations require the board to develop and convey a performance matrix for the director, based on which variable pay will be determined. It also requires the director to recuse himself in all matters involving

conflict of interest.

The payment of the variable pay to the IIM Rohtak director covered three years — 2018-19, 2019-20 and 2020-21 — despite the regulations coming into effect only in October 2021.

Pointing out several other irregularities, the CAG recommended that IIM Rohtak "ensure that variable pay and similar payments are made strictly in accordance with regulations effective from the date of notification and avoid any retrospective application".

"The Ministry may consider establishing a uniform, transparent and fiscally prudent framework for payment of variable pay to directors across various IIMs," it said.

It also said the board may ensure that the director's recusal is formally recorded in all matters of personal interest and that performance benchmarks, evaluation records and supporting data are properly documented.

"Matters involving financial implications should be taken up only through pre-approved agendas to uphold transparency and integrity," it said.

The audit report was tabled in the Lok Sabha on August 12.

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER, CONSTRUCTION CIRCLE, U.P. JAL NIGAM (URBAN) GWALIOR ROAD, JHANSI-284001 Email id - seurbanjhscircle@gmail.com

Letter No. 1254/F-03/179 Dated: 31.08.2026

E-Tender Notice

U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) invites online percentage plus/minus (+/-) rate e-tenders on Turn-key basis in two bid system for execution of "Replacing of Raw water Gravity Main of 1050 mm dia Under Jhansi-Babina water Supply Scheme (45MLD)" are hereby invited from eligible, reputed and experienced bidder. E-bid documents will be available for download from 07.09.2026 by 17:00 Hrs. Pre-bid meeting will be held on dated 10.09.2026 at 11:30 Hrs. in office of the Superintending Engineer, Construction Circle, UP Jal Nigam (Urban), Jhansi. E-bids can be submitted till 30.09.2026 up to 15:00 Hrs. and technical bid shall be opened on 30.09.2026 at 15:30 Hrs. in office of the Superintending Engineer, Construction Circle, UP Jal Nigam (Urban), Jhansi in presence of contractor or their authorized representative. E-tender Cost is Rs 10000+ GST @ 18% for Each tender. Details are available on U.P. Govt. e-procurement portal <http://etender.up.nic.in> & UP Jal Nigam (Urban) website <http://www.jn.upscd.gov.in>

कार्यालय परियोजना प्रबन्धक, युनिट-49 कन्स्ट्रक्शन एण्ड डिजाइन सर्किल उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम (नगरीय) (30 ७० सरकारी का उपकरण) ए-1, जल निगम कालोनी, बरेली - 243122, प्रधान कार्यालय: टी.सी.-38-02, विभूति खण्ड, गोमतीनगर, लखनऊ-226001 Visit us at: www.cdsupjn.org e-mail: pn49cdsbareilly@gmail.com Mob.9412665716

निविदा सूचना सं.: 1433/कार्य-15/266 दिनांक: 01.09.2026

ई-निविदा सूचना

उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम, की ओर से अयोध्याबागरी द्वारा जनपद बरेली के विकास खण्ड नवाबगंज में मल्टीपरपस सीड स्टोर एण्ड टेक्नालीजी डिस्ट्रिब्यूशन सेंटर (किसान कल्याण केंद्र) का निर्माण कार्य, अनुमानित लागत रु. 92.06 लाख (नौ.एस.टी. रहित एवं लेबर सेस सहित) हेतु सी. एण्ड डी.एस. में यथोचित श्रेणी में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से दिनांक 22.09.2026 को 17:00 बजे तक ई-निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती हैं। उक्त कार्य हेतु ई-निविदा प्रपत्र दिनांक 02.09.2026 से दिनांक 22.09.2026 को 17:00 बजे के मध्य उत्तर प्रदेश सरकार की e-procurement वेबसाइट <https://etender.up.nic.in> से डाउनलोड किया जा सकते हैं तथा ई-निविदा दिनांक 23.09.2026 को 15:00 बजे सी. एण्ड डी. एस. यूनिट-49, उ.प्र. जल निगम (नगरीय), बरेली में निविदा खोली जायेगी। ई-निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य ₹ 5,000.00 + GST (18%) अतिरिक्त देय होगा।

निविदा से सम्बन्धित विस्तृत विवरण निगम की वेबसाइट www.cdsupjn.org एवं प्रोक्चोरमेंट पोर्टल <https://etender.up.nic.in> पर उपलब्ध है। समस्त शुद्धि पत्र (Corrigendum) <https://etender.up.nic.in> पर ही अपलोड किये जायेंगे, इनका पृथक से कोई प्रकाशन नहीं किया जायेगा। निविदादाताओं को सलाह दी जाती है कि वे उक्त वेबसाइट का समय-समय पर अवलोकन करते रहें।

U.P. POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED

ELECTRICITY TRANSMISSION DESIGN CIRCLE
10th Floor, Shakti Bhawan Extension, Lucknow.

E-Tender Notice
Invites Open Tender
for
“DESIGN, DETAILED ENGINEERING, MANUFACTURE, SUPPLY OF 220 KV SINGLE CORE 2000 SQMM COPPER CONDUCTOR CORRUGATED ALUMINIUM SHEATHED XLPE INSULATED CABLE WITH ACCESSORIES, CABLE LAYING, ERECTION OF JOINTS & TERMINATIONS AND FINAL TESTING & COMMISSIONING FOR 220KV CABLE LINES ON TURN-KEY BASIS”

Tender Specification no- TD-556/26
Bid Portal (Download & Submission): <https://etender.up.nic.in>.
Bidding: Online, EMD: 15.68 Lacs
Estimated cost of work: 15.68 Cr., **Completion Period:** 09 Months
KEYDATES:
Online Bid Submission Start: 01/09/2026
Online Bid Submission Closing: 22/09/2026 at 17:00 Hrs.
Bidders are advised to visit E-Portal regularly for amendments/ Corrigendum's etc.

सं-0/-टीडी/556/26
दिनांक: 01-09-2026
Superintending Engineer,
Electricity Transmission Design Circle
Email: seetdc@upptcl.org | Tele: (0522) 2286759, 2218645

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER
PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT,
E/M CIRCLE, RAIPUR (C.G.)
e-Procurement Tender Notice

Online tenders are invited on behalf of Governor of Chhattisgarh from contractors, C.G. P.W in new Registration system (unified Registration system) for the following work :-

NIT No./ NIT Date	Name of Work	Probable amount of contract
71/SE E/M/2026-27 (I Call) System Tender No Registered contractor class in "C" & above For Form A (Percentage rate)	PROVIDING ELECTRIFICATION & ROAD LIGHTING WORK AT NANDINI ROAD TO AWANTIBAI CHOWK CANNAL ROAD 4.8 KM DISST.- DURG	Rs 152.99 Lacs
72/SE E/M/2026-27 (I Call) System Tender No Registered contractor class in "C" & above For Form A (Percentage rate)	Providing & Installation of Street Road Lighting, High mast & LED strip RGB lighting E/F Work Rajnandgaon-Gundardehi-Dhamtari Nagri-Sihawa-Borai (SH-23) from Sihawa Chowk to Naharnaka (Four Lane) Road (phase 2-Danitolra road junction TO Naharnaka), Distt. Dhamtari (C.G.)	Rs 175.43 Lacs
75/SE E/M/2026-27 (I Call) System Tender No Registered contractor class in "D" & above For Form A (Percentage rate)	SUPPLYING & FIXING OF L.E.D. STREET LIGHTING, AT NAYAKTAND TO KHARORA GAURAV PATH (LENGTH-2.5 K.M.) DISTT.- RAIPUR (C.G.)	Rs 38.62 Lacs

Date of bid submission 17-09-2026 The tender documents can be downloaded from the web-portal <http://eproc.cgstate.gov.in>. Only those contractors/bidders, interested in bidding shall pay the tender document cost online.

Sd/-
Superintending Engineer
P. W. D. (E & M) Circle
Raipur (C. G.)

No. 26270303/5

UP POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LTD.,
ELECTRICITY TRANSMISSION DESIGN CIRCLE
10th Floor, Shakti Bhawan Extn, Lucknow

E-Tender Notice
Invites Open Tender
for
“DESIGN, DETAILED ENGINEERING, MANUFACTURE, SUPPLY OF 220 KV SINGLE CORE 1200 SQMM COPPER CONDUCTOR CORRUGATED ALUMINIUM SHEATHED XLPE INSULATED CABLE WITH ACCESSORIES, CABLE LAYING, ERECTION OF JOINTS & TERMINATIONS AND FINAL TESTING & COMMISSIONING FOR 220KV DC SECTOR 148(400)-SECTOR-155 UNDERGROUND CABLE LINE ON TURN-KEY BASIS”

Tender Specification no- TD-558/26
Bid Portal (Download & Submission): <https://etender.up.nic.in>.
Bidding: Online, EMD: 8.12 Lacs
Estimated cost of work: 8.12 Cr.
Completion Period: 09 Months
KEYDATES:
Online Bid Submission Start: 01/09/2026
Online Bid Submission Closing: 22/09/2026 at 17:00 Hrs.
Bidders are advised to visit E-Portal regularly for amendments/ Corrigendum's etc.
Superintending Engineer, Electricity Transmission Design Circle
सं-1562/टीडी/558/26
दिनांक: 01.09.2026
E-Mail: seetdc@upptcl.org | Tele: (0522) 2286759, 2218645

AVM Shakti Sharma scripts history as highest-ranking woman IAF officer

1st woman officer (non-medical) in the armed forces to attain the rank of Air Vice Marshal

Amrita Nayak Dutta
New Delhi, September 1



AIR VICE-MARSHAL Shakti Sharma has made history as the first woman officer (non-medical) in the Indian defence forces to achieve the rank of Air Vice Marshal (or its equivalent). She is the first woman officer in the Indian Armed Forces to break this glass ceiling and reach such a milestone. In the Army and Navy, women officers so far have reached the rank of Colonel and equivalent. On Tuesday, AVM Sharma assumed charge as Assistant Chief of the Air Staff

Air Vice Marshal Shakti Sharma with Vice Chief of the Air Staff Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit in New Delhi on Tuesday. PTI
Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1
(Education) at Air Headquarters, the Ministry of Defence said in a statement, adding that this landmark achievement marks a new chapter in the journey of women officers in the defence forces. Commissioned into the Education Branch of the IAF on June 18, 1994, the senior officer has served across various training establishments, field stations,

demic and strategic defence collaboration. She is also the first woman officer from the Tri-Services to command a Sainik School, serving as Principal of Sainik School, Kapurthala. One of the key reasons why a woman officer could achieve this feat is attributed to the IAF officially granting Permanent Commission status to women officers in 2010. Since then, the IAF has streamlined opportunities for their promotion and career development, including their participation in career courses. The Army and Navy started granting Permanent Commission to women officers in select arms/services and branches in 2008. However, that was extended to other branches in 2020 after the top court's intervention. The fact that only one woman officer (non-medical) has attained the rank of AVM reflects the highly competitive nature of career advancement in the Armed Forces.

Former envoy to Bangladesh Pinak Ranjan Chakravarty is guest at Explained.Live



Express News Service
New Delhi, September 1



BILATERAL TIES between India and Bangladesh are going through a turbulent phase. Two years after the collapse of the Sheikh Hasina-led Bangladesh government, her presence and statements from Indian soil have once again created tension between the two countries. The incumbent government in Bangladesh led by Tarique Rahman's bilateral visit has been in the works, but that has been marred by the current tension. This has led to a host of questions on everyone's mind. How much does Sheikh Hasina's shadow impact ties? How does PM Tarique Rahman look at the current situation? How can India and Bangladesh reset and repair ties? Should India be worried about the security situation in Bangladesh? Can Delhi and Dhaka work on economic and development projects? How do China and Pakistan view and influence the current situation in Bangladesh? To answer these questions and explain the situation, former Indian High Commissioner to Bangladesh Pinak Ranjan Chakravarty will be the guest at the Express Explained.Live session on "Can India and Bangladesh find common ground again" at 6 pm on Wednesday. He will be in conversation with Shubhajit Roy, Diplomatic Editor at *The Indian Express*. A former member of the Indian Foreign Service (1977 batch), Chakravarty honed his expertise on Bangladesh over two stints — as Deputy High Commissioner (1999-2002) and

Former Indian High Commissioner to Bangladesh Pinak Ranjan Chakravarty

TOPIC: Can India & Bangladesh find common ground again
DATE: September 2
TIME: 6:00 PM

later as High Commissioner (2007-2009).

In February 2024, he published a book on the India-Bangladesh relations, titled "*Transformation: Emergence of Bangladesh and Evolution of India-Bangladesh ties*". Express Explained.Live is a unique series of explanatory conversations that The Indian Express hosts from time to time. Previous guests include former Indian ambassador to China Gautam Bambawale, former Foreign Secretary Shyam Saran, former Indian ambassador to US Arun K Singh, former Indian ambassador to Egypt and Australia Navdeep Suri, former Indian ambassador to Russia D B Venkatesh Varma, former Foreign Secretary and Indian ambassador to China Vijay Gokhale, former Deputy NSA Pankaj Saran, former Indian ambassador to Nepal Ranjit Rae, former Indian High Commissioner to Pakistan T C A Raghavan, former G20 Sous Sherpa J S Mukul, former Indian ambassador to the US Taranjit Singh Sandhu, former Indian ambassador to US, UK and Israel Navtej Sarma among others.

Over 90% crimes in Goa committed by migrants: Sawant

Pavneet Singh Chadha
Panaji, September 1

IN A repeat of his controversial remarks from 2023, Goa Chief Minister Pramod Sawant on Tuesday said that more than 90% of crimes in the state are committed by migrants. During Zero Hour in the Legislative Assembly, Sawant said, "If we are to do crime-prevention plans... we need to create awareness. First and among the foremost things that the police department has done is verification of labourers and tenants. Nobody should rent their homes to unknown persons without having their antecedents verified by police." During the discussion on the law-and-order situation in the state, Sawant stressed that verification of tenants and labourers is an important component of the government's strategy to prevent crime and strengthen security in the state.

6 pilgrims killed as pick-up vehicle rams stationary truck in Haryana

Press Trust of India
Faridabad, September 1

SIX PILGRIMS were killed and 14 others injured after a pick-up vehicle rammed into a stationary

truck on the Kundli-Manesar-Palwal Expressway in Haryana's Palwal on Tuesday, police said. The accident occurred at around 4.30 am when the occupants of the pick-up vehicle

were returning from Rajasthan after visiting Khatu Shyam temple and other shrines in the state, and were headed to Vrindavan in Uttar Pradesh. A preliminary probe sug-

gests that the driver fell asleep, causing the incident, police said. The driver fled the spot and efforts are on to trace him. A police officer said among the six deceased, three were women.

EMPLOYMENT NOTICE
EX-SERVICEMEN CONTRIBUTORY HEALTH SCHEME
STATION HQ, AMBALA CANTT

1. Ref Advertisement dated 28 Jul 2026.
2. Additional application forms for the following posts are also invited for employment of contractual staff for ECHS Polyclinics \$^4\$

Ser No.	Appointment	Minimum Qualification Fixed	No of Vacancy		Age in Years		Fixed Remuneration
			ESM Only	Open for ESM & Civilian	For Employment	For Contractual Service	
2.1	Medical Officer	MBBS & Min 03 Yrs Experience after Internship Preferable Additional Qualification in Medicine/Surgery	-	02 (Ambala-01 & Kaithal-01)	63	65	Rs. 95,000/-pm
2.2	Nursing Asst.	GNM Diploma/Class-I Nursing Assistants Course (Armed Forces) & Min 05 Yrs Experience	-	02 (Kurukshetra)	56	58	Rs.36,500/-pm
2.3	Female Attendant	Literate & Min 05 Yrs Experience in Civil/ Army Health Institutions	-	01 (Sonapat)	53	55	Rs. 21,800/- pm

3. The following amendment is hereby made in the advertisement/nepapers of 28 Jul 2026:-
For - One Vacancy each for the post of Medical Officer for ECHS Polyclinic, Ambala & Kaithal published against ESM vac.
Read - Application forms for Medical Officer for ECHS Polyclinic, Ambala & Kaithal is required against Open Vac.
4. Last date of submission of application is **16 Sep 2026**.

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(A Govt. of Uttarakhand Undertaking) Corporate Identity No. U40109UR2001SG00258672358
Victoria Cross Vijeyta Gabar Singh Urja Bhawan, Kanwali Road, Dehradun -248001 Telephone-(0135)2763672-76, Fax-(0135)2760289, Website: www.uktenders.gov.in

E-TENDER NOTICE
Uttarakhand Power Corporation Ltd., invites e-tender for Implementation of Standalone Battery Energy Storage System (BESS) at various Locations / Substations of UPCL under Tariff Based Competitive Bidding (TBCB) mechanism, as detailed below-

Sl. No.	Name of Package	Name of Circle	Estimated cost	Earnest Money	Processing Fee	Cost of tender document including GST (in ₹)	Date & time of Prebid conference in online mode	Last Date & time of online request for Tender and Submission of tender in online & Offline mode	Date of opening of bid Part-I in online and offline mode
1	Tender Specification No.CCP-I/27/2026-2027								
	Cluster-A	Rudrapur, Kashipur, Haldwani, Pithoragarh	180.50 Cr.	3.61 Cr.	8.45 Lacs	29,500.00	5.9.2026 at 11:30 hrs at Victoria Cross Vijeyta Gabar Singh Urja Bhawan, Kanwali Road, Dehradun	15.9.2026 upto 17.00 hrs	16.9.2026 at 11.30 hrs
	Cluster-B	Dehradun (Urban) Dehradun (Rural)	115.50 Cr.	2.31 Cr.	5.40 Lacs	29,500.00		15.9.2026 upto 17.00 hrs	16.9.2026 at 11.45 hrs
	Cluster-C	Tehri, Haridwar & Roorkee	206.30 Cr.	4.13 Cr.	9.63 Lacs	29,500.00		15.9.2026 upto 17.00 hrs	16.9.2026 at 12.00 hrs

For further details, please visit the website www.uktenders.gov.in
No. : 678/EE(CM)/UPCL /A-2
Date : 31.08.2026

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CORPORATE (C&P-I)

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₹4.75 lakh budget allocation per category
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No post, courier or offline applications. Late, incomplete or incorrectly formatted submissions may be rejected.

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ONLINE APPLICATION PORTAL / QR

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Information, Public Relations and Languages Department, Haryana
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Advertisement No. 91/2026
Government of India
Public Enterprises Selection Board invites applications for the post of
Director (Finance)
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Bridge and Roof Company (India) Limited
Last date of submission of online application by applicants is by 15:00 hours on
22nd September, 2026
Last date of forwarding of applications by the Nodal Officers on online system of PESB is by 17:00 hours on
01st October, 2026.
For details login to website <https://pesb.gov.in>
Link for registration of nodal officers/competent authorities is available on PESB website.

URBAN ENVIRO WASTE MANAGEMENT LIMITED
CIN: L39006MR2011PLC218213
Regd. Office: 26, Matey Square, Near BPCL Petrol Pump, Gopal Nagar Road, Nagpur 440022
Website: <https://urbanenviroindia.com/>, Email: info@urbanenviro.in, Tele Fax: 0712-2996029

NOTICE OF 15th ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING AND E-VOTING INFORMATION
NOTICE is hereby given that in compliance with the applicable circulars issued by Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA) and the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) the 15th Annual General Meeting of Urban Enviro Waste Management Limited is scheduled to be held on Friday, 25th September, 2026 at 11.30 a.m. at the registered office of the company situated at 26, Matey Square, Near BPCL Petrol Pump, Gopal Nagar Road, Nagpur- 440022, Maharashtra, India (through Physical mode) to transact the businesses mentioned in the notice sent to the shareholders.
In compliance with the MCA Circulars and SEBI Circulars, Notice of the 15th AGM along with the Annual Report 2025-26 has been sent only through electronic mode (by e-mail) on Tuesday, 01st September, 2026 to those Members whose email addresses are registered with the Company/ Depositories. Members may note that the AGM Notice and Annual Report 2025-26 is available on the Company's website <https://urbanenviroindia.com/>. The Notice can also be accessed from the websites of the Stock Exchange i.e. National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.nseindia.com and website of NSDL (agency for providing the remote e-Voting facility) i.e. www.evoting.nsdl.com.
In terms of Section 108 and other applicable provisions of the Act, read with Rule 20 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014, as amended, and Regulation 44 of the SEBI (LODR), the Company is providing to all its members, the facility to exercise their vote by electronic means (e-voting) on the business set forth in the Notice of the AGM.
The Board has appointed Mr. Kunal Dutt, Practising Company Secretary (COP No.10188 FCS No.8831), as the scrutineriser to scrutinise the e-voting process in the fair and transparent manner.
All Members are hereby informed that:
1. The E-voting on the resolutions to be passed at the said meeting shall begin on Monday, 21st September, 2026 at 9.00 a.m. (IST) and end on Thursday, 24th September, 2026 at 5.00 p.m. (IST). During this period, a person whose name is recorded in the register of members or in the register of beneficial owners maintained by the depositories as on the cut-off date (i.e. Friday, 18th September, 2026) only shall be entitled to avail the facility of remote e-voting as well as voting at the AGM through ballot /polling paper. The remote e- voting module will be disabled thereafter by NSDL. Once the vote on resolution is cast by a member, no change will be allowed subsequently. The detailed procedure/instruction for the process of remote e-voting has been specified in the notice.
2. A member may participate in the general meeting even after exercising his voting right through remote e- voting, but shall not be allowed to vote again at the meeting.
3. The facility for voting through ballot/polling paper shall be made available at the AGM. The members attending the meeting who have not cast their vote by remote e-voting shall be able to exercise their right at the meeting through ballot /polling paper.
4. The manner of e-voting by members holding shares in dematerialized mode, physical mode and for members who have not registered their email addresses is provided in the Notice of the AGM.
5. Any person, who acquires shares of the Company and become member of the Company after dispatch of the notice and holding shares as of the cut-off date (i.e., Friday, 18th September, 2026), may obtain the login ID and password by sending a request at evoting@nsdl.co.in or Company/ RTA. A person who is not a member as on the cut-off date should treat this Notice of AGM for information purpose only.
6. In case of any queries, you may refer the Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) and e-voting user manual for Shareholders available at the download section of www.evoting.nsdl.com or call on 022- 48867000 or send a request to Pallavi Mhatre at evoting@nsdl.co.in.
In case shares are held in demat form-Register/update the details in your demat account as per process advised by your Depository Participant. Members are requested to carefully read the detailed instructions set out in the Notice of AGM, indicating the manner of casting vote through remote e-voting before the AGM.

Place: Nagpur
Date: 01.09.2026

URBAN ENVIRO WASTE MANAGEMENT LIMITED
Sd/-
Shreetha Kulkarni
(Company Secretary)

GOVT. OF NATIONAL CAPITAL TERRITORY OF DELHI
DIRECTORATE OF HIGHER EDUCATION
MUNI MAYA RAM MARG, PITAM PURA, DELHI-110034
E-mail id: dtehedu@gmail.com

ADVERTISEMENT
Applications are hereby invited from eminent scholars for the post of Vice-Chancellor at Delhi Sports University, Camp Office, Ludlow Castle Sports Complex, 4 Shannath Marg, Delhi-110054, which was established under the Delhi Act (Delhi Act 01 of 2020).
Essential Qualification and Experience:-

- Persons of the highest level of competence, integrity, morals and institutional commitment are to be appointed as Vice-Chancellors.
- The Vice-Chancellor to be appointed should be a distinguished sports scholar.

OR

a sportsperson of international eminence or a sports-coach of international eminence.

OR

a professor in reputed sports Institutions/Academy with ten years of experience.

- The Vice-Chancellor shall hold office for a term of five years from the date of joining his/her office and shall be eligible for reappointment only for one more term:

For other information regarding Vice-Chancellor (DSU) may please refer to First Statute of Delhi Sports University dated: 28/01/2022.

The format of application and other details are available on the DHE website i.e. <https://higherdn.delhi.gov.in/>

Last date of receipt of Application is 16.10.2026. The application in the prescribed should reach by Registered/Speed cover closed proforma in a Post to:

The Principal Secretary,
Directorate of Higher Education (DHE)
Government of NCT of Delhi.
Muni Maya Ram Marg, Pitampura Delhi-110034.
Application through email will also be accepted at E-mail pstechedu@nic.in

Sd/-
Administrative Officer (Higher Education)
Govt. of NCT of Delhi

DIP/Shabdarth/Classified/0197/26-27

Take Bishkek to BRICS

PRIME MINISTER Narendra Modi's address at the 26th summit of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation in Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan, comes at a time when Central Asia is diversifying its partnerships in all directions. A region long shaped by its Soviet past and one that still maintains economic links with Russia, its five countries are now also looking to China for trade, investment and infrastructure, and to Iran and the Gulf for access to the south, though the ongoing conflict complicates the latter. The region's growing strategic importance and shared security concerns, including terrorism, have led India and all Central Asian countries except Turkmenistan, which maintains permanent neutrality, to establish strategic partnerships. This evolving context makes the PM's visit even more significant. The PM's speech focused mainly on two issues: Connectivity and terrorism. The absence of direct land access has constrained trade and wider economic and cultural engagement. There is no overland access through Pakistan, and Afghanistan's airspace remains beset by security risks. But connectivity goes far beyond building roads and railways. At its core, it is about shaping the economic and strategic geography of Eurasia. India, therefore, must find ways to expand economic engagement while overcoming the limitations imposed by geography. A starting point could be to focus on products and services that do not depend on roads — services, digital systems and technological investments. On terrorism, the Prime Minister is right to call on the international community to collectively dismantle the ecosystem of terror, including its financing and recruitment networks. The reality New Delhi must recognise, however, is that the international political will against terrorism has weakened. Over the past year, Pakistan has largely overcome its diplomatic isolation, and it is set to assume the organisation's rotational chairmanship. In June last year, SCO defence ministers could not agree on the references to terrorism in their joint statement. China possesses greater financial resources than any other member and is heavily investing in Central Asian infrastructure as part of the Belt and Road Initiative. Delhi should therefore place greater weight on its individual partnerships with member states. The agreement with Uzbekistan on the long-term supply of uranium is a step in that direction. Central Asian countries are emerging as multi-vector actors. Rather than choosing between competing powers, they are seeking multiple options to improve access to market. India should become one of those options — and use a multilateral forum like the SCO to advance bilateral relationships. That is a strategy New Delhi should carry forward to BRICS, as it prepares to host its 18th summit. Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mjMzg1

Red label for salt, sugar and fat is a good start

AMID RAPIDLY expanding concerns about Indians' growing consumption of food high in sugar, refined carbohydrates, salt and unhealthy fats comes the FSSAI proposal to implement front-of-pack warnings in the form of red, hexagonal labels on package food. Sweetened beverages will carry a separate warning. The proposal comes weeks after the Supreme Court pulled up the apex food regulator for failing to move on warning labels. It is a welcome step towards addressing alarming levels of obesity, particularly among children — India now ranks second globally, after China, for the number of children who are overweight or living with obesity. Given that eating behaviour is complex and influenced by a number of factors, including gender, economic wherewithal, awareness and faith-based restrictions, there has been scepticism about the effectiveness of food warnings. But there is also evidence that such interventions can change consumption patterns. For example, Chile witnessed a 24 per cent drop in sugary drink consumption after it introduced black octagonal warning labels on packages in 2016. Clarity and legibility are key; a previous FSSAI proposal to use a health star rating system was criticised as such stars are usually perceived as positive and warning labels bearing them have been associated with increased consumption of unhealthy foods. The notification and timeline for implementation are still awaited. Experts have warned that the two-or-more-unhealthy ingredients threshold in the first of the intended two-phase implementation could leave out products that are high in just one unhealthy ingredient. There are concerns that the proposed font size may be too small to be effective. Warning labels, finally, can only be one part of a larger approach. Addressing the obesity epidemic — which exists alongside malnutrition — will require a broader public-health response that includes raising nutritional awareness, stronger regulation of junk food and nudges towards healthier lifestyles. A red label on a packet may not, by itself, make people eat better, but it is a useful place to start if it makes it easier to tell healthy choices from harmful ones.

Football, before and after Messi

INTERNATIONAL FOOTBALL has lost its grandest experience, which was watching Lionel Messi. Time, grief and wear and tear took their inescapable toll on the Argentine, who announced his retirement on Monday through a post on Instagram. There is a sense of loss and mourning, because no one player has had such a vast impact on a major sport's footprint as Messi. He scored goals, hatched assists, won trophies and honours, conquered glory and immortality. But most poignantly, he embodied the beauty in the beautiful game. In 21 years at the pinnacle of the sport, he saw the game transform from the preserve of artistes to that shaped by athletes, the game getting brutally physical, the movements predetermined in the board-room. But Messi remained as he was when he first burst through — a shapeshifting genius immune to the changes around him. Roles, positions, and hairdos changed, but the magnificence of Messi's game remained untarnished. He came closest to the sport's ideal as anyone ever has. His genius was simple and uncomplicated, football with a frictionless lightness, a complicated game made to look ridiculously simple, a task of merely finding angles and spaces, precision and perfection, of brush-stroking the ball with a swish of his left foot to the back of the net. Whether he is the greatest of all time is a meaningless debate. Only Messi could measure Messi or gauge the true depth of his gifts. The two men who could have arguably judged his greatness are dead, Pele and Diego Maradona. The scale of measurable achievements would not capture the scale of immeasurable experience that was watching Messi. International football, after Messi's departure, will be a less pleasurable feast.

INDIA'S GDP growth of 7.8 per cent in the first quarter once again exceeded expectations, continuing a pattern seen over the past several quarters. Growth surpassed both the median forecast of 6.8 per cent by professional forecasters and the RBI's revised projection of 7 per cent. The outperformance underscores the strength of India's domestic drivers and its ability to navigate an increasingly uncertain global environment. Even amid continuing conflict in West Asia and weather-related uncertainties, high-frequency indicators had signalled strong momentum. Robust industrial activity, healthy consumption and strong goods exports, alongside accelerating government investment, were the key drivers of growth in the first quarter of this fiscal. The residual impact of policy measures introduced last fiscal year, coupled with continued support through direct benefit transfers, also bolstered growth. Such programmes have expanded steadily, with 17 states now providing cash transfers, primarily to women. The impact of GST rate cuts was particularly visible in automobiles. Dealer discounts and higher disposable incomes resulting from income-tax relief provided additional support. According to data from the SIAM, sales of passenger vehicles, commercial vehicles and two-wheelers rose 26 per cent, 20.3 per cent and 18.3 per cent respectively in the first quarter. Retail credit growth remained robust with other personal loans, a proxy for short-term consumption, growing at 14.2 per cent. Also, households were cushioned against the sharp rise in crude prices with government Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F>

A master plan for Delhi with ecology & heritage at its centre



TARANJIT SINGH SANDHU

GREAT CITIES are defined not only by the infrastructure they build, but by what they preserve, restore, and pass on to future generations. Delhi is uniquely endowed in both respects. The Yamuna and its floodplains, the Ridge, urban forests, biodiversity parks and neighbourhood greens form the city's ecological foundation. As India advances towards the Prime Minister's vision of Viksit Bharat 2047, Delhi must demonstrate how a growing metropolis can combine development with environmental restoration and heritage conservation. The Master Plan for Delhi 2047 (MPD-2047) provides an opportunity to place these principles at the heart of the Capital's future. Climate change has fundamentally rewritten the rules of urban planning. Rising temperatures, extreme rainfall, acute water stress, deteriorating air quality and biodiversity loss directly affect the quality of life. MPD-2047 envisages an interconnected Green-Blue network that integrates the Yamuna, the Ridge, forests, biodiversity parks, water bodies, drains, neighbourhood parks, and open spaces into a unified ecological system. For centuries, the Yamuna has shaped Delhi's geography, history, and civilisation. Now, rapid urbanisation has placed unprecedented stress on its ecosystem and floodplains. MPD-2047 places the river at the centre of Delhi's ecological regeneration. Nearly 1,700 hectares of the Yamuna floodplains are proposed to be protected, conserved and ecologically restored. To tackle pollution at its source, the strategy focuses on intercepting and treating drains flowing into the river through upgraded sewage treatment infrastructure, constructed wetlands, and bioremediation. Together, these measures will restore the river's ecological health and natural floodplain functions. The larger objective, however, goes beyond environmental restoration. Delhi must also rebuild its relationship with the river. A proposed 52-kilometre cycling corridor, alongside walking trails, public greens, and managed recreational spaces, will reconnect citizens with the waterfront. Complementing the Yamuna is Delhi's other major ecological pillar — the Delhi Ridge, an extension of the ancient Aravalli range. MPD-2047 plans the ecological restoration of approximately 7,784 hectares of the Ridge, prioritising native species and scientific ecosystem management.

MPD-2047 envisages an interconnected Green-Blue network that integrates the Yamuna, the Ridge, forests, biodiversity parks, water bodies, drains, neighbourhood parks, and open spaces into a unified ecological system

and oil companies absorbing most of it, particularly in the initial phase of conflict. That said, as 2026-27 progresses, the growth-inflation mix is likely to become less favourable, with growth moderating and inflation rising. Crisil expects GDP growth of 7 per cent and inflation of 5.1 per cent. The moderation in growth reflects a more challenging external environment, marked by disruptions from the conflict in West Asia, unresolved tariff issues with the US, weather-related risks and a strong base effect in the second half. The two exogenous factors that worked in India's favour last year, low crude oil prices and a normal monsoon, are unlikely to provide similar support this year. Meanwhile, the conflict in West Asia has disrupted supply chains, increased insurance, freight and input costs, and is likely to weigh on both global and domestic growth. Weather-related risks warrant close monitoring as El Niño conditions in the equatorial Pacific intensify. Over the past 25 years, five of the six El Niño years have resulted in below-normal rainfall. This year, cumulative rainfall was 14 per cent below the long-period average (LPA) at the end of August. While rainfall in July was 1 per cent above the LPA, August recorded a deficit of 16 per cent. The IMD has signalled below-normal rainfall in September. There are, however, some mitigating factors. India's net irrigated area has risen by 10 percentage points to 59 per cent over the past decade, improving resilience to rainfall shocks. The country also holds ample rice and



DHARMAKIRTI JOSHI

As 2026-27 progresses, the growth-inflation mix is likely to become less favourable, with growth moderating and inflation rising. Crisil expects GDP growth of 7 per cent and inflation of 5.1 per cent

wheat stocks, which should help contain food price pressures. Agriculture itself is becoming more resilient as non-crop activities gain a larger share. While crop gross value added contracted by an average 0.5 per cent annually in the five years to 2023-24, non-crop agriculture, which now accounts for nearly 40 per cent of agricultural gross value added, expanded 6.5 per cent annually. Nor is the relationship between monsoons and inflation straightforward. Historical evidence suggests deficient monsoons do not always lead to higher food inflation. Foodgrain stocks, currently more than twice buffer norms, provide an additional cushion against price spikes. Even so, these improvements do not fully insulate agriculture or the broader economy. Several crops without buffer stocks, as well as perishable vegetables, remain vulnerable to adverse weather. Weak monsoons can also hurt rabi production by reducing soil moisture and lowering reservoir levels. Agricultural output and food inflation therefore remain key variables to watch. Although headline inflation eased in July and core inflation remained benign, upside risks persist. Our base case assumes Brent crude prices averaging \$82-87 per barrel this fiscal. The unresolved conflict in West Asia continues to keep oil prices volatile. Higher crude prices typically translate into slower growth, higher inflation and a wider current account deficit. Core inflation, often viewed as a gauge of underlying demand pressures, also appears decep-

tively low. Strong demand conditions, rising fuel costs and other input pressures, reflected in near-double-digit wholesale price inflation, are gradually being passed through to consumers. The automobile sector illustrates this well. Vehicle prices are likely to rise as manufacturers pass on higher costs to protect margins, while dealer discounts are gradually withdrawn. Combined with a high base effect, this should moderate automobile growth in the second half. Unlike last year, the balance of risks now points towards possible interest rate hikes. Persistent inflationary pressures, coupled with an unresolved conflict in West Asia and weather-related risks, could bring monetary tightening back into consideration. Despite the expected moderation in growth, India's macroeconomic buffers remain strong. Foreign exchange reserves cover more than nine months of imports, while corporate and banking-sector balance sheets are in robust health. The economy remains resilient, but the road ahead is likely to be less forgiving than last year. The challenge will be to sustain high growth in an increasingly uncertain global environment. For now, tax relief and public investment continue to support activity. The Pay Commission's recommendations should provide an additional boost to consumption when implemented. Beyond cyclical tailwinds, sustained progress on structural reforms that enhance competitiveness will be critical to maintaining the growth momentum. Joshi is chief economist, Crisil Ltd

Solution for stubble burning lies close to the farm



SHWETA SAINI



GOPAL SOOD

Wheat does not travel 100 km merely because flour requires machinery. The village chakki places processing close to where the commodity is produced and consumed. Paddy residue may need a similar rethink

IN A few weeks, Delhi will again begin watching Punjab's farm fires. Governments will announce measures and farmers will again be asked not to burn paddy straw. But the economics facing farmers has changed little over the years: Bulky residue, a narrow window before wheat sowing, and a cost attached to almost every alternative to burning. What has changed, however, is the value of parali itself. When we began working on crop residues, farmers in several locations were still paying to have straw removed. Today, in parts of Punjab, the same straw can fetch around Rs 1.5-2 per kg. Demand from power plants, CBG units and pellet manufacturers is slowly creating a market for what was until recently treated as waste. This raises another question: If parali now has value, where should that value be created, and how much can remain with the farmer? Biochar offers one possibility. It is a carbon-rich material produced by heating biomass under limited oxygen, and can be made from crop residues such as paddy, maize, cotton and mustard stalks. Roughly 100 kg of dry parali can yield around 30 kg of char. Applied to soil, it can improve water retention and nutrient-use efficiency, while locking carbon away for a century. This differs from using biomass only as fuel. Burning recovers energy but returns much of its carbon to the atmosphere. Biochar applied to soil can retain a significant share while also serving an agronomic purpose. For Punjab, this matters. Its rice-wheat system is under stress from declining soil quality, intensive fertiliser use, and groundwater depletion. Residue generated by the same system could improve its soils. The problem is where processing happens. Parali has to be collected, baled, stored and transported within the narrow window before wheat sowing. Long-distance transport of a bulky, relatively low-value material quickly eats into its economics. The farmer supplies raw material, while much value-addition happens after biomass leaves the village. With biochar, the irony is greater. A farmer may supply the straw, see it processed elsewhere and later buy back a product made from biomass originating on farms like his. Why not, then, move the technology closer to the straw? India already understands decentralised rural processing. Wheat does not travel 100 km merely because flour requires machinery. The village chakki places processing close to where the commodity is produced and consumed. Paddy residue may need a similar rethink. We have been developing a village-scale biochar system around a build-operate-transfer model. A technology provider initially installs and operates the unit, trains local operators and ensures quality and emission standards. Over time, the asset and capability can transfer to an FPO, SHG, or cooperative. The government does not need to run thousands of such units. It can provide standards, training, concessional finance and initial support. Panchayats can help with land and coordination. Farmers could bring straw to a nearby processing point much as they bring wheat to a flour mill. Some biochar could return to their fields; the rest could be sold where markets exist. This changes the economics. Raw straw travels less, value addition happens closer to the farmer, and villages are not left with subsidised machinery nobody knows how to operate. It also changes the incentive to burn. Burning remains quick and cheap where alternatives involve cost, labour and uncertainty. Enforcement and machinery subsidies can help, but behaviour is likely to change when residue itself becomes valuable. As biomass markets develop, the question should be: Where should value from parali be created, and who should capture it? The answer may lie closer to the farm. Saini is CEO, Arcus Policy Research. Sood is chairperson, Arcus Serves Foundation

40 YEARS AGO
September 2, 1986

NAM proposes sanctions

THE EIGHTH non-aligned summit began in Harare with a fervent appeal by top leaders for efforts to end the apartheid policies in South Africa. Similar action was suggested towards achieving a just international economic order and nuclear disarmament.



Bid to blow up bus in Delhi

TWO SUSPECTED terrorists tried to blow up a DTC bus in the Capital, leaving an explosive device in a briefcase on the bus near Kauria Bridge. Passengers noticed the briefcase just as the bus was about to start. Police and experts of the bomb squad rushed to the spot. The experts defused the device.

77 die in US plane collision

AN AEROMEXICO DC-9 airliner and a private

plane collided and crashed in balls of fire into houses in Los Angeles, killing at least 77 people. Teams of disaster workers spread out over a blackened square mile of houses and tree-lined streets, strewn with shoes, clothing and toys scattered by the airliner.

Judge among three shot

R P Gaiid, additional district and sessions judge, Jalandhar, and two others were gunned down by terrorists in the past 24 hours in Punjab.



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China, US are in race to connect science with industry. India must catch up



RAJA MANDALA
BY C RAJA MOHAN

BEHIND THE riot of robots running, dancing and playing at Beijing's second World Humanoid Games last week is an ambitious Chinese project to turn China into the world's leading science power. This ambition is rooted in President Xi Jinping's call to fully mobilise "new quality productive forces" being unleashed by the current revolutions in science and technology. Xi is convinced that China's next phase of growth cannot rely on cheap labour, large-scale manufacturing, infrastructure and capital accumulation. It must come from innovation.

AI is central to Xi's strategy. Beijing's objective is to diffuse AI across the physical economy — robotics, machine tools, automobiles, biotechnology, materials, energy, agriculture and scientific research. China's manufacturing depth is its advantage. Beijing is betting that fusing digital intelligence with the world's largest industrial ecosystem will make China the leading technological power.

For decades, China absorbed foreign technology, improved it through manufacturing and dominated production. It now wants to move upstream — from adaptation to original discovery. China spent 2.8 per cent of GDP on R&D in 2025; basic-research expenditure rose by 11 per cent. The manufacturing power now seeks to become a science superpower.

The logic is simple: AI accelerates discovery; discovery produces technology; technology transforms industry; industrial strength generates national power and gives China a geopolitical edge.

Washington is reaching a similar conclusion, coming from the opposite direction. The Trump administration's Science: A New Golden Age, released in July, has been billed as the first major reset in US science policy since World War II. It begins by recognising Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F>

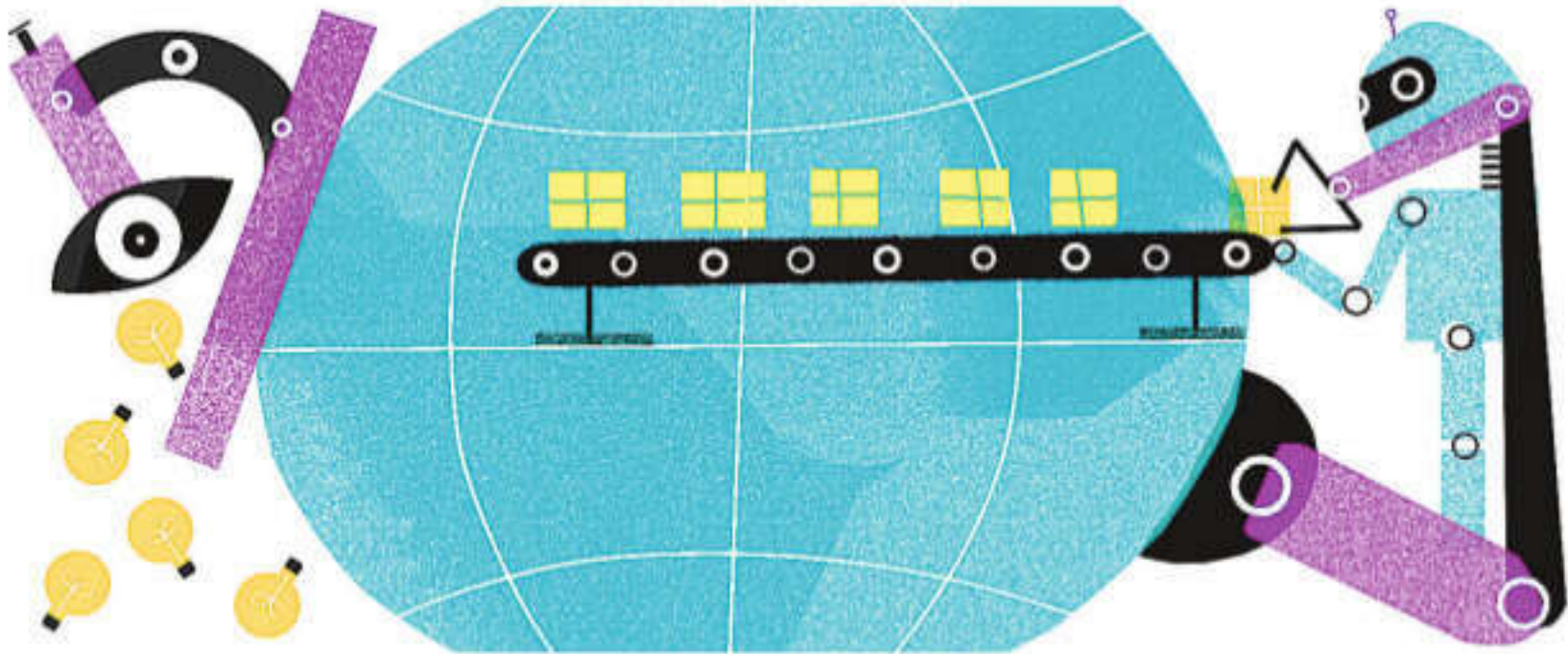


ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

American strengths — its great universities, laboratories, technology companies and capital markets. It also acknowledges the American weakness — the erosion of the capacity to turn discoveries into production.

Globalisation separated American innovation from manufacturing. Companies designed at home, produced abroad and depended on long supply chains. That model generated wealth but also vulnerabilities exposed by the pandemic, China's rise and geopolitical rivalry. Washington now wants to reintegrate the production of knowledge and manufacturing.

Washington and Beijing see AI not merely as a general-purpose technology, but as an accelerator central to the production of new knowledge that in turn will transform industry. By making discovery continuous with design and manufacturing, AI-driven science will transform production itself — and turn scientific speed into economic power and geopolitical capability.

China begins with the largest manufacturing base and moves upstream into science. America begins with the strongest scientific system and moves downstream into manufacturing. China fears dependence on American technology; the US fears dependence on Chinese production. Both seek to close the gap between knowledge and production.

This contest is not about who unveils the cleverest AI model or the most sophisticated humanoid. It is about building the most effective ecosystem connecting universities, laboratories, entrepreneurs, finance, energy, factories, supply chains and markets

This contest is not about who unveils the cleverest AI model. It is about building the most effective ecosystem connecting universities, laboratories, entrepreneurs, finance, energy, factories, supply chains and markets

sities, laboratories, entrepreneurs, finance, energy, factories, supply chains and markets.

Where does this leave India? Delhi recognises the trend and has launched several new missions — on AI, semiconductor production and quantum technologies. It also has a draft robotics policy. But two weaknesses stand out.

First, ambition and imagination are concentrated in government declarations at a time when the private sector contributes more than ever to producing knowledge in the US and China. Indian capital rarely articulates a project for mastering the new forces of production or a new project for science and basic research. This was not always so. Jamsetji Tata helped create the Indian Institute of Science in 1909; the Kirloskars and other western Indian business families sent their children to the Massachusetts Institute of Technology from the 1920s. They recognised that independent India's future lay in mastering modern science. The Sir Dorabji Tata Trust supported Homi Bhabha in establishing the Tata Institute of Fundamental Research, which formed the nucleus of India's atomic energy and space programmes. Indian capital has sadly retreated from that tradition.

The Economic Survey 2025-26 puts India's R&D expenditure at 0.64 per cent of GDP. In comparison, China spends about 2.8 per cent and the US 3.5. The World Intellectual Property Organisation estimates India's total R&D spend

Kriti Sanon in an ad, me on the poll trail, who will tell us what to wear?



MEHBOOBA MUFTI

WHO DECIDES what a woman should wear? It is a question that India seems to answer differently depending on whether a woman chooses to reveal more or cover more. I remember fighting my first election in 1996. I would travel through rural areas campaigning in a kurta churidar, with a dupatta loosely draped around my neck. The situation was volatile, and many people were reluctant to come out because of the fear of militants. Those who did come were mostly men, especially young boys, for whom seeing a woman campaigning for an election was unusual and highly amusing.

For me, the experience was not always comfortable. My dupatta would slip from my shoulders, and sometimes the wind would lift my shirt. Instead of concentrating on what I wanted to say, I found myself worrying about my clothes. The next day, I opened my cupboard and found an abaya that I had brought back from Medina during Hajj. I put it on, took a scarf to cover my head and went campaigning.

Imagine if, instead of making that personal choice, I had been forced to go to court to seek permission to wear my abaya and hijab. I am not advocating hijab for every woman. Quite the contrary, I believe that every woman has her own understanding of comfort and freedom. For one woman, covering her head may provide confidence and freedom, while for another, revealing her shoulders may do the same. That is my point.

Today, two women have found themselves at the centre of two different controversies. One is being told that her clothes are inappropriate for Indian culture. The other was told by a high court that she could not insist on adding a religious headscarf to her school uniform. But the two cases raise the same fundamental question. Who gets to decide what a woman should wear?

The first is actor Kriti Sanon, whose appearance in a jewellery advertisement for Raksha Bandhan triggered a social-media storm. The controversy intensified after actor and BJP MP Kangana Ranaut criticised the advertisement. Sanon responded by arguing that the essence of a festival lies in its emotions and traditions, not in the clothes a woman wears. She did not stand alone. Among others, Rahul Gandhi came to her defence. Eventually, the jewellery company withdrew the ad.

Then there is Sukaina Rizvi, a student who had completed Class X at Tagore Public School in Attarsuliya, Prayagraj. She approached the Allahabad High Court seeking permission to continue wearing a hijab with her school uniform. The court dismissed her plea, holding, among other things, that she had not placed sufficient material to establish that wearing the headscarf constituted an essential practice of Islam. Unlike Sanon, Rizvi did not have celebrities or politicians rushing to defend her choice. Courts are supposed to be the last resort when citizens believe their rights have been infringed. When even this last door closes, one is left asking where a young woman should go. Rizvi is around my daughter's age, and perhaps that is why I found myself relating to her dilemma.

The larger issue, however, goes beyond the two women. It begins when a woman's clothing becomes a measure of her morality, character, religion or loyalty to a particular culture. Sanon's neckline does not tell us whether she respects Indian culture. Rizvi's hijab does not tell us whether she respects her school, her country or anyone else.

We celebrate women entering Parliament, occupying boardrooms and becoming pilots, soldiers, scientists, doctors and judges. We speak about equal opportunities, representation and independence. Yet we remain remarkably uncomfortable with one of the most basic expressions of personal freedom: A woman deciding what she wants to wear. We seem to celebrate women's choices only when they conform to our idea of what is acceptable.

The problem is not merely conservative patriarchy. It is also the increasing politicisation of personal choices involving religion, clothing, marriage and relationships. Questions that should ordinarily remain within the sphere of individual liberty have increasingly become part of political and cultural battles. The so-called "love jihad" narrative is one example of how the personal choices of consenting adults can become matters of public and political scrutiny.

A woman must have agency over her own body, subject only to legitimate and constitutionally valid restrictions. This is also why the judiciary must be cautious about becoming an arbiter of personal morality or religious faith. The same principle of equal treatment should apply when religious practices become controversial, whether the issue concerns places of prayer, religious processions, symbols or practices like animal sacrifices associated with festivals. Constitutional freedoms cannot become conditional rights, protected when politically convenient and restricted when they become uncomfortable for those in power.

We do not have to agree with every choice a woman makes. We do not even have to understand it. But we should defend her right to make it.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Hormuz deadlock

THE IMBROGLIO between the US and Iran appears to stem from an inadequate intelligence assessment by America ('In US vs Iran, all roads lead back to Hormuz', IE, September 1). America must go beyond the objective of neutralising Iran's nuclear threat and reassure the international community about the smooth conduct of global affairs. The possible way out now is not to pressure Iran over a nuclear deal, but to allow fair play in maintaining its nuclear programme under IAEA supervision.

Parag Deshmukh, Thane

THE STRAIT of Hormuz presents a situation similar to that of the Suez Canal, which also became deeply entangled in the Arab-Israeli wars and remained closed for nearly eight years ('In US vs Iran, all roads lead back to Hormuz', IE, September 1). The Suez experience has shown that once a major waterway becomes a bargaining instrument, restoring normal navigation requires extensive diplomatic efforts. The international community should build a stronger multilateral framework to reinforce the principle of commercial navigation and protect merchant vessels.

Vaibhav Goyal, Chandigarh

Meta settlement

META'S \$18-billion settlement acknowledges that social platforms harm children, yet avoids addressing the core problem: Algorithms designed to maximise engagement regardless of consequences ('Meta's US deal redraws line of accountability', IE, September 1). Two-hour daily limits and curfews shift responsibility to parents while Meta's business model remains unchanged. The issue isn't usage duration but whether engagement-maximising feeds should be the default for young users. India must learn from this precedent. Effective regulation should demand that platforms prioritise safety over engagement by default, not burden families with constant monitoring.



SYED ATA HASNAIN

PRIME MINISTER Narendra Modi's presence at the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation summit comes at an unusually consequential moment. The war in Ukraine continues, the Gulf has been shaken by the US-Israeli conflict with Iran, and the international system is searching for a new equilibrium. Hence, the significance of this SCO lies most in who is sitting around the table. PM Modi is there with Russia's President Vladimir Putin, Chinese President Xi Jinping, Iran's President Masoud Pezeshkian and the leaders of Central Asia. This is precisely where India needs to be.

The SCO has never been an entirely comfortable strategic space for India. Yet it is important. The PM's bilateral engagement with Putin covered defence, energy, economic co-operation and the consequences of conflicts in West Asia and the Black Sea for maritime trade. Xi's presence is equally consequential even without a formal bilateral meeting. India and China are major economies and neighbours whose interests intersect across Asia. This is strategic autonomy in practice: The ability to engage Washington, Moscow and Beijing without allowing any one relationship to determine the others.

What makes this summit different is Iran. The conflict has shown how rapidly a West Asian crisis can acquire Eurasian consequences. The PM's meeting with President

That is why Bishkek matters beyond the SCO communiqué. The PM's presence signals that India intends to remain fully engaged wherever Eurasia's future is being shaped

In Bishkek, a lesson from Nalanda

Pezeshkian carried significance beyond bilateral ties. India emphasised diplomacy, protection of civilians and freedom of navigation and commerce. For India, Iran is also a geography. Pakistan denies India overland access to Central Asia. Afghanistan remains uncertain. Iran is vital to projects such as Chabahar and the International North-South Transport Corridor. After the Gulf crisis, West Asia and Central Asia can no longer be viewed as distinct strategic theatres.

Washington will examine Bishkek for signs of something larger: Whether China, Russia and Iran can transform dissatisfaction with the international order into durable institutional cooperation; whether alternative financial and connectivity structures acquire momentum; and where India positions itself. It would be mistaken, however, to interpret India's presence as evidence of an emerging anti-Western alignment. Its interests are more complex.

The Central Asian republics understand this. They have relationships with Russia, growing economic engagement with China, and seek wider partnerships with other countries. This is an opportunity for India. I was in Kyrgyzstan in June for the Issyk-Kul International Forum. Before that, I received the SCO Secretary General in Patna. These interactions reinforced that Central Asia desires to rediscover the region's ci-

vilisational importance. This offers India an advantage: Centuries of civilisational familiarity without a memory of domination. At Issyk-Kul, I spoke of what we in Bihar have begun describing as the Nalanda Approach. Ancient Nalanda was a knowledge ecosystem linking scholars and civilisations across Asia. That principle can acquire contemporary meaning through university partnerships, joint research, scholar exchanges, historical studies, technology collaboration and sustained intellectual dialogue.

India and Central Asia are geographically close but strategically separated. The absence of direct land access has constrained commerce, tourism, academic exchange and human interaction. Chabahar, the INSTC, air connectivity and new multimodal arrangements deserve greater attention.

That is why Bishkek matters beyond the SCO communiqué. The PM's presence signals that India intends to remain fully engaged wherever Eurasia's future is being shaped. Strategic partnerships can secure India a place at the table, and connectivity can give those partnerships substance. India has the ability to reconnect with Central Asia through knowledge, culture and civilisational memory. In a world once again dominated by contests for power, that may prove to be a remarkably durable form of influence.

The writer is Governor of Bihar

Himalayan disaster redraws disease ecology

mate change-related issue. After the latest disaster in Nepal, it is time to look at it from a health perspective. We know what happens when the water arrives. We still barely speak about what happens after it leaves.

Four waves of harm. Wave One: The immediate kill. Drowning, trauma, hypothermia. Kedamath 2013, Chamoli 2021, Sikkim 2023 — deaths were counted. Injuries were not. Crush wounds. Fractures. Frostbite.

Wave Two: The contamination. Glacial silt plus sewage plus animal carcasses is a laboratory for acute diarrhoea, hepatitis A and E, typhoid, skin infections and leptospirosis. When the primary health centre goes under, a pregnant woman delivers on the roadside. Vaccines warm. The outbreak begins after the rescue teams leave.

Wave Three: The invisible disruption. This is the largest wave, and the least

counted. Himalayan states carry a heavy load of non-communicable disease. A disaster like that in Nepal snaps the drug chain. Insulin needs refrigeration; electricity may be out for weeks. Dialysis patients are forced onto journeys of hundreds of kilometres, and tuberculosis treatment is interrupted.

Wave Four: The long shadow. After the Sikkim disaster, clinicians reported old patients relapsing and new ones arriving with

A disaster like that in Nepal snaps the drug chain. Insulin needs refrigeration; electricity may be out for weeks. Dialysis patients are forced onto journeys of hundreds of kilometres

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panic, hyperarousal and the inability to sleep when rain begins. Children stop going to school. Farmers watch a field turn into a stone bed. In the wetlands the flood leaves behind, mosquitoes appear at altitudes where they were never a public-health concern. The glacier redraws disease ecology.

Preparedness needs to be rewritten from a health perspective. First, map the downstream health footprint. ISRO and NDMA already rank dangerous water bodies. Overlay that map with Health and Family Welfare data: Primary health centres, sub-centres, cold-chain points, antenatal case loads, insulin-dependent patients, dialysis chairs. Second, treat early warning as a clinical intervention — to lift an oxygen plant, move vaccines, shift women in labour, and lock the NCD cupboard onto higher ground. Third, make the hill hospital climate-proof. The Na-

tional Programme on Climate Change and Human Health must name glacier-related disasters as a core hazard for Himalayan districts. Every district hospital in those catchments needs elevated drug storage, a solar-baked cold chain, a seven-day emergency kit for hypertension, diabetes, asthma and mental-health first aid, and household safe-water stock. Fourth, watch for 90 days, not 90 hours. Post-disaster, surveillance should be syndromic: Diarrhoea, jaundice, wound infections, breathlessness, distress and new-onset fever where vectors have new water.

The next glacier tragedy will ask whether anyone counted the insulin, the dialysis chair, the labour room and the child who still startles when the river rises in a dream.

The writer is an endocrinologist and public health physician based in Mumbai

The Big Picture

WEDNESDAY, SEPTEMBER 2, 2026

12

AROUND 8:30 PM, a doctor on duty in the Gynaecology Department of Kolkata's RG Kar Hospital rushes out for a quick break. Dressed in blue scrubs, the disposable covers on her shoes still on, she walks straight towards the food corner adjacent to the old Emergency building.

It was here, in the seminar room on the third floor of this building, that a 31-year-old postgraduate trainee was raped and murdered two years ago, a crime whose memory still casts a long shadow over the institution. The lower levels of the four-storeyed building are now a designated crime site, cordoned off by green covers.

The old Emergency building is among the few unlit spaces on the 30-acre campus. "You won't find a dark spot now. CISF jawans are stationed 24x7. In case of any problem, you can approach them immediately," says the doctor, a first-year resident, as she walks straight past a deserted canopy with worn-out banners and a few posters demanding "*bichar chai* (we want justice)".

Two years ago, this site, 'Abhaya Manch', named after the pseudonym given by the public and media to the RG Kar rape-murder victim, was the scene of one of the biggest protests Kolkata saw in the aftermath of the crime. For nearly three months, junior doctors from across the state, many of them young women like the victim, sat in protest here, demanding better working conditions and accountability from the Trinamool Congress government.

Many point to the tragedy, and the handling of the protests that followed, as among the many alleged mishandlings that triggered the fall of the TMC government and that led to the BJP coming to power in the state for the first time.

Since then at RG Kar, North Kolkata's key referral government hospital, where thousands once stood demanding accountability, daily life and medical emergencies have taken over. Some of the everyday demands the protesters raised then — rest spaces for doctors in the middle of their long, exhausting shifts and washrooms for women medical professionals — were drowned out, overtaken by dramatic political happenings in the state. Other, more visible changes were effected quickly. And as always, some things moved, others stayed still.

'It shouldn't have come to this'

Since the incident two years ago, the hospital's Emergency services have moved to the Trauma Care Centre building. The glowing red sign on the building shines brightly against the night sky, illuminating an area filled with non-stop activity. Stretchers roll quickly across the pavement, parked ambulances stand ready for the next call, and healthcare workers move swiftly from ward to ward, while yellow-and-green auto-rickshaws carry late-night patients and their relatives into and out of the campus.

At 9 pm, an intern whose family is from Varanasi, starts to walk back to her hostel room after wrapping up her 12-hour shift at Trauma Care. It's a seven-minute walk, past a few departments, including Gynaecology and the Night Patient Shelter. But she appears relaxed.

"How difficult this walk was," she says, recalling the years before the 2024 incident. "I was a third-year student when the doctor was killed. This long stretch used to be a dark zone those days, with almost no security. Now, you see movement all around. The security personnel are always on alert; they even remember our faces. A guard is stationed at our hostel, while two armed CISF personnel stand outside the gate, 24/7."

Personnel of the Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) had moved in on August 22, 2024, days after the August 9 rape-murder.

According to a senior CISF constable stationed outside Trauma Care, the security grid runs in three eight-hour shifts, involving over 70 personnel per shift. "Maximum deployment during the daytime is concentrated at the entry gates and the Emergency," he says. "At night, personnel are equally distributed throughout the campus so that the staff feel safe."

Outside the Trauma Care Centre, two CISF personnel stand watch. Directly opposite, at the Institute of Cardiovascular Sciences, three unarmed and two armed CISF personnel maintain a vigilant perimeter. Nearby, a Kolkata Police van stands parked. Every movement across the area is watched closely.

Joya Das, 42, a Group-D sanitation worker who has worked at RG Kar for 15 years, the last four years at the Labour Department, says, "Security has definitely improved so much. Earlier, anyone could enter the wards. Now, the CISF doesn't let people in without reason."

Das, who lives in the Belgachia slums nearby, was inside the hospital on the day of the 2024 incident. "I didn't know the doctor personally, but the incident left all of us disturbed," she says.

Surveillance across the campus has been scaled up. Over 800 working CCTV cameras now cover nearly every corner, monitored round-the-clock by the CISF from a centralised control room set up inside the campus.

On the night of the incident, the man accused of the rape-murder, Sanjay Roy, a former Kolkata Police civic volunteer, had allegedly walked into the Emergency building and up to the third floor where the victim was resting. A regular at the police outpost inside the hospital, he would allegedly move freely through every department and building in the complex.

At 8 pm, a woman police officer, who takes over the helpdesk outside the main entry gate, says, "Everyone remembers the incident. But we are vigilant enough now to



PHOTOS: PARTHA PAUL

TWO YEARS SINCE RAPE-MURDER

ONE LONG NIGHT AT RG KAR

Two years after a former civic volunteer raped and killed a 31-year-old doctor on duty at RG Kar Medical College & Hospital, a lot has changed. Yet, gaps remain. SWEETY KUMARI tracks the night shift at a hospital that became the epicentre of a fierce anti-government campaign



(Above) Inside one of the wards at RG Kar Hospital in Kolkata, where doctors manage overwhelming patient loads; security personnel at the Trauma Care Centre from where the Emergency department now runs

ensure no unnecessary loitering takes place inside the campus."

While the heightened security is reassuring, it serves as a constant reminder of why that protection became necessary.

The intern from Varanasi says, "I have at least one 24-hour shift every week. When on night duty, my parents call me from Varanasi every few hours just to ensure I am safe. I still feel a bit uneasy going out for tea, but when I see the guards, it gives me confidence."

Yet, she says, it shouldn't have come down to this. Doctors should not have to face a tragedy and should not need CISF "just to feel secure", she says.

As the clock strikes 11.30 pm, the hospital's main gates are partly closed, routing all traffic through a guarded side gate. Between 11:30 pm and 12 am, a joint contingent of armed CISF personnel, administrative staff, and Kolkata Police officers march through the campus corridors, blowing their whistles. "We do this daily to build confidence among the nurses, doctors, and patient families. Troublemakers are deterred by this routine," says a Kolkata Police officer on duty at the RG Kar outpost.

Dr Md Doyel Nur, a postgraduate trainee

who grew up in Murshidabad and completed his MBBS from a private college in Bangladesh, grabs a midnight meal at an eatery near the old Emergency building. "If the CISF weren't deployed here today, I don't think women PGTs [postgraduate trainees] would take night-call duties as smoothly or easily," he says.

'We are right back at zero'

Despite the security fixes, many point to the broader structural problems that persist, such as the lack of adequate, clean toilets for patients and doctors and spaces where doctors can rest in between shifts.

It's 7:45 pm and a young medical intern whose family is from Bhagalpur, Bihar, is sitting on the footpath near the principal's office, holding a lukewarm cup of tea.

"If you are on duty for 48 hours and are on your periods, every time you want to change a pad or pass urine, you have to leave the department, walk about seven minutes all the way to your hostel. Are dedicated, safe washrooms, separate for women doctors, such a big thing that we are asking for?" she says.

She is soon joined by a few other women colleagues who have stepped out of their hostel to join an 8 pm night shift at the Trauma Care Centre.

One of her colleagues admits to a startling daily ritual: "Today, I have a two-hour

duty, so I drank enough water. But now I won't sip any more water. I avoid using the department washrooms, and it's impossible to walk back to the hostel every time."

On the ground floor of the Trauma Centre, Emergency Medical Officers, doctors, Group-D staff, and contractual workers share a resting space — it's also a space where an initial registry is maintained for cases that need police intervention.

One washroom caters to both the General Medicine and Trauma units at the centre. Inside the washroom is a small room that the female staff keep locked for their exclusive use, but it is hardly a substitute for separate washrooms.

Doctors also say that one of the key demands of the protesters — dedicated, fully functional on-call duty rooms split by gender — has gone unaddressed.

Resident doctors frequently work uninterrupted 24- and 48-hour shifts, and in the absence of dedicated resting rooms, they are often forced to take brief moments of rest on vacant hospital beds, makeshift couches, or empty seminar halls. It was during one such exhausting shift that the RG Kar victim, who had sought a few hours of rest in the seminar room late at night, was assaulted and murdered.

During Supreme Court hearings in the rape-murder case, the hospital had committed to creating a safer environment and laid down directives for separate, biometric-secured resting spaces for men and women doctors. But two years on, in the absence of any such separate areas to rest, the staff continue to share the common areas.

Trinnesh Mondal, a second-year Postgraduate Trainee in General Surgery, says, "Every department ought to have a dedicated resting room for doctors. After 4 pm, there is only one washroom left for doctors, and that is shared. The rooms where doctors go to rest are easily accessible — anyone can walk in," he says.

Dr Nur, the postgraduate trainee from Murshidabad, says that in the Orthopaedics and Surgery departments, male interns often stay back in wards to provide security and support to their female colleagues, because dedicated, secure doctors' rooms do not exist. Across departments, patients, doctors, nurses and contractual workers share the same cramped rest spaces and washrooms.

A junior woman doctor says, "One of the key theories surrounding Abhaya's case is that she was resting with the door open in a common duty room accessible to anyone. Today, many of us feel that our fundamental demands remain unfulfilled. We feel we

are right back at zero."

Calls and texts to Medical Superintendent and Vice-Principal Dr Saptarshi Chatterjee went unanswered.

The victim's mother, Ratna Debnath, now a BJP MLA from Panihati, too, refused to comment on the changes at RG Kar.

The West Bengal government recently reopened its review of the criminal case, with newly appointed Health Minister Dr Sharadwat Mukherjee announcing a fresh evaluation into the initial handling of the case.

There are other systemic problems, including the patient burden at RG Kar, that were spoken of in the aftermath of the rape-murder, but remain unresolved.

The hospital's Outpatient Department sees an average footfall of 4,500 to 6,000 patients every day and maintains a consistent inpatient bed occupancy of around 1,500.

"CCTVs have increased, but the central referral system that was supposed to be activated never materialised. This would have ensured that the pressure of district cases wouldn't fall entirely on tertiary centres like RG Kar," says Dr Mondal, the doctor in the General Surgery department.

The closure of the old Emergency building has further strained resources. "The combined pressure of Trauma Care and Emergency now falls entirely on one building," he says.

Speaking on condition of anonymity, a senior administrative official at RG Kar Hospital reveals that patient care infrastructure, too, faces critical shortfalls.

"The Emergency department handles at least 150 patients daily. In the absence of washrooms, bedridden patients must rely on their families to bring bedpans while ambulatory patients walk 150 metres to a pay-and-use toilet outside," the official says.

As the night wears on, doctors manage overwhelming patient loads in their wards. In the Urology department, a single junior doctor routinely manages between 50 and 60 critical patients per shift.

Around 1 am, a postgraduate trainee from the Labour Department steps out for a brief break during her 24-hour shift. "What you see on the surface is the change. There are CISF personnel everywhere. But our hostel and rest conditions remain in a pathetic state," she says.

Outside the women's hostel, a group of interns sit on plastic chairs, sharing momos and biscuits. One of them points to two women CISF officers sitting under a street-lamp and says, "The only real change in the last two years is their deployment. But we constantly wonder — all this security is only at RG Kar. What about the other government medical colleges across Bengal? What is the guarantee that such an incident won't happen somewhere else? And how long will the CISF stay here?"

A quiet moment

At 12:30 am, near Trauma Care, Payal Aich, 20, a resident of Sodepur, walks nervously through the courtyard, clutching a prescription. Her father, a liver cancer patient, has been rushed to the centre, and the doctors have told her to urgently buy an injection. Approaching a woman CISF officer, Payal asks for directions to the pharmacy.

The officer points to a dimly lit lane, instructing her to turn left and walk for five minutes. Hesitant, Payal asks, "Could you please accompany me? That lane looks deserted." The woman constable walks alongside her towards the pharmacy.

The quiet moment reflects the reality of RG Kar today: security personnel filling some gaps, while healthcare workers and patients confront others that remain — and are widening.

• THE CASE SO FAR

THE INCIDENT

On August 9, 2024, a 31-year-old second-year PG student was found unconscious in the seminar hall of the hospital's Emergency building, and later declared dead. Police registered a case of rape and murder

WHAT HAPPENED NEXT

● The West Bengal Junior Doctors' Forum launched a protest across all public sector healthcare facilities in the state

● On August 14, 2024, hundreds of thousands of people, predominantly women, hit the streets in what was called the 'Reclaim the Night' march

● Later that night, a mob breached the hospital, vandalised areas near the Emergency building, the crime scene

THE INVESTIGATION

● The Kolkata Police, which initially probed the case, arrested a civic volunteer, Sanjay Roy, as the prime accused on August 10

● On August 13, the Calcutta High Court officially transferred the probe to the CBI

● Former RG Kar principal Sandip Ghosh and former Tala police station officer-in-charge Abhijit Mondal were arrested and accused of delaying the FIR and of tampering with the crime scene

● The CBI continues to file supplementary chargesheets before the Sealdah court. The HC has directed it to conclude the probe in 3 weeks. Next hearing is on September 24, 2026

THE ACCUSED

● On January 20, 2025, the Sealdah court sentenced Roy to life imprisonment until death

● The CBI filed an appeal before the HC, seeking the death penalty

OIL IMPORTS FROM VENEZUELA JUMPED 60.2% IN AUGUST

Russian oil imports fell 26% in Aug amid supply pressure, China factor

India's total oil imports in August stood at 4.62 million bpd, down 8.4% from July's 5.04 million bpd

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, September 1

INDIA'S OIL imports from Russia in August declined 26% from the historic highs in the previous month amid tighter Russian export availability as well as stronger competition from Chinese refiners, according to provisional tanker data.

Maintenance shutdowns at a few Indian refineries also likely contributed to lower crude intake.

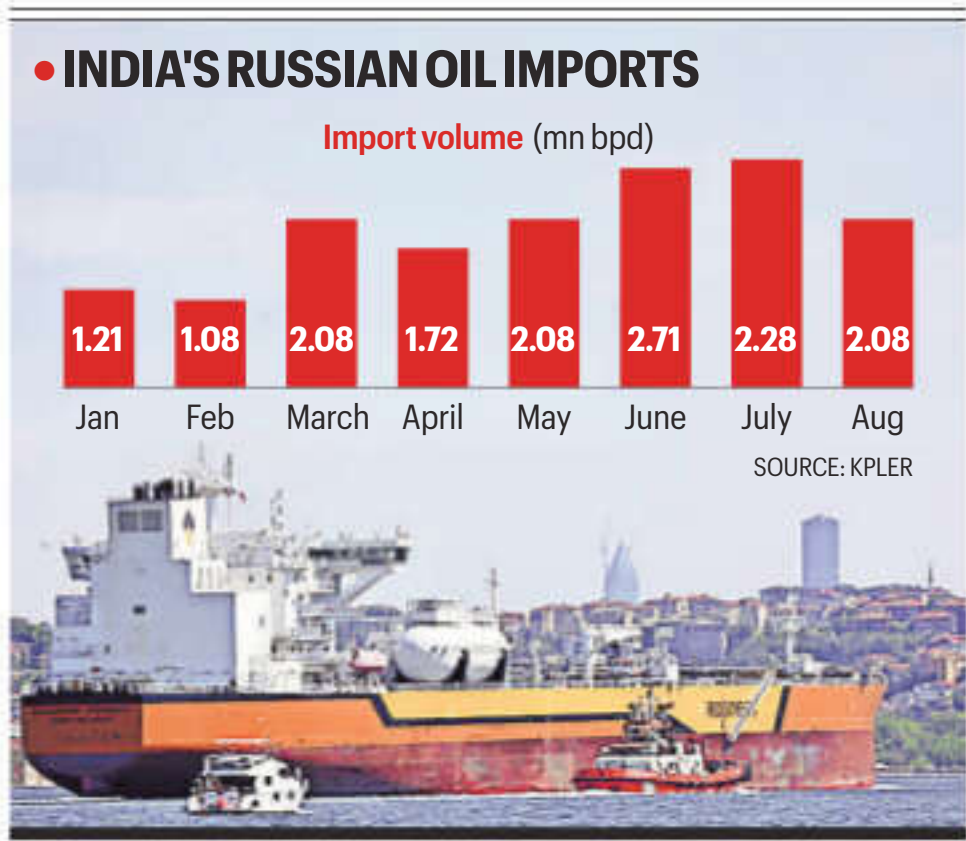
The fall in Russian volumes was the primary reason for the over 8% decline in India's overall oil imports in August. Notably, though, oil imports from Venezuela touched their highest monthly levels since 2020. With the US allowing Caracas's oil to flow into the global market, India restarted imports of Venezuelan oil a few months ago after nearly a year of zero imports.

According to vessel tracking data from commodity market analytics firm Kpler, India imported 2.08 million barrels per day (bpd) of Russian oil in August, down 26.3% from July's record levels of 2.82 million bpd.

India's total oil imports in

August stood at 4.62 million bpd, down 8.4% from July's 5.04 million bpd. Moscow's share in New Delhi's crude diet declined to 45% in August from 55.9% in July. According to Kpler, the shift points to market normalisation rather than a structural retreat from Russian crude, with flows expected to stabilise at 2.0 to 2.5 million bpd in the foreseeable future, which suggests that Russian oil is likely to remain the mainstay of India's oil imports. The import volumes, however, may come under some pressure due to the evolving energy market conditions with Russia's ability to export more being constrained and intensifying competition for Russian barrels from China.

"Russia is exporting less crude both to India and overall, just as China is competing more aggressively for available cargoes. The question for the coming months is therefore whether August represents a temporary retreat or the start of a period in which Russian barrels become scarcer, costlier and harder for Indian refiners to secure," said Abu Dhabi-based energy ana-



lyst Natalia Katona. Ukrainian attacks on Russia's oil and gas infrastructure is a key reason for the pressure on Russian oil exports. Attacks on export infrastructure in the Black Sea have become a tangible threat to navigation of energy tankers in the region.

Freight economics are incentivising avoiding the Black Sea routes altogether, according to Katona. For instance, moving a Suezmax tanker from the Black Sea port of Novorossiysk to India's west coast now costs about \$20 million, or roughly \$20 per barrel, compared with about \$13 per barrel if the tanker starts from the Baltic Sea ports. But dispatches from the Baltic Sea

ports carry their own risks, as Russian tankers sailing around Europe face detention or seizure by European countries.

"That has encouraged greater use of the Northern Sea Route (NSR), for which August and September are the peak traffic months even in a normal year due to the thin ice levels. With Black Sea drone threats adding to the pressure, Russian exporters are sending more vessels through the route, logically making China the most cost-competitive destination," Katona said.

Competition for Russian oil from China has picked up due to a few more factors, which in-

clude lower Russian oil exports as Moscow has been trying to maximise domestic refinery production to meet domestic fuel demand amid Ukrainian attacks on its energy infrastructure, and the fall in Iranian oil volumes available to Chinese refiners amid the Strait of Hormuz crisis.

India's crude import strategy has shifted sharply since March 2026 as Strait of Hormuz disruptions tightened West Asian oil flows and increased freight risks. Russian crude remains the backbone of India's import slate, while refiners have diversified aggressively towards African, North American, and South American barrels to offset the drop in supplies from the Gulf.

Interestingly, oil imports from Venezuela in August jumped 60.2% over July to 350,000 bpd, the Kpler data shows. With the US capturing Venezuela's then president Nicolás Maduro early January, Trump had said that Washington would take control of Caracas's oil sector. After that, a few commodity traders were authorised by Washington to sell Venezuelan oil globally, which had been under US sanctions.

About 40% of India's crude imports usually came through the Strait of Hormuz, and a large part of that supply has effectively been offline.

FULL REPORT ON
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FOREIGN ASSETS DISCLOSURE SCHEME

Concerns rise over high fee on ESOPs, small investments

Aanchal Magazine
New Delhi, September 1

● *A salaried individual had invested Rs 90,000 in stocks listed in the US, now trading at a loss. The money transfer was part of the annual information statement (AIS) of the person's income tax return (ITR) but he did not disclose it separately in the Schedule FA (foreign assets). Under the new scheme, he will have to pay Rs 1 lakh upfront for disclosing the loss-making investment.*

● *An employee with a foreign company operating in India had the vesting details of his employee stock ownership plan (ESOP) as part of his salary, but had not declared it separately in the Schedule FA. He has to now pay Rs 1 lakh just as disclosure charges under the new scheme.*

When the government proposed the foreign assets disclosure scheme in this year's Budget, the intent was well specified — to address "practical issues of small taxpayers like students, young professionals, tech employees, relocated NRIs" among others.

However, the disclosure window, Foreign Assets of Small Taxpayers – Disclosure Scheme (FAST-DS), launched on August 16, has now resulted in doubts and questions as individuals face high fees and penalties. The problem is more acute for salaried individuals who have received restricted stock units (RSUs) or ESOPs, and not reported them before. Even for cases where there has not been any actual gain, the employees will now be required to pay Rs 1 lakh for disclosure under the scheme,

which is being seen as too steep an amount by many. "The ESOPs are part of my salary, just that I did not disclose it separately earlier. Asking for Rs 1 lakh as an amount for only disclosure is too high," the employee with the foreign company cited above said.

Change in status

Experts said that the change in status from a non-resident to an Indian resident needs to be taken note of by the authorities, especially for cases where salaried employees took ESOPs from their global companies. "Many of them were non-resident Indians (NRIs) then and were later deputed to India and became Indian residents. They did not disclose the old details earlier and are disclosing it now. After disclosure, you get the notices saying how did you acquire it? The NRIs have turned into residents, that has to be taken note of," a top executive with an asset management company said.

ESOPs are key salary components in many sectors, especially in tech sector, startups and foreign companies. The scale of ESOPs in India's net outflows can be seen from the sharp rise of the flows under "financial derivatives (other than reserves) and employee stock options" of the Balance of Payments (BoP) in recent years. In 2025-26, this figure stood at just under \$24 billion, up 8% from a net outflow of around \$22 billion in 2024-25. However, it rose sharply in 2024-25, almost tripling from nearly \$8 billion in 2023-24. Many employees are considering filing an up-

dated return for such anomalies rather than disclosing under the scheme, with greater scrutiny going ahead being one of the key concerns. When asked, tax officials pointed out that the Black Money (Undisclosed Foreign Income and Assets) and Imposition of Tax Act doesn't recognise updated returns for income that was never before taxed or disclosed. "So even if the updated return is filed, he'll still be liable to tax and penalty under the Black Money Act. That's why it is better to disclose under FAST-DS. There is no intention of more scrutiny for such declarations," an income tax official said.

'Disproportionate penalty'

The scheme has two categories: i) undisclosed and never-before-taxed foreign income or asset outside India up to Rs 1 crore; ii) asset up to Rs 5 crore outside India, which was already offered to tax or was acquired under non-resident status, but not declared properly in the ITR. Under the first category, an assessee needs to pay 30% of fair market value of assets or undisclosed income as tax and 30% as additional income tax in lieu of penalty, while for the second category, the disclosure fee is Rs 1 lakh. The question is also of materiality — the maximum amount of error allowed in the financial statements before they are considered wrong. Experts pointed out that if the amounts are not significant enough, the penalty of Rs 1 lakh looks disproportionate.

After Q1 surprise, economists hike FY27 GDP growth outlook

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, September 1

THE RESERVE Bank of India's (RBI) GDP growth forecast of 6.7% for 2026-27, made on August 5, is looking increasingly conservative, with economists making sharp upward revisions to their predictions after Monday's blockbuster 7.8% growth print for April-June.

Ranging from 20 basis points to 80 basis points (bps), the growth upgrades made by economists on Monday and Tuesday have been such that the consensus number is now 7.2%, up from 6.7% earlier, according to estimates of 10 economists. Their forecasts are now in the range of 6.9-7.5%.

GDP growth has been higher than 7% in the last three years: 7.3% in 2023-24, 7.2% in 2024-25, and 7.8% in 2025-26. A full-year growth print of over 7% in 2026-27 would make it four years in a row.

According to ANZ economists Dhiraj Nim and Sanjay Mathur, the April-June growth number "marked the 12th consecutive quarter of positive surprise relative to market expectations". While the RBI had forecast 7%, market economists were closer to 7.3-7.5%, with only a small number predicting that growth could be as high as 7.8-8%. However, even those who predicted such a high number have made a sharp upward revision to their forecast for 2026-27 as a whole. Soumya Kanti

Ghosh, State Bank of India's Group Chief Economic Adviser, has raised his forecast by 70 bps to 7.3%, having predicted that growth may come in at 8% in April-June. "GDP growth has continued to surprise on the upside," said Upasana Chachra and Bani Gambhir, economists at Morgan Stanley, in a note. According to them, the strength in manufacturing and investment activity "aligns with our view of India being on the cusp of a capex up-cycle".

"The stronger-than-expected April-June data, alongside the robust tracking data for July-September so far, point to sustained growth momentum. Against this backdrop, we raise our FY27 real GDP growth forecast to 7.3% (from 6.7%)," they said. Those who didn't raise their growth forecasts admitted there is an upside risk to their predictions. However, some chose to keep their powder dry keeping in mind an expected slowdown in the second half of the year and the risks to the growth outlook.

For instance, ICICI Securities Primary Dealership's economists led by A Prasanna — who retained their forecast of 7% — see five risk factors for growth in the next three quarters: an unfavourable base effect, crude oil prices, any impact on agriculture growth and rural demand from sub-par rains, and the hit to India's exports from weaker foreign demand due to tighter financial conditions.

In the same vein, they expect the RBI to also consider interest rate hikes, as signalled by the central bank's officials in the minutes of the Monetary Policy Committee's August 3-5 meeting.

"Fiscal policy choices will also be crucial. In case the government chooses to stick to the fiscal deficit target, and given the front loading on the capex growth front, there could be marginal headwind to demand from that side as well," they added. As per the RBI's own forecast, GDP growth is seen at 6.4% in July-September, 6.5% in October-December, 6.8% in January-March 2027, and 7.3% in April-June 2027. The RBI's MPC will next meet October 5-7, where the central bank is expected to raise its own prediction of growth this year.

"The strong GDP data should bolster the MPC's confidence on growth, and sharpen its focus on inflation," Nomura's Sonal Varma and Aurodeep Nandi said.

"The key question is whether stronger growth will lead to more demand side inflationary pressures — which have been absent thus far, despite the surge in input costs."

Data released earlier this month showed headline retail inflation inched up to 4.45% in July from 4.38% in June — the second month in a row it was above the RBI's medium-term target of 4%. FULL REPORT ON

WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM



Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman met US Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent on the sidelines of the G20 Finance Ministers and Central Bank Governors meeting, in Asheville, on Monday. X/@FINMININDIA

Current account deficit widens to \$4.2 bn in Q1

ENS Economic Bureau
Mumbai, September 1

INDIA'S CURRENT account deficit (CAD) widened to \$4.2 billion, or 0.5% of GDP, in the first quarter of 2026-27, from \$3.4 billion, or 0.4% of GDP in the corresponding quarter a year ago, according to data released by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI).

The modest widening in the CAD came primarily on the back of a sharper merchandise trade deficit. The merchandise trade gap increased to \$86.1 billion in Q1 2026-27, compared with \$68.9 billion in Q1 2025-26, reflecting the continued pressure from India's import bill, the central bank said.

However, the impact of the wider trade deficit was partly offset by stronger earnings from services and higher remittance receipts.

Net services receipts rose to \$51.6 billion during the quarter from \$47.9 billion a year earlier. Services exports increased year-on-year across major segments, including computer services, other business services and transportation services, the RBI said.

The primary income account also provided some relief. Net outgo on the account, which largely reflects investment income payments, declined to \$10.5 billion in Q1 2026-27 from \$13.3 billion in the year-ago quarter, it said.

● THE OPERATIONAL FRAMEWORK NOTIFIED ON MONDAY PUTS CHIP DESIGN AT THE FRONT OF THE NEW SEMICONDUCTOR MISSION

Semicon 2.0: How India aims to build a domestic chip design ecosystem

Soumyarendra Barik
New Delhi, September 1

THE CENTRE'S Rs 1.27 lakh crore Semicon 2.0 programme has laid out a three-part push to build domestic chip-design companies, offering government-backed support for developing strategic semiconductor technologies, commercially viable chips, and getting those products deployed in the market.

The operational framework notified Monday puts chip design at the front of the new semiconductor mission.

Of the programme's six pillars and 10 categories, its first pillar is entirely focused on design, with separate tracks for chips required for national and strategic priorities, commercial

semiconductor products, and a deployment-linked incentive for newly developed chips.

The design push seeks to address a key gap in India's semiconductor ambitions. While the country has emerged as a major global base for chip-design engineers, much of this work is currently done for multinational semiconductor companies.

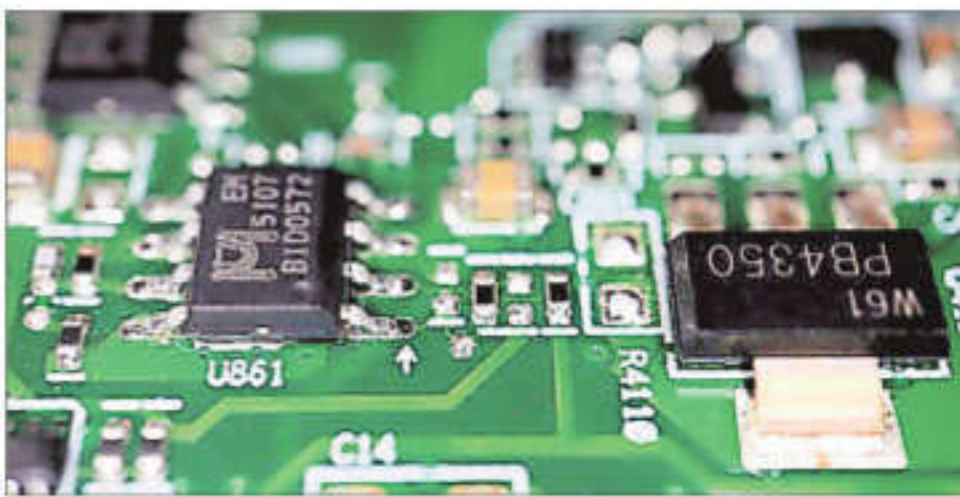
Semicon 2.0 seeks to build more Indian-owned intellectual property and fabless semiconductor companies — firms that design and sell chips while outsourcing their physical fabrication.

Boosting chip design

The first track is aimed at semiconductor technologies

considered important for national security and critical infrastructure. The government will identify IP, chips, systems-on-chip (SoCs) and modules that it wants developed, including building blocks for compute, memory, radio frequency, power, networking and sensors. A second track is meant for commercial chip-design companies.

Here, the government will provide access to expensive electronic design automation tools, multi-project wafer fabrication services, IP cores, compute subsystems and post-silicon validation facilities. Start-ups and MSMEs can receive milestone-linked seed funding of up to Rs 15 crore, or 50% of the project cost,



The design push seeks to address a key gap in India's semiconductor ambitions. REUTERS
Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RG9mIjMzg1 whichever is lower. The government can also make equity co-investments alongside venture capital and private equity investors. Larger eligible companies can opt for royalty financing, under which they will pay 5% of the net revenue from

provided they are incorporated and headquartered in India and maintain a significant operational and manpower presence here. The IP and associated design and development files will have to remain in India.

"I was also glad to see that the scheme has this time been opened up to companies owned by Overseas Citizens of India which is a very good decision, since they bring rich global experience that will help create truly advanced design companies in India," said Arjun Malhotra, co-founder of HCL and chairperson of the EPIC Foundation.

Helping Indian chips find buyers

Semicon 2.0 also intro-

duces a separate deployment-linked incentive, aimed at the next problem after successfully designing a chip: getting customers to adopt it at scale.

Eligible semiconductor IP, chips and SoCs launched after the scheme's announcement will receive a reimbursement equivalent to 9% of their net sales for five years.

The benefit is capped at Rs 30 crore per application and Rs 120 crore for a company, including its group entities, across multiple products. This is particularly relevant for young fabless companies, which can face a hurdle convincing electronics manufacturers to switch from established overseas semiconductor suppliers to a newly developed Indian chip.

Broader ecosystem

The scheme is also aimed at filling gaps across the semiconductor supply chain. Companies setting up semiconductor-equipment R&D facilities, plants manufacturing wafers, photomasks, photoresists, substrates, chemicals and gases, testing facilities, or units producing semiconductor equipment and components can receive 30% capital expenditure support. Equipment manufacturers will additionally get a production-linked incentive that declines from 10% to 2% over five years on the value of their bill of materials sourced domestically. Large silicon wafer fabs will be eligible for 40% capex support.

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Classifieds

PERSONAL

I, hitherto known as NEERAJ, S/o Mr. Ramanand Pandey, R/o-A-14 Ganpati Apartment 6 Alipur Road Civil-Lines, North Delhi, Delhi-110054, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Neeraj Pandey. 0040875693-2

I, Alok Kumar, S/o-Anant Prakash, R/o E3-1211A, 13th Floor, Bharat City, Indraprasth Vojna, teelamod, Ghaziabad, have changed my name to Alok Kumar Srivastava. 0040875725-5

I, BASEEM BEG, S/o-Ahmad Beg, R/o-H.No.268 Khasra No.21, Gali No.7 Block-D Bhaliswa Dairy Swami Shardanand Colony Badli Delhi-110042 have changed my name to VASIM BEG 0040875702-8

I Hari Krishan S/o Darbari Lal Kapoor R/o 90, 91, 92, 93, First Floor, Plot No-104, T-Block, Jain Colony, Part-1, Uttam Nagar, Mohan Garden, West Delhi, Delhi-110059, have changed my name to Harish Kapoor 0071058015-1

I, SUNAINA, D/o-RAJ KUMAR, R/o H.No.-L-4, Hauz-Khas, Enclave, New Delhi-1100016, have changed my name from SUNAINA to SUNAINA GAUR for all purposes. 0040875693-11

I, KM SUCHITA, W/O-Shobh Nath Pandey, R/O-RZ-47, Upper Ground Floor, Khasra- No.289, Sayed Nangloi, Paschim Vihar, Delhi-110087, have changed my name to SUCHITA PANDEY in future for all purposes. 0040875702-1

I, Anita Nangia D/o Shri Loknath Nangia R/O C-38, Arya Nagar Apartments, (Plot No.91), I.P. Extension, Patparganj, Delhi-92, do hereby inform the Public at large that my name has been mentioned as "ANITA" in Surya Aggarwal (my son) passport. Now, I wish to be called with my full name i.e., "ANITA NANGIA". ANITA and ANITA NANGIA are both same and one person i.e. my self. 0040875578-1

I, SHIFALI BASSI, W/O-MANISH KUMAR BASSI, R/O-HOUSE NO-56 ARYA SAMAJ ROAD UTTAM NAGAR, DELHI-110059, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SHAFALI BASSI. 0040875693-4

I, Jagwinder Kaur, W/o-Kawaljeet Singh, R/O-134, Second Floor, Ambica Vihar, Paschim Vihar, Delhi, have changed my name to Jagvinder Kaur, for all purposes. 0040875693-6

I, SUSHILA, M/O-ANIL RATHI resident of Town+Post-TIKRI, Teh-BARAUT, District-BAGPAT-250625 have changed my name from SUSHILA to SUSHILA DEVI vide affidavit dated 01/09/2026 0040875725-7

I, UMESH KUMAR AGARWAL, S/o SH ROSHAN LAL AGRAWAL resident of Sudhir Sadan, Kasera Oli Sarafa Bazar Gwalior MP 474001, have changed my name from UMESH KUMAR AGARWAL to UMESH KUMAR AGRAWAL as per affidavit dated 01 Sep 2026. 0040875568-1

I, NITIN JOG, S/O-DIDAR SINGH, R/O-H NO-164 DUDIAL APARTMENT MADHUBAN CHOWK PITAMPURA DELHI-110034, have changed my name to NITIN SINGH for all future purposes 0040875702-10

I, Ramesh Chandra Soni S/o Nand Lal R/O-F-27, Sector Beta-I, Greater Noida Distt G.B Nagar U.P. have changed my name to Ramesh Soni for all future purposes 0071058025-1

I, Hasina Sheikh, D/o Mohammad Masik Alam, R/O Hno. 632, Vikas Kusth Ashram, Tahipur, New Seemapuri, Delhi-110095, changed my name as Shireen Sheikh. 0130068729-1

I, SUSAN D/O MR. PAUL R/O Sacred Heart Provincial House 145/21 Shiv Enclave Dichaun Road , Najafgarh New Delhi-110043 have changed my name from Susan to Suneey Paul and shall hereafter be known as SUNEY PAUL 0040875720-1

I, RISHI RANJAN, S/O-GOPINDRA RANJAN SHARMA, R/O-SHRI SHIV MANDIR, OPPOSITE NIZAMUDDIN POLICE-STATION, NIZAMUDDIN, NEW DELHI-110013, have changed my name, from RISHI RANJAN, to RISHI RANJAN SHARMA, for all purposes. 0040875702-3

I, Mohammad Meral uddin S/o Mohammad Zainul Abedin, R/O J-1202, Tower-J, Samridhi Grand Avenue, Techzone-IV, G.B Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201306, have changed my name to UDDIN (SURNAME) GIVEN NAME - MOHAMMAD MERAJ, Father's Name - Mohammad Zainul Abedin to Mohammad Zainul Abedin for all future purposes. 0071057991-1

It is notified for the information that I, Shukla Hazra, D/o-Gobinda Chandra Hazra, H.No.44, GULMOHAR ENCLAVE, ANDREWSGANJ, S/o South-Delhi, Delhi-110049, have lost my original, GPO Dated-08.12.1989, Reg.No.31346, register ed at SRO Noida executed, by Anil Gujral in, favour of K.I.LAL Seghal of property in respect of, Flat-No.44, cat II on, First Floor in GulMohar-Enclave, New-Delhi, has been lost During photocopy, Property Papers, Finder please contact above the address. 0040875725-9

I, Sachin Kumar S/o Ram Chander Kukreja R/O N-282, Park Place, DLF Phase-5, Golf Course Road, Gurgaon, Haryana-122009, have changed my name to SACHIN KUKREJA for all future purposes. 0071057969-1

I, Ramesh Kumar, S/O-Late prabhu dayal, R/O-HNo-20/54, Dakshin puri, Dr Ambedkar Nagar Pushpa Bhawan south West, New-Delhi-110062, i declare that My Name has been, wrongly written as, My cast certificate, Ramesh Chand my correct name is, Ramesh kumar may be amended, accordingly. 0040875702-12

I, Nasim S/o Manga R/o H.No-884, Kasrewa, Muzaffarnagar, have changed my name to Naseem. 0040875725-2

I, Aanchal Arora w/o Rajiv Arora r/o-437/11 Hem Nagar sonipat, Have Changed my name to Dimpi, for all purposes. 0040875702-5

I Neeraj Alias Neha Bansal Alias Neeraj Bansal D/o Kuldeep Chand Gupta and W/o Late Neeraj Bansal R/O H-4, 1st Floor, Mukhram Garden, Tilak Nagar, West Delhi, Delhi-110018, have changed my name to Neeraj Bansal 0071057997-1

I, Mohammad Shadab Alam C/o Mehmod Hasan, K-1/89, Thokar No-4, Abul Fazal Enclave-1, Delhi-25 have changed my name to Mohd Shadab Alam. 0071058052-1

I, Nasir, S/o-Moinuddin, R/O-T-352/A, 4th Floor, Flat No.12, Ahata Kidara, Near- Al-Quresh Masjid, Delhi-110006 have changed my name to MOHD NASIR, for all purpose. 0040875693-8

I, Rashmi Nimwal, W/o Sh. Suresh Nimwal, R/O House-No.851, Sector-9, Urban Estate, Gurgaum, Haryana-122001, That Rashmi Nimwal and Rampiari are one and the same person 0040875737-1

I, Abhishek S/o Digvijay Goyal R/O-B-601, Icon Apartments Sector-Chi-3, Greater Noida Gautam Budh Nagar, Uttar Pradesh, Have Changed My Name To Abhishek Goyal For All Future Purposes. 0071057977-1

I, Shama Parveen, W/o-Rajuddin R/O-H.No-78, Gali, No-2, New Hindon Vihar, Arthala Haj House, Mohan Nagar, Ghaziabad, have changed my name to Shama Parveen Malik. 0040875725-4

I, ASHOK S/o Jamma Prasad R/J-1, Block-J, Phase-1, Budh Vihar Delhi-110086 have changed my name to DWARIKA PRASAD 0040875702-7

I, hitherto known as ANOOP W/o JUGGAL R/O Rankoli (124) Baund, Bhiwani, Haryana, 127025, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as SARJOI. 0071058012-1

I, Manish Dua S/o Late Shri Prabhu Dayal D/O R-229, Mangal Bazar Road, Laxmi Nagar, Delhi -110092 have inform that that in my Passport No. F6891153 my name is written as Manish Kumar. In my Pan Card No. AEGPD8025G and in my Aadhar No. and other documents my name is written as Manish Dua. Manish Kumar and Manish Dua is the name of one and same person i.e. my self. 0040875637-1

I, Haneet Kaur, W/O-Ritul Munjal R/O Firayalal Compound Kadru Diversion Ranchi Jharkhand 834001 Have Changed My Name To Haneet Kaur Munjal 0040875693-10

I, MANOJ KUMAR VERMA, S/o MOHAN LAL VERMA, ADD-F-802, OFFICER CITY-1, RAJNAGAR EXTENSION, GHAZIABAD 201017, UTTAR PRADESH, have changed my name to MANOJ VERMA. 0040875693-3

I, RAHUL KUMAR, C/o-I.C. Jain, Floor No-1169 First Floor, Pinewood Enclave, Sector-2 Wave City NH-24, Ghaziabad, have changed my name to RAHUL KUMAR JAIN. 0040875725-6

I, Pooja Wangnoo, W/O Swapnadi Mazumder R/O 129, Munirka Enclave, Delhi-110067 Have Changed my Name to Pooja Wangnoo Mazumder. 0040875702-9

I, AZAM S/o Farooq Siddiqui, G-14, TF, Shaheen Bagh, Jamia Nagar, Delhi-25 have changed my name to AZAM FAROOQ SIDDIQUI. 0071058056-1

I, RAMESH SINGLA, S/O MANGA RAM, R/O-181-182, UGF, POCKET-12, SECTOR-24, ROHINI, DELHI-110085, have changed my name to RAMESH KUMAR 0040875702-2

I, ALAINA D/O MOHD ISHAR SOLANKI R/O H.NO-IX/5594, GALI NO-11, OLD SEELAMPUR, GANDHI NAGAR, PO: GANDHI NAGAR, DIST: EAST DELHI, DELHI-110031 have changed my name to ALAINA SOLANKI for all purposes. 0071057981-1

I, PUSHPENDER KUMAR SINGH, S/O-NARENDRA PRATAP SINGH, N-5-2/141/A, AMAN ENCLAVE, PREM NAGAR-3, KIRARI SULEMAN NAGAR, NORTH WEST DELHI-110086, have changed my name to PUSHPENDRA KUMAR SINGH. 0040875693-5

I, Rajeev Bhatia, S/o Vijay Kumar Bhatia, R/O 5/9, Jai Dev Park East Punjabi Bagh Delhi-26 have changed my name to Rajiv Bhatia. 0040875693-1

I, Nripendra Gupta S/o Phool Chandra Gupta, R/o- Flat No. GC 201, Aditya Mega City, Vaibhav Khand, Indirapuram, Ghaziabad 201014 (U.P.), have changed my name to Nripendra Kumar Gupta and both Nripendra Gupta and Nripendra Kumar Gupta is same person. 0071057966-1

I, Rais Ahmad, (DOB-20-01-1965) S/o Babu Khan R/O-29/500/19A/2C, Gali No.10, Vishwas Nagar, Shahdara, Delhi-110032, have changed my name to Rahish (DOB-01-01-1970) for all purposes. 0040875725-8

I, SHISH PAL/OSHISHU PAL DHINGRA S/o-Lakhi Ram Dhingra R/o-1/135, Subash Nagar Delhi-110027, both names belong to same person i.e. myself 0040875702-11

I, Prachi Gupta, W/o Vishal Gupta, resident of House No. A-76, Patel Nagar-2, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201001, have changed my name from Prachi Gupta to Prachi Garg. Henceforth I would be known by the name of Prachi Garg for all future purposes. 0071058029-1

I, SARIKA GROVER, W/O-VIKRANT MEHRA, R/O H NO-7-A GF GALI NO-5/9 CHANDER VIHAR NANGLOI DELHI 110041, have changed the name to SARIKA MEHRA. 0040875725-1

I, Gagan Deep Chhabra, R/o J-1870, Ground Floor, C.R.Park, New Delhi-110019, have changed the name of my minor son Shaurya Veer Chhabra, aged 13 years, and he shall hereafter be known as Shauryaveer Chhabra for all future purposes. 0040875575-1

I, Neelam w/o-Anit Kumar r/o Flat no-004, Tower no-6, Sunshine County, Ansul Sushant City, Sonipat Have Changed my name to Neelam Devi, for all purposes 0040875702-4

I Shweta W/O Brajesh Kumar, resident of KM 34, 101, KOSMOS, JAYPEE WISH TOWN, SECTOR 134, NOIDA, GAUTAM BUDDH NAGAR, 201304, UTTAR PRADESH, INDIA have changed my name from Shweta to Shweta Rani. Henceforth I would be known by the name of Shweta Rani for all future purposes. 0071057994-1

I, Sunil Kumar, R/O-House-No.J-1/338, DDA Flats, Kalkaji, New Delhi 110019, have changed my son's name from AYAAN to VANSH for all purposes. 0040875693-7

I, Shuhangi Verma, W/o-Shubham Sharma, R/O-31, The Palms Society, Builders Area, Pocket-P7, Greater Noida-201310, U.P. have changed my name to Shubhangi Sharma. 0040875725-10

I, Fozia W/o Amir Saifi, R/o Tilpata Karanwas, Greater Noida, Up-201306 have changed my name to Fozia Naim for all future Purposes. 0071057976-1

I, SUPRIYA Ghosh, mother of NO.15752905W , Rank-SIGMN , Name-Sudharsan Ghosh , resident of Vill-Madhunia, PO+PS-Kandi, Dist-Murshidabad, West Bengal-742137, have changed my name from Supriya Ghosh to Supria Ghosh vide Affidavit No. IN-DL78469719186812Y dated 18 Aug 2026 0040875682-1

I, Riyazuddin Khan, S/o-Jumman Khan, R/O-H.No-78, Gali, No-2, New Hindon Vihar, Arthala Haj House, Mohan Nagar, Ghaziabad, have changed my name to Rajuddin Khan. 0040875725-3

I, FARHAT KHATOON, W/o-Md Sabir Ali, R/O-C-90, Gali No.-3, Harijan Basti, Mulla Colony, Gharoli, East Delhi-110096, have changed, my name from, FARHAT KHATOON to FARHAT PARWEEN, for all future purposes. 0040875702-6

Raj Bala W/o Tilok Chand Jain R/O C-15, Vandana Vihar, Nangloi, Delhi -110041, have changed my name to Raj Bala Jain 0071058000-1

I, ALOK MITRA S/o Sachi Nandan Mitra, 112, C-3, Phase-4, Aya Nagar, Delhi-47 have changed my name to ALOK KUMAR MITRA. 0071058055-1

I, Sajid S/O, Islamuddin R/o D-407, Pocket A-14, Govindpur, Delhi, have changed my name to Sajid Iqbal. 0040875608-3

I, NOSHAD ALI, S/O-IRSHAD ALI, R/O A-135, SHAHEEN BAGH ABUL FAZAL ENCLAVE -1, DELHI-110025 HAVE CHANGE MY NAME NAME TO NAUSHAD KHAN. 0040875693-9

I, Nafish Nazli W/o Ejaj Raja R/o Ward No-15 Jangalia Gopalganj Bihar-841428 Have Changed My Name To Nafissa Najli For Future. 0040875737-2

I, Dinesh Chand Gupta, S/o Sh. Kaniya Lal R/O-Plot-No-216, Block-A, First-Floor, Sector-8, Dwarka, Delhi-110077, have changed my name Dinesh Chand Gupta to Dinesh Gupta, for all purposes, and both are the same person. 0040875571-1

मैं, श्रीमती सुशीला देवी W/O श्री सुशील कुमार निवासी ग्राम तिलकपुरवा, थाना बघौली, तहसील हरदोई, जिला हरदोई, उत्तर प्रदेश, भविष्य के सभी कार्यों के लिए अपना नाम "सुशीला" से बदलकर "प्रेमा देवी" कर रही हूं। सुशीला देवी" और" प्रेम देवी दोनों एक ही व्यक्ति हैं.

LST & FOUND

I rani kamal kaur d/o nderjit kaur r/o sarvodaya enclave delhi, have lost original property transfer deed done with ats developers for my apartment no.6191 in derabassi. Have lodged FIR no. LR.No: 595712/2026 0040875608-1

I, Deepak Kashyap S/o Late Naubat Ram, have Lost Original Cancelled Perpetual Lease Deed and Handing Over Possession of D-16/290, Sector-7, Rohini, Delhi-110085. Finder Call:- 9868847465. 0040875702-14

EDUCATION

EDUCATIONAL

MA EDUCATIONAL INSTITUTE
Pkt.: H-3, Sec-18, Rohini, Delhi-89
M: 9312628221
E-mail: maisdelhi@rediffmail.com
Admission in
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under 10% Management
Quota Seats
Eligibility 12th Passed with 50%
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10 September & submitted in College
Office by 12 September 2026 by 1pm

RECRUITMENT

SITUATION VACANT

OTHERS

Required trained plumber for working in highrise building in cp area in a maintenance company. Kindly email your particular at em.gvcl.vandhana@gmail.com 0040875716-1

PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE
Apartment No. CMS07A situated at 'The Camellias', Golf Course Road, DLF Phase-5, Sector-42, Gurgaum, Haryana-122009 [said Apartment], was purchased in the name of Late Mr. Naveen Kumar Khatiyariya S/o Late Mr. Ram Mukund Khatiyariya alias Ram Mukund Khatiyariya and Mrs. Puja Khatiyariya W/o of Late Mr. Naveen Kumar Khatiyariya, both R/O Apartment No. CMS07A situated at 'The Camellias', Golf Course Road, DLF Phase-5, Sector-42, Gurgaum, Haryana-122009. Whereas Mr. Naveen Kumar Khatiyariya left for heavenly abode on 14.10.2023 and left behind 3 (three) legal heirs namely 1.) Mrs. Puja Khatiyariya (Wife), 2.) Mr. Sidharth Khatiyari (Son) and 3.) Mr. Gautam Khatiyari (Son). Now the share of Mr. Naveen Kumar Khatiyariya in the said Apartment is being noted in the name of his wife Mrs. Puja Khatiyariya (with the mutual consent of all the legal heirs of Mr. Naveen Kumar Khatiyariya) in DLF's record and the name of Mrs. Puja Khatiyariya recorded as the sole owner in respect of the said Apartment. If anybody has any objection to this, he or she or their registered office at DLF Shopping Mall, 3rd Floor, Arjun Marg, DLF City Phase-1, Gurgaum-122002, Haryana, India or the undersigned within 11 (Twenty-One) days of publication of this notice.

Vidhi Goe (Advocate) Capex Legal
C-451, LGF, Defence Colony, New Delhi-110024

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notified that my clients Sh. Lokesh Verma S/o Sohan Pal Verma and his wife Sunita Rani R/o K-175, Shakur Pur, Delhi-110034, have severed all their relations from their Daughter Himanshi, due to her bad habits and the had married of her own Will without consent of my clients and after her marriage she is living separately with her husband. My clients have disowned/debarred her from all their moveable and immovable properties, acquired and to be acquired, and broken all their relation with her because she is not obedient of my clients. Any person dealing and having relation with her in any manner shall be at their own risk, cost & consequences and my clients shall not be responsible for any act and deed of the aforesaid.

Sd/-
Vishal Singh
Advocate
Enrl. No.7492014

PUBLIC NOTICE

WHEREAS my clients Sh. Ram Prasad son of Sh. Janardan Prasad & Smt. Shiv Kumari Devi wife of Sh. Ram Prasad both residing at G-908, Near Siddhi Baha Mandir, Loni Dehat, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201021, has desired and declare that they have broken all family relation and disowned & debarred from the immovable and moveable properties their son Rahul Kumar and Daughter-in-Law, Neha causing mis-behaviour for ever with immediate effect, my clients will not responsible for any dealing with them.

Sd/-
Sujeet Kumar
Advocate
Chamber No-37,
Patiala House Court, New Delhi

PUBLIC NOTICE

"Be it known to all that my clients Sh. Brj Mohan S/o Late Ram Swarup and Smt. Neeraj W/o Sh. Brj Mohan, Both R/O D-869, Kh. No.669, Gali No.3, Ashok Nagar, Mandoli, Delhi 110093, have lost their confidence in their son namely Sh. Mohan and his wife Smt. Kusum & Sheetal, because of their unlawful/unlawful conduct with general public as well as with my clients. I hereby inform all of you that my clients have debarred them from their personal life and also from their moveable/immovable properties. Any person dealing with them please take note of it that my clients would not be responsible for any legal/legal/unlawful conduct of their son and daughter-in-law above named."

Sd/-
Santosh Kumar
Advocate
Ch. No. 251, Western Wing,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi-110054

PUBLIC NOTICE

The General Public is hereby notified that my client Mr. Nirfesh Bansal s/o Sh. Deep Kumar Bansal r/o 484, Gali Sheesh Mahal, Sita Ram Bazar, Delhi is absolute owner of 2nd floor (rear portion 80 sq. yds.) of property no. SP-7, D Block, Pandav Nagar, Delhi 110092 mentioned as property no. SP-7, D Block, Pandav Nagar, Delhi in municipal records (Property UPIC no. 0150714E0043400).

The original chain of title deeds, comprising 3 Sale Deeds dt. 15.05.2012, dt. 18.07.2012, & dt. 19.03.2015 are missing and not found despite diligent search. FIR bearing LR no. 584085/2026 dated 27.08.2026 has been registered with PS Pandav Nagar, Delhi. Any person finding or coming into possession of the said documents is requested to inform and hand over the same to the undersigned. The public is cautioned against dealing with or relying upon the aforesaid documents or creating any third-party interest in the said Property on the said basis. Any person doing so shall do so at his/her/their own risk, cost and consequences.

Sd/-
Manu Bansal
Advocate
5, Siri Fort Road,
New Delhi 991051880

PUBLIC NOTICE

Be it known to all concerned that my client CHHOTI DEVI W/O SRI MOHAN R/O H.No.A-26, SARWAL NAGAR, ANDREWSGANJ, New Delhi-110049 has severed all her relations & disowned and debarred her son HEMANAT KUMAR & GEETANJAN from her all moveable & immovable properties due to her Cruel nature, disobedience, bad/responsible behaviour towards my client. My client & her family members shall not be responsible for any acts, deeds done by HEMANAT KUMAR, his wife NAINA DEVI and his sons JAYESH and GEETANJAN at any point of time.

TUSHAR SINHA (ADVOCATE)
En. No-D-192/2011
Ch. No.466, Lawyers Block, Saket Court Complex Saket, New Delhi-110017

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to the General Public that Dr. Dr. Rajender Kumar, Son of C.T. Jais, who has already disowned his son, Rahul Jais, vide legal notice to him dated 01.12.2015 & public notice dated 17.09.2017, which relinquished all rights, if any, then or any of my properties. He has no authority to sell, rent out, license, mortgage, mortgage, lease or create any third party interests in any of my client's properties including space no RMT-306, First Floor, Rajendra Mahaveer Tower, B-2, METROSC Shopping Centre, Saket, New Nagar, New Delhi-110017 alongwith damages of Rs. 1 crore, within 10 days starting from the date of this notice (a criminal) will be filed against both of you and Mr. Rahul Jais, at the courts, risks, responsibilities and consequences of the persons involved. He shall of my client.

Dr. Dr. Rajender Jais
Sd/-
Rajender Kumar
Advocate
Chamber No.466, Saket Court, Patiala House Courts, New Delhi-110017

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is To Certify That Our Clients Sh. Prem Gopal Singh S/o. Sh. Purnam Lal Prem And Gaudi Devi W/o. Sh. Prem Gopal Singh R/O-E-10/0, J.J. Colony, Midpur, Paschim Purnia, Bihar-8010063, Have Severed Their All Relations From His Son & His Wife Namely Sh. Deepak Kumar & Asha Devi Respectively. They Have Also Disowned The Above Said Son & Daughter-in-law From Their All Moveable As Well As Immoveable Properties. Whosoever Deals With His/her In Any Manner, He/she Will Be Going To At His/her Risk And Responsibility. VIJAY MIRWAL ADVOCATE Ch. No. 269, Western Wing, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi-110054

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is hereby notified for the information of the general public at large that my clients Mr. SHEELA ANITA W/O MR. BHUPINDER SINGH R/O Flat No. PH-06232, Tower-C, in "ATS ADVANTAGE", situated at Ahinsa Khand-I, Indrapuram, Ghaziabad, has disowned the original documents i.e. Allotment Letter dated 24.04.2006, in respect of Residential Plot/Dwelling Unit having No. MH2 on the Top Floor in PHEZ Tower, C, known consisting of 2 Bedrooms, 4 Toilets, Living Room, Dining Room, Family Room, Kitchen, Servant Room With Toilet having a total area measuring 135 sq. ft. (291.24 Sq. Mtr) along with 100 Sq. feet open terrace in the Housing Complex "ATS ADVANTAGE" situated at Plot No. 11, Ahinsa Khand-I, Indrapuram, Ghaziabad, Road & East Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh. His Allotment Letter/MH is not traceable, for which Mr. Shilpa Khanna has also lodged an Lost Report FIR dated 01.08.2024 for the same.

Any person having any claim, right or interest by way of agreement, sale, contract, encroachment or otherwise may require to give notice of the same to the undersigned within 14 days from the date of this notice, failing which we will sue for the same, or claim, if any, with the demand of its value being waived and not binding, we are not Clients, and any person claiming, if any, shall be deemed to sue without reference to the same, if any.

Sd/-
PARVEEN KUMAR
Advocate
Seat No. 118, Civil Side,
Bar Room No. 1,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

सार्वजनिक सूचना

सर्वप्रथम को विदित सूचित किया जाता है कि मेरी पुष्पिका श्रीमती अर्पिता देवी श्री म. श्री म. अमर कुमार, निवासी नगर नं. 3302, गली नं. 4, सिव् वनी मीर, सुवर्ण पुर नं. 2, मेरी नगर, दिल्ली-110031, अपने वही पुत्र श्री दर्शन सिंह कुमवार एवं उनकी पत्नी श्रीमती लता को श्रीमती लता के दुर्घटन, गत आश्रय एवं अर्पिता हरमती के कर्त्तव्य अर्पित वत्त अर्पण करने से (Disown/De-bar) करती है तथा दोनों से समस्त संबंध समाप्त करती है। अतः उक्त दोनों का मेरी पुष्पिका को सर्वप्रथम स्वयं भविष्य की सभी चीजें को छोड़कर या वस्तु नहीं होनी। उसके किसी भी व्यवहार लेन-देन, अर्पण, भविष्य अथवा कर्त्तव्य के लिए मेरी पुष्पिका, उसके पति, वही पुत्र अथवा भविष्य का कोई संबंध उत्तरदायी नहीं होगा।

RANJAN
Advocate
Enrl. No.-D16412013
Ch. No. K-1, Ground
Floor Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi-110054

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If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to explained@indianexpress.com

• DEFENCE

INS Nipun: Key boost to India’s deep-sea abilities



The INS Nipun diving support vessel. X/@INDIANNAVY

Sushant Kulkarni
Pune, September 1

THE INDIAN Navy commissioned INS Nipun, the second diving support vessel (DSV) of the Nistar class, in Mumbai on Monday. The vessel will strengthen the Western Naval Command’s deep-sea diving, underwater intervention and submarine rescue capabilities.

What is a DSV?

A DSV is a specialised platform that allows a navy to sustain complex underwater operations for extended periods, particularly in deep and challenging waters. Naval operations often require divers and specialised teams to inspect, repair, recover or intervene around ships, submarines and other underwater assets. A DSV provides the diving systems, medical facilities and support needed for such missions, reducing dependence on shore-based facilities, and enabling quick response to underwater contingencies. The Navy undertakes extensive diving operations in the Indian Ocean Region for submarine rescue, underwater inspection, testing or salvage, and recovery of objects, ships or aircraft lost at sea. Earlier, the Navy operated Russian-origin submarine rescue vessels and relied on a mix of shore facilities along with specialised diving units and suitably equipped naval vessels. But these lacked the multidomain operational capabilities and ability of long deployments at sea. In 2018, the Navy signed a contract with Hindustan Shipyard Ltd, Vishakhapatnam, for construction of two DSVs, the first of which — INS Nistar — was commissioned in July 2025.

‘Mother ship’

Admiral Krishna Swaminathan, Chief of the Naval Staff, said at the commissioning ceremony of the 9,000-tonne vessel: “Nipun adds specialised capability to support complex underwater operations and respond to emergencies in one of the most demanding and mysterious environments known to the world.” Nipun is installed with dive equipment and can undertake deep-sea saturation diving — this denotes operations where divers live under pressure for long periods to work deep underwater. “A side diving stage has also been provided for undertaking diving operations. The remotely operated vehicles further enhance the ship’s operational capabilities by facilitating diver monitoring and salvage operations,” the Navy said. Nipun also serves as the “mother ship” for deep submergence rescue vessels (DSRVs) “to evacuate personnel in case of an emergency on a submarine”, the Navy said. Currently, India has two DSRVs. Nipun has a self-propelled hyperbaric lifeboat — a pressurised lifeboat that can independently evacuate divers and diving compression chambers. It can help in recovering of damaged, sunken or stranded ships and equipment.

Maritime preparedness

“For a navy operating across the vast Indian Ocean Region, the ability to sustain specialised underwater operations at sea is an important part of preparedness. This is particularly relevant to submarine operations, where an accident or technical emergency can quickly become a race against time,” a retired Navy officer, who has served on submarines, told *The Indian Express*.

For India, this is significant as underwater capabilities become increasingly important to maritime security. “The induction of indigenous DSVs also means the Navy is building and sustaining specialised expertise and equipment domestically, while strengthening its ability to provide submarine rescue assistance to regional partners,” said the retired officer.

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• INDUS WATERS TREATY

With India rejecting Hague court order, the road ahead



AMITABH SINHA

THE PERMANENT Court of Arbitration, adjudicating on a dispute raised by Pakistan on the Indus Waters Treaty, has passed two more orders against India. It has ruled that India’s decision to put the Treaty in ‘abeyance’ was “not permissible under the Treaty or other applicable rules of international law”, and therefore the Treaty — which governs the sharing of six transboundary river waters between the two countries — remained “fully in force” and India continued to be bound by it. The Court also directed India to halt construction work at the Ratle Hydroelectric Project, as requested by Pakistan, till the technical dispute over it is settled. India has not been participating in this arbitration process, underway for four years, having maintained that the Court was constituted in violation of the provisions of the Treaty. A neutral expert had already been appointed to adjudicate on the same issue, and the Treaty does not allow parallel resolution processes on the same dispute. As such, India said the Court lacked legitimacy, and did not appoint its two arbitrators on the Court. The Court went ahead with its proceedings with two arbitrators appointed by Pakistan, and three ‘umpires’ nominated by institutions mentioned in the Treaty.

India’s rejection

India’s reaction to the two orders on Monday was on expected lines. “This so called Court was constituted by the World Bank in patent breach of the terms of the Treaty and India categorically rejects its so-called award... India’s decision to hold the Indus Waters Treaty in abeyance remains in force,” the Ministry of External Affairs said. The two set of rulings on Monday happened to be the fourth ‘award’ from the Court of Arbitration, set up in September 2022, to adjudicate on objections raised by Pakistan over the construction of a couple of hydropower projects in Jammu and Kashmir. All the ‘awards’ have, unsurprisingly, gone in favour of Pakistan. In its earlier ‘awards’, the Court has, among other things,

• THREE LEVELS OF DISPUTE RESOLUTION IN THE TREATY

Any ‘question’ over the interpretation or applicability of the Treaty has to be addressed first by the **Permanent Indus Commission**, comprising the Indus Commissioners of the two countries.

If they are unable to resolve the ‘question’, a ‘difference’ is deemed to have arisen.

If the nature of the ‘difference’ is one of the 23 different specified kinds, this can be referred to a **neutral expert**.

If the nature of the ‘difference’ is something other than the 23 specified types, it is considered to have become a ‘dispute’, which needs to be adjudicated by a **Court of Arbitration**.

The Court of Arbitration also comes into the picture if the neutral expert decides that the whole matter, or a



An IWT hearing at the Court of Arbitration, The Hague, in April.

part of it, should be treated as a ‘dispute’, or if both the parties decide on this route at any point of time.

In the present case, there was no agreement between the two Commissioners to treat the ‘difference’ as a ‘dispute’. Nor was there a recommendation from a neutral expert that it needed to be treated as a ‘dispute’.

Also, the World Bank had set up a neutral expert at India’s request. Setting up a Court of Arbitration on the same issue was about instituting a parallel process, which is not allowed in the Treaty. It could also lead to the absurdity of the two processes producing different and irreconcilable decisions.

Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F> Council. Another alternative would be to get the Security Council or the UN General Assembly to refer the matter to the International Court of Justice.

The treaty

Under the Treaty, ‘Eastern Rivers’ of the Indus system — Sutlej, Beas and Ravi — are for India. Pakistan gets water from the ‘Western Rivers’ — Indus, Jhelum, and Chenab.

The Treaty allows India limited use of Western rivers too, but this has not been possible because of Pakistan’s objections to anything India builds on them

Road ahead for Pakistan

The best case scenario for Pakistan would be to get the UN Security Council to pass a resolution against India, framing its dispute over the Treaty as a security issue. It has been working towards that aim, and is almost sure to take a shot at it during the remaining four months of its tenure as a non-permanent member of the Security

Road ahead for India

India’s main focus is on expeditious completion of the projects that will allow it to make full use of its rights on the three western rivers — Indus, Jhelum and Chenab — allocated to Pakistan under the Treaty. The Treaty’s provisions allow India to make limited use of these waters, but this has not been possible because of Pakistan’s repeated objections to anything India tries to build on

The Court of Arbitration has no means to get its orders enforced, but Pakistan may use this to up the diplomatic ante against India at international fora

these rivers. India is pursuing eight infrastructure projects on these rivers in Jammu and Kashmir, worth Rs 50,000 crore. At least one of them, seeking to divert waters from the Chenab to the Beas, goes beyond the provisions of the Treaty, which does not allow inter-basin transfer of waters.

For India, the Indus Waters Treaty is as good as dead. ‘Abeyance’ is deliberately being used to keep it vague, since there is no provision to terminate or suspend it unilaterally.

That is the reason why India disengaged from the neutral expert process last year, which was set up on its own request. India continues to share hydrological data with Pakistan, but only through its high commission in Islamabad, and not through the Permanent Indus Commission set up under the Treaty. Continuing to participate in the neutral expert process or sharing information through the Permanent Indus Commission could be seen as utilising the provisions of the Treaty, which could be contrary to its position that it does not exist.

India has also suggested that the two countries renegotiate the Treaty. But Pakistan realises it is unlikely to get a deal as good as the current one. Also, India is almost sure to insist on a strictly bilateral agreement, without the need for any third party like the World Bank, which Pakistan is unlikely to agree to.

Sharing without a Treaty

The deadlock looks unresolvable in the foreseeable future. The transboundary rivers between India and Pakistan are most likely to continue flowing without any formal agreement on sharing of waters. There are hundreds of instances across the world of transboundary rivers not governed by any water-sharing agreement. India shares rivers with each of its other neighbours — China, Bhutan, Nepal, Bangladesh and Myanmar — and most of these have no formal water-sharing arrangement.

Keeping the Indus Waters Treaty in ‘abeyance’ does not mean India has stopped the flow of river waters to Pakistan. It cannot do that even if it wanted to. Pakistan continues to receive the river waters as earlier. It would continue to get that even after India completes all the projects on the western rivers. Though the per capita water availability has gone down due to population pressures and climate change, the Indus river system still has sufficient water to cater to the needs of the people living in its basin in India and Pakistan.

• LEGAL

Distinguished jurist: The unused route to appoint an SC judge

Amaal Sheikh
New Delhi, September 1

DECADES AFTER the Constitution came into force, one route to becoming a Supreme Court judge has never been taken. At a convocation address on August 30, Supreme Court judge Justice Ujjal Bhuyan pointed to Article 124(3), which allows the appointment of a “distinguished jurist” as a Supreme Court judge, and called it an “unused mandate” of the Constitution that “needs our serious attention.” He said that having a distinguished jurist on the bench would “diversify the Bench” and that they “would not remain constricted by narrow technicalities thereby being in a stronger position to deal with public law issues.” He said the “participation of... legal academia and scholars would have a defining impact on the judicial functioning of the Supreme Court.”

What the Constitution states

Article 124 sets out how the Supreme Court is constituted. Article 124(3) lists who can be appointed as a judge, i.e., a citizen of

India who has either served as a High Court judge for five years, practised as an advocate for ten years, or “is, in the opinion of the President, a distinguished jurist.”

The first two routes are how the court has always been staffed. Most judges have been elevated from the High Courts, while a smaller number of lawyers have been appointed directly from the Bar. The most recent was Justice V Mohana, recommended by the collegium in May 2026 and sworn in the following month. The third category, the appointment of distinguished jurists, has simply never been used.

Article 217 lays down the conditions for the appointment of a High Court judge. The 42nd Amendment, enacted during the Emergency, added a provision allowing the appointment of a “distinguished jurist” as a judge of the High Court. However, the provision was eventually repealed by the 44th Constitutional Amendment.

Where the clause came from

The clause was added during the Constituent Assembly debates on May 24, 1949, after H V Kamath moved an amendment

Appointing a judge: 3 ways

The Constitution sets out who can be made a SC judge: a citizen of India who has either served as a HC judge for 5 years; practised as an advocate for ten years; or ‘is, in the opinion of the President, a distinguished jurist’.

The first two routes are how the court has always been staffed. The third route has never been used.

saying the pool of candidates shouldn’t be “necessarily confined to Judges or Advocates.” He said that India needed a way to bring in “men or for that matter, women who are possessed of outstanding legal and juristic learning,” even if they had never practised law. He pointed out that judges of the International Court of Justice at The Hague are chosen on similar terms.

B R Ambedkar didn’t object to the idea itself. His only hesitation was over the word “distinguished”, and he wondered whether “eminent” would be a better fit. He, however, left the final call to the Drafting Committee. The amendment eventually went through.

Who qualifies & why no one has

Justice Bhuyan offered two possible explanations for why the clause remains unused. “The first is that earlier in the view of the central government and thereafter of the collegium, there is not enough depth in the Indian academia to be considered for elevation as a judge of the Supreme Court. The second is that both the central government and the collegium have not seriously explored this provision thus far,” he said.

A “distinguished jurist” is generally understood to be anyone engaged in serious work in the practice, teaching or research of law, including those who do not require courtroom experience to fit the description. But this interpretation runs into a separate problem in India, where the Bar Council rules generally prevent full-time law teachers from practising law.

A further complication is the process of Supreme Court appointments itself. Appointments today are initiated through the collegium system, meaning that a jurist would first have to be recommended by the Supreme Court collegium before the appointment goes to the government.

In an interview in 2015 with *LiveLaw*, Upendra Baxi recalled being addressed as “Judge Baxi” by a professor, who had been told by Justice P N Bhagwati that Baxi would be made a judge within a few months. That appointment never materialised. Addressing the matter, Baxi said that “the Presidents of India have been looking with a telescope and have not found any jurist worth appointing as a Supreme Court Judge” and thus called it “a dead issue.”

• NEPAL DISASTER

Why risk-monitoring in the Himalayas is like looking for ‘needles in haystacks’



EXPERT EXPLAINS

AUSTIN LORD

SENIOR FELLOW AT STIMSON CENTER

THE FLOODS in Nepal have raised fresh questions about how well the Himalayas are prepared for rapidly evolving and cascading climatic and geological hazards. **Austin Lord**, a Senior Fellow with the Energy, Water and Sustainability Program at the US-based non-profit thinktank Stimson Center, has been closely examining the region’s evolving hazard landscape. In an interview with **Nikhil Ghanekar**, Lord discusses the sequence of events, the risk of ‘hazard constellations’, and the lessons the disaster holds for Nepal and the wider Himalayas. Edited excerpts:

What was the trigger and sequence of the Nepal flood?

The present consensus is that the initial trigger was a glacial detachment that included bedrock on the northern slopes of Langtang Lirung, a 7,000-plus-metre peak in the Langtang range. The exact triggering process is not entirely understood. That could be related to climate-related risks or gradual shifts at the site. Preliminary analysis indicates there may have been some minor movement of the glacial mass in the weeks or months before the event, followed by a tipping point. Once it failed, it swept down through a gully toward the Lhende River, which reaches the Chinese border. The source area was around 5,200 metres, so the flow descended a couple of thousand metres. It deposited a mixture of ice, rock and sediment, creating a temporary natural dam that blocked the river. There is still debate about how much water came from the glacier itself, from the melting of entrained ice, and from water that accumulated behind the landslide dam. The dam failed and sent a major pulse

of water downstream. The event reached the China border in roughly nine minutes. Footage from the Gyirong border facility shows a massive dark wave containing not just water but a large volume of material. The border facility was at a confluence with another tributary, the Gyirong River. The flow then continued downstream. Within seconds of hitting the Chinese facility, it was already moving back into Nepal. There was no realistic opportunity for people at the facility to warn communities downstream; many of those who could have generated an alert were themselves swept away. The flow then destroyed dams and hydropower projects downstream, recruited additional sediment, and swept through villages along the river corridor. The event continued into Nuwakot district and affected larger market towns in the floodplain. These affected areas are well beyond the 100-year or 500-year floodplain. This was a thousand-year-plus flood event, with significant impacts extending more than 100 kilometres downstream. The flood pulse also registered at

the India-Nepal border. The larger issue is the increasing frequency and intensity of cascading hazard chains. We have seen this in Chamoli; Sikkim, with the South Lhonak GLOF (glacial lake outburst flood); and in Nepal with the Melamchi disaster. Climate risks are interacting with and amplifying other disaster risks. These events are becoming more frequent and more intense.

Was the failed glacier identified as a vulnerable site?

Several places around Nepal have been identified as high-risk areas for glacial detachment and surges. There are glaciers immediately on the other side of Langtang Lirung that are high-priority research sites. But this particular location had no red flags. Even now, we are examining whether changes could have been detected in the days leading up to the event, but that would still require knowing where to look. Monitoring every glacier and every mountainside that could collapse is like looking for needles in haystacks. You need some signal to separate from the noise.

That is why remote sensing and satellite-based analysis are important, but different satellite tools answer different questions, and you have to know where to look. To know where to look, it’s important to engage local communities. Of over a dozen extreme events in the Himalayas over 10 years, almost all came from unknown places, except the South Lhonak GLOF which was a known risk. We are beginning to identify patterns, but there is no training dataset from the Alps or Norway that can simply be transferred to the Himalayas. The Himalayas have their own context and significant data scarcity and data sparsity.

What is the broader lesson for India, Nepal and the Himalayas?

The kind of mapping exercise undertaken by India’s Home Ministry and space agencies (to monitor glacial lakes and hazards) is an absolute necessity. It provides a baseline. Nepal does not have the same level of resources, and although some mapping has been done, it is not as comprehensive. Once you have those maps, you can

begin hazard zoning and modelling. But the key is monitoring. Remote sensing and satellite imagery are one part of the triangle. The second is fixed station networks — hydromet and seismic stations. The third is localised monitoring. You need to engage local governments, disaster managers and Community Disaster Management Committees. They can collect local data, report landslides and monitor impacts after storms. You also need people who are immersed in these environments. Yak herders and fishermen can notice changes in rivers, glaciers and glacial lakes. Oral histories with elders can reveal smaller avalanches, glacial-lake floods and other events that science has not recorded, helping identify potential hotspots. When you combine the station network, remote sensing and localised monitoring, you have a better chance of detecting changes and distinguishing the signal from the noise that tells you where to look.

FULL INTERVIEW ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

"IMPORTANT"

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कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, अलीगढ़ वृत्त, लो० नि० वि०, अलीगढ़

अल्यकालीन ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

(प्रेस विज्ञप्ति) (प्रथम बार)

दिनांक: 25.08.2028

1. महामहिम राज्यपाल उत्तर प्रदेश की ओर से अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, अलीगढ़ वृत्त, लो० नि० वि०, अलीगढ़, द्वारा निम्न तालिका में अंकित विवरण के अनुसार लोक निर्माण विभाग में मांग निर्माण कार्य हेतु सुसंगत श्रेणी में पंजीकृत ठेकेदार से प्रतिस्पर्धित दृढ़ के आधार पर आमंत्रित निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदादाता किसी एक अथवा समस्त कार्यों हेतु निविदा में भाग ले सकता है। निविदादाताओं को सलाह दी जाती है कि निविदा डालने से पूर्व निविदा के लिए न्यूनतम अर्हता हेतु निविदा निर्देशिका के कलांज 6 का ध्यानपूर्वक अध्ययन कर लें।

क्र. संख्या	कार्य का नाम	प्रतिस्पर्धित की जायेगा	ई-निविदा शुरू होने का दिनांक	ई-निविदा समाप्त होने का दिनांक	पूरा निर्माण कार्य पूरा होने का दिनांक	निविदा प्रस्ताव	निविदा प्रस्ताव	निविदा प्रस्ताव	निविदा प्रस्ताव	निविदा प्रस्ताव	निविदा प्रस्ताव	निविदा प्रस्ताव	निविदा प्रस्ताव	निविदा प्रस्ताव	निविदा प्रस्ताव
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	
1	अध्यापक कक्षाओं में विविध वर्ष 2028-29 में प्रास्ताविक से सुव्यवस्थित कार्य का नवीकरण का कार्य	121.60	3.00	124.60	8.23	2028-29-1	414	12 भाग						र. पी.	
2	अध्यापक कक्षाओं में विविध वर्ष 2028-29 में प्रास्ताविक से सुव्यवस्थित कार्य का नवीकरण का कार्य	112.74	8.12	120.86	8.04	2028-29-1	414	12 भाग						र. पी.	
3	अध्यापक कक्षाओं में विविध वर्ष 2028-29 में प्रास्ताविक से सुव्यवस्थित कार्य का नवीकरण का कार्य	102.49	2.56	105.05	7.25	2028-29-1	414	12 भाग						र. पी.	
4	अध्यापक कक्षाओं में विविध वर्ष 2028-29 में प्रास्ताविक से सुव्यवस्थित कार्य का नवीकरण का कार्य	132.70	3.30	136.00	8.80	2028-29-1	414	12 भाग						र. पी.	
5	अध्यापक कक्षाओं में विविध वर्ष 2028-29 में प्रास्ताविक से सुव्यवस्थित कार्य का नवीकरण का कार्य	142.84	3.37	146.41	9.32	2028-29-1	414	12 भाग						र. पी.	
6	अध्यापक कक्षाओं में विविध वर्ष 2028-29 में प्रास्ताविक से सुव्यवस्थित कार्य का नवीकरण का कार्य	131.60	9.55	141.15	9.06	2028-29-1	414	12 भाग						र. पी.	
7	अध्यापक कक्षाओं में विविध वर्ष 2028-29 में प्रास्ताविक से सुव्यवस्थित कार्य का नवीकरण का कार्य	107.39	7.77	115.16	7.56	2028-29-1	414	12 भाग						र. पी.	
8	अध्यापक कक्षाओं में विविध वर्ष 2028-29 में प्रास्ताविक से सुव्यवस्थित कार्य का नवीकरण का कार्य	136.88	9.88	146.86	9.34	2028-29-1	414	12 भाग						र. पी.	
9	अध्यापक कक्षाओं में विविध वर्ष 2028-29 में प्रास्ताविक से सुव्यवस्थित कार्य का नवीकरण का कार्य	167.62	4.19	171.81	10.59	2028-29-1	414	12 भाग						र. पी.	

2. कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि में वर्षा ऋतु भी सम्मिलित है एवं बिजुल अपलोड करने की तिथि से 90 दिन तक बिजुल स्वीकृति हेतु वैध रहेगी।

3. वेबसाइट <http://etender.up.nic.in> पर निविदा से सम्बन्धित समस्त विवरण एवं विस्तृत शर्तें तथा बिडिंग डॉक्यूमेंट्स आन लाइन देखे जा सकते हैं तथा दिनांक 07.09.2026 से 22.09.2026 तक देखे जा सकेंगे। ऑनलाइन बिड दिनांक 22.09.2026 को दोपहर 12:00 बजे या इससे पूर्व ई-निविदा <http://etender.up.nic.in> पर अनिवार्य रूप से ऑनलाइन जमा कर दी जाएगी। ऑनलाइन प्रस्ताव सट्टिमैनल बिड दिनांक 22.09.2026 को अपराह्न 12:30 बजे खोली जायेगी।

(जान प्रकाश)

अधीक्षारी अभियन्ता

प्रांतीय खाट, लो० नि० वि०,

कालासज

(प्रभात कुमार चौधरी)

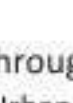
अधीक्षण अभियन्ता

अलीगढ़ वृत्त, लो० नि० वि०,

अलीगढ़

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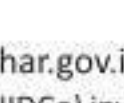
Bihar Urban Infrastructure Development Corporation Ltd.

A Government of Bihar Undertaking

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

NIT. No- BUIDCo/Yo- 3539-2026-69

(Through e-procurement mode only – www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)



Govt. of Bihar

1. Bihar Urban Infrastructure Development Corporation Limited (BUIDCo) invites bids from eligible experienced Firms/Contractors/Agencies/Bidders for execution of works as given below :-

Gr. No.	Name of work	Estimated Cost (In Rupees)	Bid Processing fees (Beltron)	Bid Document Cost (In Rupees)	Bid Security (EMD) (In Rupees)	Contract Duration
1.	Munger Water Supply Scheme under AMRUT 2.0	169,19,260.00	As per eproc 2 fee	59,000.00	1,61,20,000.00	12 Months
2.	Date of downloading of bid document	: From 05.09.2026 to 30.09.2026 at 05:00 PM Through website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in				
3.	Place & Date of Pre-bid meeting	: Date 11.09.2026 Time 03:00 PM. Near Rajapur Pul, West Boring Canal Road, Patna-800001 Query may be send only on e-mail id pdhqbuidco@gmail.com up to date 11.09.2026 Time 05:00 PM. No Query will be entertained after the last date and time of submission of queries & other than the given e-mail.				
4.	Last date and time for receipt (upload) of bids	: Date 30.09.2026 up to 05:00 PM Through website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in				
5.	Last Date and time for Submission of hard copy of EMD	: Date 01.10.2026 up to 04:00 PM				
6.	Time and date of opening technical bids	: Date 01.10.2026 Time 04:30 PM				
7.	Time and date of opening of financial bids	: To be communicated later on				
8.	Place of opening of bid	: Through website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in				
9.	Period of bids validity	: 120 days				
10.	Officer inviting bids	: Chief General Manager, BUIDCO				

All the information/corrigendum/addendum related to the project shall be published on the website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in and www.buidco.in

For any information department help line No. 18003456109 may be used

For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar

**Chief General Manager,
BUIDCO, Patna**

PR- 010880 (B & C) 2026-27



Office of the Principal
Bakhtiyarpur College of Engineering,
Champapur, Dedaaur, Bakhtiyarpur-803212
 (Under Department of Science, Technology & Technical Education Patna,)
Email-Id-bcebakhtiyarpur@gmail.com, principal@bcebakhtiyarpur.ac.in
Website-bcebakhtiyarpur.ac.in

WALK-IN-INTERVIEW FOR GUEST ASSISTANT PROFESSOR
Advt. No.- BCE/CSE/Math/2026-27/07

Bakhtiyarpur College of Engineering, Bakhtiyarpur is going to conduct a walk-in-interview for the empanelment of **GUEST ASSISTANT PROFESSOR** for B.Tech. Programme in **Computer Science & Engineering Department and Mathematics** as per BEU curriculum for the current academic session. Interested and eligible candidates may appear for the walk-in-interview with all their original academic certificates, Category Certificate, Residential Certificate, Hard copy of CV, 02 sets of photo copies of original documents/certificates, and 02 recent passport size photographs per the following schedule:-

Sr. No.	Post	Subject/ Department	Academic qualification and Experience	Date and time of Interview	Venue
1.	Guest Assistant Professor	Computer Science & Engineering	As per AICTE/ DSTTE Norms	07.09.2026	Bakhtiyarpur College of Engineering, Champapur, Dedaaur, Bakhtiyarpur-803212
2.		Mathematics		11:00 AM	

Important Instruction:-

- Essential qualifications are as per AICTE/DSTTE Norms.
- Ph.D./NET/GATE qualified candidates will be preferred.
- Retired teachers will get preference.
- This engagement will be purely temporary and remuneration-based.
- Remuneration for Guest Assistant Professor will be as per existing rules and directives of DSTTE, Government of Bihar.
- The Institute reserves the right to withdraw the partial or full advertisement/ notification w.r.t walk-in-interview without assigning any reason.
- The services of Guest Assistant Professor will be terminated without notice if found unsatisfactory. No claim will be entertained in this regard.
- No TA/DA will be paid for attending the Interview.
- Reservation as per existing state government rules and departmental letter no-897, Date-31.03.2022
- The advertisement is based on the departmental Sankalp no. 3016/Patna dated 02.12.2021

For further details please visit website www.bcebakhtiyarpur.ac.in

Principal in Charge
Bakhtiyarpur, College of Engineering,
Bakhtiyarpur

PR. No. 010933 (Sci.&Tech.) 2026-27

This information is available on website www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar also

गर्भावस्था की पहली तिमाही में माँ की एच.आई.वी. और सिफलिस की जाँच जरूर करायें।

epaper.indianexpress.com New Delhi

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, ड्रेनेज मण्डल, अलीगढ़

(E-Mail: sedrainage@gmail.com)

ई- प्रोक्वोरमेंट अल्पकालीन निविदा सूचना संख्या: 11/ एस०ई० / डी.सी.ए./2026-27

महामहिम राज्यपाल, उत्तर प्रदेश की ओर से निम्नलिखित कार्यों हेतु ऑन लाईन निविदाई (http://etender.up.nic.in) सिंचाई एवं जल संसाधन विभाग, उत्तर प्रदेश में वनीकृत श्रेणी में पंजीकृत टेकेदारों से दिनांक 19.09.2026 अपराह्न 03.00 बजे तक आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा की प्री-क्वालीफिकेशन / टेक्नीकल बिड अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, ड्रेनेज मण्डल, अलीगढ़ के कार्यालय में मुख्य अभियन्ता (गंगा) मेरठ द्वारा गठित समिति के सदस्यों द्वारा दिनांक 19.09.2026 को अपराह्न 03.30 बजे खोली जायेगी। इसके अगले कार्य दिवस में, यदि इस सम्बन्ध में कोई आपत्ति हो तो, इस कार्यालय में आपत्ति प्राप्त की जायेगी। प्री-क्वालीफिकेशन / टेक्नीकल बिड में क्वालीटीआइड पाये गये टेकेदारों की ही फाइनलेशन बिड खोली जायेगी। कार्यालय बन्द होने अथवा अवकाश होने की दश में यह निविदा अगले कार्य दिवस में उसी समय खोली जायेगी। अल्पकालीन ई-निविदा दिनांक 11.09.2026 को अपराह्न 02.00 बजे से दिनांक 19.09.2026 को अपराह्न 03.00 बजे तक डाउनलोड/अपलोड की जा सकती है। कार्य का विवरण निम्नवत है :-

लॉट सं०	कार्य का नाम	कार्य की अनुमानित लागत (बिना जी०एस०टी०) लाख रु० में	धरोहर धराशायि लाख रु० में	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि	सम्बन्धित खण्डीय कार्या का नाम	निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य + जी.एस.टी. + वेबसाइट ईण्डाईजि चार्ज (रुपये में)	पंजीकृत श्रेणी
1	2	3	4	5	6		
1	Laying C.C.Lining of Noorpur Dy. from Km. 18.000 to Km. 19.310, Parpa Mr. from Km. 6.000 to Km. 8.850, Beeghepur Mr. from Km. 0.000 to Km. 2.000, Galand Mr. from Km. 0.000 to Km. 1.230, Dhabarsi Mr. from Km. 1.400 to Km. 2.800, Kapoorpur Mr. from Km. 3.550 to Km. 3.750, Meechepur Mr. from Km. 0.000 to Km. 6.500 & Km. 1.200 to Km. 1.500 and Maholi Mr. from Km. 0.000 to Km. 0.800 in Jurisdiction of IInd Sub- div. in Distt. Gaziabad, Hapur and Bulandshahr.	502.05	10.05	09 माह	अधिशाली अभियन्ता, बुलन्दशहर खाइय गंगा नहर, बुलन्दशहर	300 + 500 + 144 + 5000 = रु० 5944.00	'एग'

विस्तृत अल्पकालीन ई-निविदा सूचना का विवरण एवं नियम व शर्तें उत्तर प्रदेश सरकार की वेबसाइट (http://upgovt.up.nic/infotech) तथा सिंचाई विभाग की वेबसाइट (http://www.idup.gov.in) पर उपलब्ध है। उपरोक्त वर्णित सूचना तथा वेबसाइट पर प्रदर्शित सूचना में यदि कोई भिन्नता होती है तो वेबसाइट पर प्रदर्शित सूचना ही मान्य होगी। यह अति अल्पकालीन निविदा सूचना बिना किसी पूर्व सूचना के निरस्त की जा सकती है। इसके लिये किसी प्रकार का कोई दावा मान्य नहीं होगा।

UPID-255270 Date 31/08/2026
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(प्रधान कुमार सिंह)
अधीक्षण अभियन्ता

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता

प्रथम मण्डल सिंचाई कार्य, मेरठ।

se.iwcl@gmail.com

ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या:-14/ एस०ई०-1/2026-27

महामहिम राज्यपाल, उत्तर प्रदेश की ओर से सिंचाई विभाग निम्नानुसार श्रेणी के पात्र पंजीकृत निविदाताओं से आनलाईन टेंडरिंग के माध्यम से नीचे दर्शाये गये कार्य हेतु निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है।

क्र० सं०	कार्य का नाम / लॉट संख्या	कार्य की अनुमानित लागत जी०एस०टी० रहित (लाख रु० में)	कार्य को पूर्ण करने की अवधि	धरोहर धराशायि 2 प्रतिशत (लाख रु० में)	निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य (रु० में)	पंजीकृत श्रेणी	कार्य से सम्बन्धित अधिकारी का पता			
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	अधि० अधि०	अधि० अधि०	मुख्य अधि०	
1	ऊपरी गंगा नहर के कि०मी० 16.1- 100 पर स्थित मृदानुराग घाट के नवीनीकरण का कार्य।	619.00	06 माह	12.38	रु० 300.00 + 18% G.S.T. निम्नानुसार + रु० 2000 रेटेशनरी चार्ज	"एए"	अधिशाली अभियन्ता, मेरठ खाइय गंगा नहर, मेरठ।	अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, प्रथम माण्डल, सिंचाई कार्य, मेरठ	मुख्य अभियन्ता (गंगा) सि०बि० ड०ग्रे०, मेरठ	
2	जनपद मुजफ्फरनगर में ऊपरी गंगा नहर के कि०मी० 100.500 से निम्नलिने वाली खलीली रक्रेष की पुनर्विस्थापना एवं सुरक्षात्मक कार्य।	1379.43	06 माह	27.60	रु० 300.00 + 18% G.S.T. निम्नानुसार + रु० 2000 रेटेशनरी चार्ज	"एए"	अधिशाली अभियन्ता, मेरठ खाइय गंगा नहर, मेरठ।	अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, प्रथम माण्डल, सिंचाई कार्य, मेरठ	मुख्य अभियन्ता (गंगा) सि०बि० ड०ग्रे०, मेरठ	
3	राजवाडा मेन चनेडा के कि०मी० 00.000 से कि०मी० 27.000 (रेन) तक नहर पुनरोद्धार, खडन्डा निम्नोष्ण, शिक विधिषा सी०सी० टाईल लाईनिंग, सी०सी० लाईनिंग य डीला निर्माण का कार्य।	531.87	05 माह	10.70	रु० 300.00 + 18% G.S.T. निम्नानुसार + रु० 2000 रेटेशनरी चार्ज	"एए"	अधिशाली अभियन्ता, मुजफ्फरनगर खाइय गंगा नहर, मुजफ्फरनगर।	अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, प्रथम माण्डल, सिंचाई कार्य, मेरठ	मुख्य अभियन्ता (गंगा) सि०बि० ड०ग्रे०, मेरठ	

बिड डाक्यूमेंट वेबसाइट http://etender.up.nic.in पर दिनांक: 14.09.2026 की पूर्वाह्न 10:00 बजे से दिनांक:-19.09.2026 की अपराह्न 03:00 बजे तक उपलब्ध है, अपलोड किये जा सकते है। इसकी तकनीकी बिड दिनांक:-19.09.2026 को अपराह्न 04:00 बजे खोली जायेगी। निविदा से सम्बन्धित अधिक जानकारी वेबसाइट http://etender.up.nic.in पर उपलब्ध है।

UPID-255275 Date- 31/08/2026
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ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या:- 15/ एस०ई०-1/2026-27

महामहिम राज्यपाल, उत्तर प्रदेश की ओर से सिंचाई विभाग निम्नानुसार श्रेणी के पात्र पंजीकृत निविदाताओं से आनलाईन टेंडरिंग के माध्यम से नीचे दर्शाये गये कार्य हेतु निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है।

क्र० सं०	कार्य का नाम / लॉट संख्या	कार्य की अनुमानित लागत जी०एस०टी० रहित (लाख रु० में)	कार्य को पूर्ण करने की अवधि	धरोहर धराशायि 2 प्रतिशत (लाख रु० में)	निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य (रु० में)	पंजीकृत श्रेणी	कार्य से सम्बन्धित अधिकारी का पता			
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	अधि० अधि०	अधि० अधि०	मुख्य अधि०	
1.	जानी एलेक के कि०मी० 0.200 पर स्थित सी०आर०सी० कम फाल का पुनर्विनिर्माण, कि०मी० 0.000 से 0.200 तक माइलिंग मरम्मत, कि०मी० 0.200 से 1.000 एवं कि०मी० 2000 से 8.100 तक आन्तरिक अग्रधान की पुनर्वसुध्ना तथा कि०मी० 8- 100 पर स्थित सुखाइयक की मरम्मत का कार्य।	861.40	6 माह	17.23	रु० 300.00 + 18% G.S.T निम्नानुसार + रु० 2000 रेटेशनरी चार्ज	"एए"	अधिशाली अभियन्ता, मेरठ खाइय गंगा नहर, मेरठ।	अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, प्रथम माण्डल, सिंचाई कार्य, मेरठ	मुख्य अभियन्ता (गंगा) सि०बि० ड०ग्रे०, मेरठ	
2.	जानी एलेक के कि०मी० 1,000 से कि०मी० 2,000 तक आन्तरिक माग में दोनो तरफ टोपाल का निर्माण तथा साइड स्लोप पर कोइटर विधिषंग के निर्माण का कार्य।	834.20	6 माह	16.69	रु० 300.00 + 18% G.S.T निम्नानुसार + रु० 2000 रेटेशनरी चार्ज	"एए"	अधिशाली अभियन्ता, मेरठ खाइय गंगा नहर, मेरठ।	अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, प्रथम माण्डल, सिंचाई कार्य, मेरठ	मुख्य अभियन्ता (गंगा) सि०बि० ड०ग्रे०, मेरठ	
3.	जानी एलेक के कि०मी० 9.200 पर फाल के निर्माण का कार्य।	845.60	6 माह	16.92	रु० 300.00 + 18% G.S.T निम्नानुसार + रु० 2000 रेटेशनरी चार्ज	"एए"	अधिशाली अभियन्ता, मेरठ खाइय गंगा नहर, मेरठ।	अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, प्रथम माण्डल, सिंचाई कार्य, मेरठ	मुख्य अभियन्ता (गंगा) सि०बि० ड०ग्रे०, मेरठ	
4.	जानी एलेक के कि०मी० 10.800 पर फाल के निर्माण का कार्य।	814.70	6 माह	16.30	रु० 300.00 + 18% G.S.T निम्नानुसार + रु० 2000 रेटेशनरी चार्ज	"एए"	अधिशाली अभियन्ता, मेरठ खाइय गंगा नहर, मेरठ।	अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, प्रथम माण्डल, सिंचाई कार्य, मेरठ	मुख्य अभियन्ता (गंगा) सि०बि० ड०ग्रे०, मेरठ	
5.	ऊपरी गंगा नहर के कि०मी० 135.550 पर स्थित भोला क्रास रेगुलेटर एवं कि०मी० 140.490 पर स्थित जानी क्रास रेगुलेटर के सुरक्षात्मक कार्य।	924.60	6 माह	18.50	रु० 300.00 + 18% G.S.T निम्नानुसार + रु० 2000 रेटेशनरी चार्ज	"एए"	अधिशाली अभियन्ता, मेरठ खाइय गंगा नहर, मेरठ।	अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, प्रथम माण्डल, सिंचाई कार्य, मेरठ	मुख्य अभियन्ता (गंगा) सि०बि० ड०ग्रे०, मेरठ	
6.	ऊपरी गंगा नहर के कि०मी० 134.530 से निम्नलिने वाली नवीगेशन चैनल के कि०मी० 0.000 से कि०मी० 2.430 के मध्य पुनर्विस्थापना एवं सुरक्षात्मक कार्य।	965.40	6 माह	19.31	रु० 300.00 + 18% G.S.T निम्नानुसार + रु० 2000 रेटेशनरी चार्ज	"एए"	अधिशाली अभियन्ता, मेरठ खाइय गंगा नहर, मेरठ।	अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, प्रथम माण्डल, सिंचाई कार्य, मेरठ	मुख्य अभियन्ता (गंगा) सि०बि० ड०ग्रे०, मेरठ	

बिड डाक्यूमेंट वेबसाइट http://etender.up.nic.in पर दिनांक: 14.09.2026 की पूर्वाह्न 10:00 बजे से दिनांक:-19.09.2026 की अपराह्न 03:00 बजे तक उपलब्ध है, अपलोड किये जा सकते है। इसकी तकनीकी बिड दिनांक:-19.09.2026 की अपराह्न 04:00 बजे खोली जायेगी। निविदा से सम्बन्धित अधिक जानकारी वेबसाइट http://etender.up.nic.in पर उपलब्ध है।

UPID-255276 Date 31/08/2026
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अधीक्षण अभियन्ता
प्रथम मण्डल सिंचाई कार्य, मेरठ।
E-mail Id: se.iwcl@gmail.com

STATE BANK OF INDIA

Authorised Officer's Details:
Name: Sri. Vivek Raina
E-mail ID: sbi.05173@sbi.co.in
Mobile No: +91-8197025366
Landline No. (Office): 080-25943678

STRESSED ASSETS RECOVERY BRANCH,
Building No.11/90, 3rd Floor, Near Old Shivaji Theatre, OPP: Trustwell Hospital, J.C. Road, Bengaluru-560002.
Contact: CCO. Sri. Dayanand Nagashetty, Mob: 9008844891.
Tel:080-2594-3678/3663. Email: sbi.05173@sbi.co.in

Appendix: IV-A [See Proviso to rule 8(6)]
E-AUCTION SALE ON 12.10.2026 - SALE NOTICE FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTY

E-AUCTION SALE NOTICE FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE ASSETS UNDER THE SECURITISATION AND RECONSTRUCTION OF FINANCIAL ASSETS AND ENFORCEMENT OF SECURITY INTEREST ACT, 2002 READ WITH PROVISO TO RULE 8 (6) OF THE SECURITY INTEREST (ENFORCEMENT) RULES, 2002
Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrowers/Guarantors/Mortgagor that the below described immovable property mortgaged/charged to the Secured Creditor, the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorized Officer of State Bank of India, Secured Creditor, will be sold on "As is where is", "As is what is" and "Whatever there is" basis on 12.10.2026 for recovery of Rs. 6,50,32,422.00 (Rupees Six Crore Fifty Lakhs Thirty Two thousand Four Hundred Twenty Two Only) as on 28.08.2026 and further interest at contractual rate from 29.08.2026 with incidental expenses, costs, charges etc. due to the State Bank of India, Secured Creditor from the Borrower: **Ms. Bhavana Jha D/o Amod Jha, Represented by: Mr. Himanshu Kumar Amod Kumar Jha S/o Amod Kumar Jha (Co-Borrower/GPA Holder).** The Reserve Price, Earnest Money Deposit and Bid increment Amount will be as under:

Property No.	Reserve Price (Below which the property will not be sold)	EMD - Earnest Money Deposit	Bid increment amount	Time & date of e Auction	Last day for submission of EMD along with KYC documents
Fiat No. B-101, First Floor "MANTRI ESPANA" at Bellandur,	Rs. 5,33,30,000/-	Rs. 53,33,000/-	Rs. 1,00,000/-	From 10:00 am to 4.00 pm on 12.10.2026	12.10.2026 up to 9.00 AM

SECURED INTEREST

DESCRIPTION OF PROPERTY (Immovable asset)					Reserve Price (Rs.)
Tender No.: SBI/SARB/166 Property ID: SBIN200050618277 Name of the Title Deed Holder: Ms. Bhavana Jha D/o Amod Jha, Represented by: Mr. Himanshu Kumar Amod Kumar Jha S/o Amod Kumar Jha (Co-Borrower/GPA Holder). SCHEDULE 'A' PROPERTY: All that piece and parcel of the converted properties situated at Kariyamana Agrahara and Devarabisanahalli Villages, Varthur Hobli, Bangalore South Taluk, totally admeasuring 13 acres 26 Guntas reduced by an area of 5526.03 Sq. Mtrs, relinquished to Bangalore Development Authority for Parks and Open Space, the details of which are as follows:					INR 5,33,30,000/-
Sl.No	Village	Sy No	Acres	Guntas	Sq. ft
1	Kariyamana Agrahara	36/1	1	21	66429
2	Kariyamana Agrahara	36/3	1	16	60984
3	Kariyamana Agrahara	37	0	4	4356
4	Kariyamana Agrahara	38/1	2	1	88209
5	Kariyamana Agrahara	38/2	0	24	26136
6	Kariyamana Agrahara	39/1	0	22	23958
7	Kariyamana Agrahara	39/1	0	23	22869
8	Kariyamana Agrahara	39/2	1	11	57717
9	Kariyamana Agrahara	39/3	0	26	28314
10	Kariyamana Agrahara	39/4	0	22	23958
11	Kariyamana Agrahara	39/6	0	25	27225
12	Devarabisanahalli	50/2	1	36	82764
13	Devarabisanahalli	51/1	1	18	63162
14	Devarabisanahalli	51/3	0	05	5445
15	Devarabisanahalli	51/4	0	12	13068
Total					594594

The aforesaid lands are contiguous in nature and as a composite property are bounded on: **East By:** Portion of properties bearing Sy. No 38/2,36/2 and Private Property. **West By:** Portion of properties bearing Sy.No.40, 50/1, 50/3 park and open space and Private Property. **North By:** Portion of properties bearing Sy.no 41, 39/5,50/1 and Private Property. **South By:** Road and portion of properties bearing Sy.No.51/3, 51/4 and 50/3.
As per Sale Deed, Annexure A :-
Building/Tower No: 'B', 1st Floor, Apartment No. B-101, Super Built-up Area (SBUA): 4010 Sq.ft. (372.677 Sq. Mtrs).
Undivided Percentage/Share of Schedule A Property: Proportionate Undivided share in the Schedule A Property
Right to use of Car Park : Four Car Park.

The sale shall be subject to provisions of the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.
For further details regarding inspection of the property the intending bidder may contact the Authorized Officer, State Bank of India, Stressed Assets Recovery Branch, Building No.11/90, III Floor, Opp. Trustwell Hospital, Near Old Shivaji Theatre, JC Road, Bengaluru -560 002 Telephone: 080-2594-3678/3663 or Bank's approved Resolution Agent, **M/s. Incio Advisory and Financial Services Pvt. Ltd., Bangalore, Representative: Sri P Raghavendra Rao Mobile No. 9900053220**
To the best of knowledge of the Authorized Officer & as per available information there is no encumbrance on any of the above said property. For detailed terms and conditions of the sale, please refer to the link provided in PSB Alliance Pvt Limited, <https://baanknet.com> and www.sbi.co.in
NOTE: Sale of property is brought under "AS IS WHERE IS", "AS IS WHAT IS" and "WHATEVER THERE IS" condition, any dues affecting the property such as Electricity bill, Water bill, pending charges with respect of Association, Transfer of E-Khatha & property tax etc., has to be borne by the auction purchaser.

Sd/-
Chief Manager & Authorized Officer
SBI SARB, Bengaluru

Date: Bengaluru
Date: 31.08.2026

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER

RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, KATAKA

E-mail:- scrw_ctc@yahoo.com

No. Tender Online RWC-14/26

e-Procurement NOTICE

1. Name of the work	>: Construction of Building works.
2. Class of contractor	>: 01 No. Special Class (of Odisha PWD) & relevant class of other licensing authorities. A Class (of Odisha PWD) & relevant class of other licensing authorities. B Class (of Odisha PWD) & relevant class of other licensing authorities.
c) Estimated cost more than Rs.6.00 Crore & upto Rs.50.00 Crore	
d) Estimated cost more than Rs.1.00 Crore & upto Rs.20.00 Crore	
e) Estimated cost more than Rs. 20.00 Lakh & upto Rs.3.00 Crore	
3. Time for Completion	>: As specified in the Column-7of the Annexure.
4. Detail Projects	>: As per Annexure attached
5. Other Details	>:

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No.	Availability of tender On-line for bidding From To	Last Date & Time of seeking Tender Clarification	Date & Time of opening of tender Technical Bid Financial Bid
Chief Construction Engineer, Rural Works Circle, Kataka	Tender Online RWC-14/26	02.09.2026 at 11.30 A.M.	18.09.2026 up to 02.00 P.M.	19.09.2026 at 11.30 A.M. Will be intimated later

Further details can be seen from the website www.tendersodisha.gov.in

Sd/-
Chief Construction Engineer
Rural Works Circle, Kataka

OIPR-25001/25097/1/26-27/0013

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय

ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल,गुमला

mail-rdsdgumla123@gmail.com

अति अल्पकालीन ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

ई- निविदा सूचना संख्या – RDD/SD/GUMLA/21/2026-27

1.कार्य की विस्तृत विवरणी: (आई०टी०डी०ए० मय)

युप० सं०	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि	अग्रधन की राशि	परिमाण विपत्र का मूल्य	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि
1	ग्राम- पुगु प्रखण्ड- गुमला जिला – गुमला में वृहद धुमकुडिया भवन का निर्माण।	4,99,72,400.00	9,99,500.00	10,000.00	18 माह

2. वेबसाइट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि – 08.09.2026

3. ई-निविदा प्राप्ति की तिथि एवं समय – दिनांक 08.09.2026 से दिनांक 29.09.2026 को अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक

4. ई-निविदा खोलने का स्थान – कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमण्डल, गुमला।

5. ई-निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय – 01.10.2026 अपराह्न 2:00 बजे

6. ई-निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता :- कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, गुमला।

7. ई-निविदा प्रकोष्ठ का दूरभाष सं० – 06524223013 (संबंधित कार्यपालक अभियंता का दूरभाष नम्बर)

8. परिमाण विपत्र की राशि घट-बढ़ सकती है तदनुसार अग्रधन की राशि देय होगी।

9. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रधन की राशि केवल Online Mode द्वारा स्वीकार्य होगी।

10.निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रधन की राशि का ई-युगतान जिस खाता से किया जायेगा, उसी खाते में अग्रधन की राशि वापस होगी। अगर खाता को बंद कर दिया जाता है तो उसकी सारी जवाबदेही आपकी होगी।

विस्तृत जानकारी के लिये वेबसाइट www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in एवं कार्यालय की सूचना पट्ट पर देखा जा सकता है।

कार्यपालक अभियंता

ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल,गुमला

PR 388763 Rural Development(26-27).D

JAPIT

Jharkhand Agency for Promotion of Information Technology

(An Autonomous body under Department of IT & e-Governance, Govt. of Jharkhand)

Ground Floor, Engineer's Hostel – I, Near Golchakkar, Dhurwa, Ranchi, Jharkhand

Phone. 0651-2401044/2401067, E-mail- japit_doit@rediffmail.com

Corrigendum-I

(Ref. No. – GEM/2026/B/7969423)

The Pre-Bid Queries/Representations shall be submitted through the GeM Portal, as per the applicable GeM Guidelines, or through email at japit_doit@rediffmail.com / ceo.japit@jharkhandmail.gov.in by 06.09.2026, against the tender for “Selection of Service Provider for Supply, Installation, Commissioning and Maintenance of CCTV Based Surveillance System at Police Stations Buildings in Jharkhand” (Ref. No. GEM/2026/B/7969423).

The pre-bid queries must be emailed in the following format (in editable Excel format):

Bidder's Request for Clarification				
Name of Organization seeking clarification	Name & Position of person submitting request along with mobile no. and email id	Address of Organization including organizational Phone, Fax, email & Single Points of Contact		
		Tel: Fax: e-Mail:		
Sno	RFP Page No	RFP Clause No	Content of RFP	Points of Clarification / Suggestion

The Pre-Bid Meeting shall be held on 10.09.2026, 03:00 PM at JAP-IT, Ground Floor, Engineers Hostel-1, Near Golchakkar, Dhurwa, Ranchi – 834004.

Bidders/OEMs may also submit their queries/representations during the meeting in hard copy or soft copy.

Bidders/OEMs who wish to participate in the Pre-Bid Meeting through online mode shall submit a requisition along with their pre-bid queries and join using their company/organization name. The online meeting link and other necessary joining details shall be shared with the concerned bidder on the email ID provided by them.

Only one representative per Bidder/OEM shall be permitted, either physically or online.

(PR-388583)

Sd/-
Chief Executive Officer, JAP-IT

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय

सिंचाई प्रमंडल बरहरवा, साहेबगंज

(Email Id – eebarharwawrd@gmail.com)

Eprocurement Tender Notice

निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना सं० F2- 01/2026–27 (ई० प्रोक्वोरमेंट सूचना)

निविदा संदर्भ संख्या:–WRD/IRR/BARHARWA-F2-01/2026-27 Dated :- 01/09/2026

1. विभाग का नाम :- जल संसाधन विभाग, आरखण्ड सरकार

2. विज्ञापनदाता का नाम :- कार्यपालक अभियंता, सिंचाई प्रमंडल बरहरवा

3. निविदा विपत्र वेबसाइट पर प्रकाशन की तिथि :- 06 / 09 / 2026

4. परिमाण विपत्र डाउनलोड करने की तिथि :- 08 / 09 / 2026 से 21 / 09 / 2026 तक

5. निविदा प्राप्त करने की अंतिम तिथि :- 21 / 09 / 2026 (05:00 PM)

6. निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय :- 28 / 09 / 2026 (03:00 PM)

7. कार्य का विवरण :-

क्र० सं०	युप सं०	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि	अग्रधन की राशि	परिमाण विपत्र की राशि	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि
1	1	साहेबगंज जिला अन्तर्गत बरहरवा प्रखण्ड के पंचायत विष्णुपुर के ग्राम बसपुर में प्राथमिक विद्यालय से पुराने क्रेटिंग तक गुमानी नदी के बाँध तट पर कटाव निरोधक कार्य हेतु 70 मी लम्बाई में Edge crating with crated toe wall का निर्माण कार्य।	5220028.80	105000.00	10000.00	180 दिन
2	2	साहेबगंज जिला अन्तर्गत पतना प्रखण्ड के ग्राम कुंवरपुर में पुराने बोल्टर क्रेटिंग से सीढ़ी घाट के आगे तक गुमानी नदी के दायें तटबंध पर कटाव निरोधक कार्य हेतु सबसे असुरक्षित हिस्से के 100 मी० की लम्बाई में edge crating with crated toe wall का निर्माण कार्य।	7890586.46	160000.00	10000.00	180 दिन
3	3	साहेबगंज जिला अन्तर्गत बरहरवा प्रखण्ड में पंचायत श्रीकृष्ण ग्राम चकपाड़ा में रेलवे ब्रिज से RCC Bridge तक गुमानी नदी के दायें तटबंध पर कटाव निरोधक हेतु सबसे असुरक्षित हिस्से के 200 मीटर लम्बाई में edge crating with crated toe wall का निर्माण कार्य।	15288744.77	310000.00	10000.00	180 दिन
4	4	साहेबगंज जिलान्तर्गत बरहरवा प्रखण्ड में श्रीकृष्ण पंचायत, ग्राम हरिहरा पुल के सामने में सिद्धी की घर से मेढवाव के घर तक गुमानी नदी के बाँधें तट पर कटाव निरोधक कार्य हेतु सबसे असुरक्षित हिस्से के 200 मीटर लम्बाई में edge crating with crated toe wall का निर्माण कार्य।	15006756.57	301000.00	10000.00	180 दिन
5	5	साहेबगंज जिलान्तर्गत बरहरवा प्रखण्ड में हस्तीपाड़ा पंचायत के ग्राम जुहीबोना में विशु के घर से इदमाह तक गुमानी नदी के दायें तट पर कटाव निरोधक कार्य हेतु सबसे असुरक्षित हिस्से के 200 मीटर लम्बाई में edge crating with crated toe wall का निर्माण कार्य।	14587190.20	292000.00	10000.00	180 दिन
6	6	साहेबगंज जिलान्तर्गत बरहरवा प्रखण्ड में पंचायत हस्तीपाड़ा के ग्राम छोटा चांदपुर में मंसिंदर से सीढ़ी घाट तक गुमानी नदी में बायें तट पर कटाव निरोधक कार्य हेतु 200 मीटर लम्बाई में edge crating with crated toe wall का निर्माण कार्य।	1547504			

SALUTE THE SOLDIER

BORDER SECURITY FORCE
Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawans on their Balidan Diwas.

CT/BB
GOPI NATH
MANNA
116 BN BSF
30.03.1965 –
02.09.1990

LANCE
NAIK
A RAJAN
104 BN BSF
20.05.1962 –
02.09.1988

CONSTABLE
SHANKAR
KUMAR SINGH
64 BN BSF
04.06.1973 –
02.09.2000

CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE

Veer Balidani
Naik
Birdhi Chand
60 Bn
6-8-1948 To
2-9-1990

DG and all ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Naik Birdhi Chand of 60 Bn, who made supreme sacrifice after being injured in a grenade attack by militants in Srinagar, J&K, on 2 September 1990. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

Veer Balidani
Lance Naik
Amba Lal
60 Bn
7-11-1964 To
2-9-1999

DG and all ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Lance Naik Amba Lal of 60 Bn, who made supreme sacrifice in a fierce encounter with insurgents in Assam, on 2 September 1999. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

Veer Balidani
Constable
Shaikh
Khairuddin
Nijamuddin
182 Bn
25-4-1983 To
2-9-2008

DG and all ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Shaikh Khairuddin Nijamuddin, of 182Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after sustaining injuries in a cowardly attack by militants at Litter Chowk, Pulwama, J&K, on 2 September 2008. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE						
Sr. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF AUTOMATED PERIMETER ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	31.08.2026 21.09.2026	20,00,000/-	www.hmscd.org.in	890299829 equipmentsgm2026@gmail.com
2	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF STREAK RETINOSCOPE ON 3 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	31.08.2026 21.09.2026	2,00,000/-	www.hmscd.org.in	890299829 equipmentsgm2026@gmail.com
3	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF DIRECT OPHTHALMOSCOPE ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	31.08.2026 21.09.2026	11,50,000/-	www.hmscd.org.in	890299829 equipmentsgm2026@gmail.com
FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeaprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in						No.48803/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE						
Sr. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HSAMB GURUGRAM	CLEANING, SWEEPING WITHIN THE NEW GRAIN MARKET PUNHANA & NEW VEGETABLE MARKET PUNHANA AND DURING SEASON IN SUB-VAR PINGWAL CLEANING OF DRAINS WITHIN NEW GRAIN MARKET AND NEW VEGETABLE MARKET AREA CLEANING & SWEEPING OF THE SERVICE ROADS ON BACK SIDE OF NEW GRAIN MARKET SHOPS & NEW VEGETABLE MARKET AND ITS TOILETS EVERY DAY AND CLEANING THE DAILY DUMPED, GARBAGE, MUD AND DUST ETC. OUTSIDE THE CITY LOCATION DECIDED BY MCD BY HIS OWN TRACTOR – TROLLEY / DUMPER ON HIS OWN RISK & COST AND MINIMUM 5 WORKERS/OWNERS IS REQUIRED FOR CLEANING & SWEEPING EVERY DAY.	28.08.2026 06.09.2026	EMD 2% FOR CONTRACTOR 21000/- AND 1% FOR L&C SOCIETY LTD. RS. 10,80,00/- (E/ MONEY ON TOTAL COST OF WORKS).	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8166392757 sargurugram.hsamb@gmail.com
FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeaprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in						No.48806/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE						
Sr. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	ONLINE TENDER FOR THE RATE CONTRACT FOR THE SUPPLY OF IRON AND FOLIC ACID TABLET (WIFS JUNIOR) PINK COLORED TO VARIOUS HOSPITALS OF GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA FOR A PERIOD OF TWO YEARS FOR GROUP B MEDICINES	31.08.2026 15.09.2026	2,30,50,000/-	www.hmscd.org.in	0172-478822 hmscdtenders@gmail.com
2	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	ONLINE TENDER FOR THE RATE CONTRACT FOR THE SUPPLY OF DISPOSABLE SURGICAL GLOVES TO VARIOUS HOSPITALS OF GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA FOR A PERIOD OF TWO YEARS FOR GROUP C	31.08.2026 15.09.2026	14,16,00,000/-	www.hmscd.org.in	0172-478822 hmscdtenders@gmail.com
FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeaprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in						No.48814/HRY

वन विभाग, पलवल में विविध कार्य करने हेतु ई-निविदायें आमंत्रित करने बारे सूचना

हरियाणा वन विभाग क्षेत्रीय वन मण्डल अधिकारी, पलवल के अधीन जिला पलवल में भिन्न-2 फोरेस्ट ब्लॉक में वानिकी कार्यो को करवाने हेतु पलवल वन मण्डल में पंजीकृत संविदाकारों से ऑनलाईन ई-निविदायें आमंत्रित की है जिनका विवरण निम्न प्रकार से है :-

Sr. No.	Year	Name Range	Name of Block	Tender No.	Particular of works	Tentative Amount	EMD. Amt.	Last date of Bid submission
1	2026-27	Palwal	Palwal	544720	Maint. of Plantation	764874	15297	08/09/2026
2			Mandkola	544726		3102039	62041	08/09/2026
3			Ghori	544729		995022	19900	08/09/2026
4		Hodal	Hodal	544733		3941731	78835	08/09/2026
5			Hassanpur	544739		1263271	25265	08/09/2026
6			Hathin	544743		2185329	43707	08/09/2026

हस्ता/-
वन मण्डल अधिकारी (क्षे),
पलवल ।

No. 48808/HRY

Municipal Corporation Gurugram NOTIFICATION

Applications have been invited from the eligible candidates for filling up the vacant posts of Medical, Paramedical and Supportive Staff in the Metropolitan Surveillance Unit, Gurugram, approved under the IDSP, NCDC program of the PM-ABHM scheme on fully contract basis.

Sr No	Name of Post	No of Age limit	Essential Qualification and Experience	Salary/Month
1.	Entomologist (Based on NOHP-PCZ's ToRs)	1	Not exceeding 50years*	Rs.75,000/-
2.	Veterinary officer (Based on IDSP Veterinary officer's ToRs)	1	Not exceeding 50years*	Rs.75,000/-
3.	Technical officer (Finance) (Based on IDSP Consultant Finance's ToRs)	1	Not exceeding 50 years*	Rs.75,000/-

Interested candidates can download the Application form from the MCG website i.e. www.mcg.gov.in and applicants are advised to attend the interview on dated 18 Sep 2026 timing (10:00 Am to 4:00 Pm) at MCG Office C1 Infocly, 3rd Floor, Sector-34, along With the filled Application Form and Relevant Original Documents. Application along with copy of relevant documents must reach the office by email i.e. adcmo@mcg.gov.in and cmo@mcg.gov.in within 14 days i.e. from 01.09.2026 to 15 Sep 2026 by 5:00 PM from the date of publication of this advertisement. For more details, please visit the MCG Office C1 Infocly, 3rd Floor, Sector-34 or MCG website i.e. www.mcg.gov.in.

Sd/-
Commissioner Municipal Corporation Gurugram.

No. 48819/HRY

CENTRAL UNIVERSITY OF PUNJAB

Ph.D. Admission Notice Advt. No. CUPB/26-27/011 Date: 31.08.2026

Admission to Ph.D. Programmes for the Academic Session 2026-27 (July 2026 Intake)

Online applications are invited from the eligible candidates for admission to Ph.D. Programme (Regular and Part Time) in various departments for the session 2026-27 (July 2026 Intake). Detailed prospectus and online application form are available at the University website www.cup.edu.in

- Date of opening of application form on the portal: 1st September, 2026
- Last date to apply: 13th September, 2026

CONTROLLER OF EXAMINATIONS

VPO Ghudda, Bathinda, Punjab Email: admissionscup@cup.edu.in Phone: 0164-2864178

Dr. Babasaheb Ambedkar Technological University

(Established by Government of Maharashtra and Governed by Dr. Babasaheb Ambedkar Technological University, Maharashtra Act No. XXIX of 2014) www.dbatu.ac.in

01 SEP 2026

Tender Notice No: DBATU/Store/various dept./E-tender/2026/4208 Date: 02/09/2026

Following tenders are invited by Registrar, Dr. Babasaheb Ambedkar Technological University, Lonere, from OEM, or authorized dealers.

Tenders details (http://www.mahatender.gov.in)	Start Date	End Date
1. Roofing work above for Civil Engineering Department in the main building. 2. LT cable laying work at different places in University Premises. 3. VNIR-SWIR Imaging System. 4. Spectroradiometer (Non Imaging System)	02/09/2026	17/09/2026

Sd/-
Registrar

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
RURAL WORKS CIRCLE : SUNABEDA
email- serwsbd2003@yahoo.com

1st Corrigendum

In continuation to this office Bid Identification No. CCERWCSBD-Online-31/2026-27 invited vide this office Notice No.4321, Dtd. 12.08.2026, partial modification of NCB has been made as follows:-

- Availability of Tender online for bidding Extended up to Dtd.22.09.2026 at 5.00 PM
- Last Date and Time of seeking tender clarification Dtd.21.09.2026 up to 2.00 PM
- Date & Time of opening of tender (Technical Bid) on Dtd.23.09.2026 at 11.00 AM.
- Date & Time of opening of tender (Price Bid) will be intimated later

All other terms and conditions will remain unaltered.

Sd/-
Chief Construction Engineer,
Rural Works Circle, Sunabeda

OIPR-25001/25182/1/26-27/0067

नीलामी सूचना

सबं साधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि हरियाणा राज्य परिवहन इन्ज्जर के अधीन नया बस स्टैंड इन्ज्जर तथा नया बस स्टैंड बहादुरगढ स्थित रोड बची हुई खाली दुकानों को दिनांक 31.03.2028 तक की अवधि के लिये क्रिये पर देने के लिये दिनांक 14.09.2026 को प्रातः 12:00 बजे बस स्टैंड इन्ज्जर तथा दिनांक 17.09.2026 को प्रातः 12:00 बजे बस स्टैंड बहादुरगढ पर नीलामी की जानी है। इच्छुक बोलीदाता नियमानुसार समय पर पहुँच कर बोली में भाग ले सकते हैं।

क्र० (दुकान का नाम)	क्र०	नया बस स्टैंड बहादुरगढ (दुकान का नाम)
1 मर्केन्डाइज की दुकान	1	फास्ट फूड की दुकान (बैठने की व्यवस्था के साथ)
2 किताबों की दुकान	2	रेस्टोरेन्ट (बैठने की व्यवस्था के साथ)
3 मीडिकल स्टोर (केवल लाईसैन्स धारकों के लिये)	3	ताजा फल व ताजा जूस की दुकान
4 नाई की दुकान	4	मर्केन्डाइज की दुकान
5 मोची की दुकान	5	किताबों की दुकान
6 यजन तोलने की मशीन	6	इंटरनेट कैफे
7 STD/Fax फोटो कॉपी मशीन बुच	7	मैडिकल स्टोर (केवल लाईसैन्स धारकों के लिये)
8 वर्कशॉप कैन्टीन	8	नाई की दुकान
9 बैंक ए०टी०एम०/एक्सटेंशन कार्डेटर	9	मोची की दुकान
	10	यजन तोलने की मशीन
	11	STD/Fax फोटो कॉपी मशीन बुच
	12	मिल्क बार- II
	13	एगो जूस बार-II
	14	बैंक ए०टी०एम०/एक्सटेंशन कार्डेटर
	15	स्कूटर/मोटरसाईकिल/कार पार्किंग

नोट:- नीलामी दिनांक 14.09.2026 को प्रातः 12:00 बजे इन्ज्जर के लिये इन्ज्जर नया बस स्टैंड पर तथा दिनांक 17.09.2026 को प्रातः 12:00 बजे बहादुरगढ की दुकानों को नीलामी नया बस स्टैंड बहादुरगढ पर होगी। बोली दाताओं को धरोहर राशी 25000/-रु० के साथ 2 एक ब्लैक चैक भी हस्ताक्षर करके नीलामी के साथ कार्यालय में जमा करवाना होगा। इसके अतिरिक्त किसी भी अन्य प्रकार की जानकारी के लिये किसी भी कार्यदिनस को इस कार्यालय के भवन लिपिक से सम्पर्क कर सकते हैं।

हस्ता/-
महाप्रबन्धक,
हरियाणा राज्य परिवहन, इन्ज्जर

No. 48790-HRY

Himachal Pradesh

Public Works Department
Corrigendum.

The online tender invited by the Executive Engineer Jawali Division HPPWD Jawali vide office letter No. PWJ/CB/TA/Tender/2026-27-3437 dated 13.08.2026 scheduled to be opened on 05.09.2026 is hereby extended as per the revised key as under :-

	Already published key	Now revised key
1. Date of on line publication	27.08.2026 at 11.00AM	05.09.2026 at 5.00 PM
2. Start Date	27.08.2026 at 11.00AM	05.09.2026 at 5.00 PM
3. Bid Submission end date	04.09.2026 at 5:00 PM	13.09.2026 at 5:00 PM
4. Date of opening	05.09.2026 at 11.30AM	14.09.2026 at 11.30AM

All other terms and conditions will remain the same.

Sd/-
Executive Engineer,
Jawali Division, HP PWD,
Jawali.

No. 3044/2026-2027/HIP

The Andhra Pradesh Mineral Development Corporation Limited

Door No. 294/ID, 100 feet Road (Tadigadapa to Enikepadu Road),
Kamuru, Vijayawada-521137, Andhra Pradesh, India
Tel: +91-866-2429999 Fax: +91-866-2429977 Email: contracts-ho@apmdc.in

E-TENDER

Selection of Agency for Operation & Maintenance of the Water Treatment Plant and Water Distribution System at APMDC, R&R Colony, Madhya Pradesh

APMDC invites tenders from reputed contractors for Selection of Agency for Operation & Maintenance of the Water Treatment Plant and Water Distribution System at APMDC, R&R Colony, Madhya Pradesh. For more information on the eligibility criteria, tender fees, timelines and other details, please visit website of A.P E-Procurement Portal (www.tenderapeprocurement.gov.in) and APMDC website (www.apmdc.ap.gov.in) and APMDC website (www.apmdc.ap.gov.in). The tender document will be available for download from 02.09.2026 onwards.

Sd/-
Managing Director
The A. P. Mineral Development Corporation Limited

Place: Vijayawada
Date: 02nd September 2026
R.O. No. 5386P/CL/ADVT/II/2021-22 Dt.: 01/09/2026

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU

0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F), email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Intiyaz Ahmed S/O Ghulam Nabi R/O Zenpura Shopian is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 174/2014 U/S 8/15 NDPS Act, of P/S Bahu Fort, Jammu. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-

Name	: Intiyaz Ahmed
S/O	: Ghulam Nabi
Address	: Zenpura Shopian
Age	: 45-50 Years

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

1. DPO, Jammu	: 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail LD	: sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3. PCR Jammu	: 0191-2605949
4. SP City South	: 0191-2430002
5. SDPO City East	: 01912433778
6. P/S Bahu Fort	: 0191-2475133

Sr.
Superintendent of Police Jammu

DIP NO. : DIP/J-9173/26 DATE 01.09.2026

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE DISTRICT

POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU

0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F), email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Rajinder Singh S/O Chail Singh R/O Famrote Ramban is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 108/2013 U/S 454/380/201 RPC, of P/S Bahu Fort, Jammu. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-

Name	: Rajinder Singh
S/O	: Chail Singh
Address	: Famrote Ramban
Age	: 60-65 Years

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

1. DPO, Jammu	: 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail LD	: sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3. PCR Jammu	: 0191-2605949
4. SP City South	: 0191-2430002
5. SDPO City East	: 01912433778
6. P/S Bahu Fort	: 0191-2475133

Sr.
Superintendent of Police Jammu

DIP NO. DIP/J-9175/26 DATE 01.09.2026

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE						
Sr. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HSAMB YAMUNANAGAR	CONSTRUCTION OF VARIOUS LINK ROADS IN THE NOTIFIED AREA OF MARKET COMMITTEE RADAUR AND YAMUNANAGAR IN RADAUR CONSTITUENCY (GROUP-J) ROAD ID 1464, 1782, 1271 AND 1273 IN DIST. YAMUNANAGAR.	27.08.2026 18.09.2026	2,94,52,833/-	https://tenders.hry.nic.in	9270010001 sonygc.hsamb2023@gmail.com
FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeaprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in						No- 48781/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE						
Sr. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HSAMB BHIWANI	CONSIT. OF LINK ROAD FROM VILLAGE KHAWA TO RUDHAN IN TOSHAM CONSTY. DISTT. BHIWANI (ID-1296) HON'BLE C.M. ANNOUNCEMENT CODE 2608 DATED 31.03.2026	CLOSING DATE 07.09.2026	1,33,35,625/-	https://tenders.hry.nic.in	01664242782 eebhiwani2025.hsamb@gmail.com
FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeaprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in						No- 48802/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA CORRIGENDUM						
Sr. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	OLD REFERENCE/ NIT NO.	NATURE OF CORRIGENDUM	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/ CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL	
1	THE ROHTAK CO OP MILK PRODUCERS UNION LTD. ROHTAK	2026_HBC_539417_1	DATE EXTENDED UPTO 07.09.2026 AT 16:00 PM OPENING ON 08.09.2026 AT 11:30 AM	vitaindia@gmail.com	9896401185 vitarohatk@gmail.com	
FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeaprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in						No- 48801/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE						
SR NO	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	PWD B&R, SONIPAT	SPECIAL REPAIR BY PDG. STG. OF 2 NOS ROAD HAVING ROAD ID I.E 9933 AND 9936 IN GANOUR CONSTITUENCY IN SONIPAT DISTT. UNDER WORK PROGRAM 2026-27 + 1 WORKS	25.08.2026 07.09.2026	983.20 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01302200575 pwd-eeop2-sonapat@hry.nic.in
2	PWD B&R, SONIPAT	SPECIAL REPAIR BY PROVIDING WIDENING STRENGTHENING AND RELYING OF CCB OF 5 NOS OF ROAD HAVING ROAD ID 12303, 6021, 12266, 2697 AND 9821IN RAI CONSTITUENCY IN SONIPAT DISTT. (UNDER WORK PROGRAM 2026-27) + 2 WORKS	25.08.2026 07.09.2026	1453.38 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01302200575 pwd-eeop2-sonapat@hry.nic.in
3	PWD B&R, GURUGRAM	HEAVY PATCHWORK ON SOHNA DAMDADA TO HARCHANDPUR VIA DAULA AND LINK ROAD TO HARCHANDPUR IN GURUGRAM DISTT. FROM KM 0.00 TO 4.760KM (ROAD ID 3091)	CLOSING DATE 05.09.2026	31.46 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01242322424 pwd-eeop1-gurgaon@hry.nic.in
4	PWD B&R, GURUGRAM	ANNUAL REPAIR FOR HARYANA STATE GUEST HOUSE, CHANAKYAPURI, NEW DELHI FOR THE YEAR 2026-27	CLOSING DATE 05.09.2026	9.04 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01242322424 pwd-eeop1-gurgaon@hry.nic.in
5	PWD B&R, GURUGRAM	ANNUAL REPAIR FOR HARYANA GOVERNMENT HOUSING COMPLEX, SHALIMAR BAGH, DELHI	CLOSING DATE 05.09.2026	21.16 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01242322424 pwd-eeop1-gurgaon@hry.nic.in
6	PWD B&R, GURUGRAM	ANNUAL REPAIR OF MAIN BLOCK INCLUDING GOVERNOR SUITE AND C.M. SUITE OF HARYANA BHAWAN, NEW DELHI FOR THE YEAR 2026-27.	CLOSING DATE 05.09.2026	9.53 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01242322424 pwd-eeop1-gurgaon@hry.nic.in
7	PWD B&R, GURUGRAM	SPECIAL REPAIR FOR IMPROVEMENT OF ROAD FROM SOHNA CITY TO DHANI SOHNA VIA NANGLI FROM KM. 0.00 TO 2.100 IN SOHNA CONSTITUENCY IN GURUGRAM DISTT. (WORK PROGRAMME 2026-2027)	CLOSING DATE 10.09.2026	108.11 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01242322424 pwd-eeop1-gurgaon@hry.nic.in
8	PWD B&R, HIS					



HUDCO held its 56th Annual General Meeting, where CMD Sanjay Kulshrestha highlighted the Company's strongest-ever operational and financial performance amid global uncertainties. During FY 2025-26, HUDCO recorded Rs. 1,64,758 crore in loan sanctions and Rs. 51,194 crore in disbursements. Its loan book grew to Rs. 1,60,724 crore, while total income rose 29% to Rs. 13,327 crore and net profit surged nearly 49% to a record Rs. 4,034 crore. Net worth stood at Rs. 21,977 crore, with Gross NPA at 1.04% and Net NPA at 0.05%. Kulshrestha also highlighted HUDCO's growing role in urban infrastructure through its Urban Invest Window, supporting sustainable, resilient and inclusive urban development across India.

TOLIC: Anshuli Arya, IAS Secretary, Department of Official Language, MoHA, GOI & Dr. Vikas Kumar, Chairman, TOLIC Delhi (Undertaking-2) and Managing Director, DMRC recently presented Trophy/Shield to T.D. Mairal, GM (HRM/Rajbhasha) along with other officials in token of appreciation for publication of 20 th edition of NBCC's Hindi In-house magazine. Additionally, during the same meeting in the Individual Employee category, Jai Ram, AGM (Finance), Vandana Ojha, Manager (Official Language), Ramesh Kumar Vaish, Manager (HRM) & Arvind Kumar Srivastava, Executive, (NBCC) have also received awards for their outstanding performances in various Rajbhasha competitions.



NTPC launches its three-month Vigilance Awareness Campaign 2026 at Scope Complex, New Delhi. Rashmita Jha, IRS, Chief Vigilance Officer formally inaugurated the campaign, which will be conducted from 17 th August to 16 th November 2026 as a prelude to the Vigilance Awareness Week 2026. On the occasion, the CVO also unveiled the revamped Corporate Vigilance Intranet page. The campaign being conducted under the theme “Probity for Prosperity” will focus on five key areas identified by the CVC: disposal of pending complaints, disposal of pending cases, capacity-building programmes, digital initiatives & contract management. Addressing the gathering, the CVO urged vigilance officials to enhance the reach, quality & impact of preventive vigilance & outreach programmes during the campaign.

REC LTD, through its CSR arm REC Foundation, has been honoured with the “GEEF Global CSR Award 2026” under the category “CSR Excellence in Sports Development & Inclusion 2026”, presented during the Global WaterTech Summit 2026 in New Delhi. The award recognises REC's continued commitment to using sports as a powerful tool for youth empowerment, inclusion and community development, creating opportunities and enabling aspiring talent across the country. REC's CSR interventions in the sports sector reflect its focus on nurturing talent, promoting inclusivity and creating avenues for youth to realise their potential. By supporting sports development, REC Foundation continues to contribute towards building a more inclusive and empowered society.



RAILTEL LTD organised the Akhil Bharatiya Rajbhasha Sammelan in Kolkata to promote the effective and progressive use of Hindi as the Official Language and discuss emerging opportunities and challenges. The programme featured the release of a special issue of RailTel's Official Language magazine, 'Tavishi', and presentations on the organisation's Rajbhasha initiatives. Sanjai Kumar, CMD, RailTel, emphasised encouraging employees from non-Hindi-speaking regions to learn and use Hindi in official work while according equal respect to all Indian languages. The conference also featured an expert session on "Artificial Intelligence and Official Language: Opportunities, Challenges and the Future", along with discussions by language experts. News-reading and Hindi quiz competitions were also organised, reinforcing RailTel's commitment to Hindi, knowledge-sharing and linguistic diversity.

CORPORATE BRIEFS



RECPDCL handed over Luhri Power Transmission Ltd, the project-specific Special Purpose Vehicle, to the successful bidder, Terralight Solar Energy Tinwari Private Ltd, on 21 August 2026. Terralight Solar Energy Tinwari Private Ltd emerged as the successful bidder through the TBCB process conducted by RECPDCL, the Bid Process Coordinator, for establishment of “Transmission system for Evacuation of Power from Sunni Dam HEP And Luhri Stage -1 HEP” on a Build, Own, Operate and Transfer (BOOT) basis. The project is scheduled for commissioning by 15.10.2029, matching with schedule of the hydro generation projects (SDHEP/LHEP-I), at an estimated cost of Rs. 839.55 crores.



SBI centre of excellence for MSME, Gurugram celebrated its first anniversary with a series of initiatives focused on strengthening India's MSME ecosystem through capacity building, research, innovation, and collaboration. The event was graced by Rajesh Kumar, DMD, Retail - Agri & SME, Shirang Ketkar CGM Credit Review Department & Satyabrata Mohapatra, CGM & Head, STU, Corporate Centre, Mumbai along with other officials. A key highlight of the celebrations was the signing of an MoU between IMI, New Delhi & the Centre of Excellence for MSME. The event also featured a high-level panel discussion on “Meeting the Credit Gap in MSMEs: Frictionless Lending and Public Tech Platforms”, focusing on technology-led and data-driven approaches to improving MSME credit access. The first anniversary marks a significant milestone in the CoE's journey towards empowering MSMEs, fostering innovation and contributing to the vision of a stronger, resilient and globally competitive MSME sector.



MPPMCL: A Memorandum of Understanding has been signed between MPPMCL and UPPCL to collaborate on power procurement on complementary basis & medium-term power banking arrangements, leveraging the distinct seasonal demand patterns of the two states. The MoU was signed by G.S. Khanooja, Chief General Manager (Non-Conventional Energy), MPPMCL, & Deepak Raizada, Director (Planning), UPPCL, under the visionary leadership of Ashish Kumar Goyal, IAS, Chairman, UPPCL and Vishesh Garpale, IAS, Secretary (Energy), GoMP. The landmark initiative has been undertaken under the able guidance of Manish Singh, IAS, Principal Secretary (Energy), GoMP that reflects the progressive and forward-looking approach of both institutions towards innovative power sector reforms.

SAIL has welcomed the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Amendment Act, 2026, notified on August 17, describing it as a significant reform for the mineral sector. The amendment introduces greater clarity and uniformity in mineral taxation and levies while addressing pending retrospective levies. For SAIL, which operates captive iron ore and coal mines, the reform is expected to improve mining viability, support investment and strengthen long-term raw material security. Increased viability and development of captive mines could also enable greater availability of iron ore in the domestic market. The reform is expected to support investment, production, mineral security and reduced import dependence.



CBol: A Retail Camp was organized by the Dehradun Region on August 21, 2026, with the objective of providing customers with information about CBI's various retail loan schemes and financial services. The special event was organized at Four Leaf Hotel, Rajpur Road, Dehradun. The program was graced by the chief guest, Kaushal Kumar, Principal, DAV along with Rajat Bajaj, Regional Head, CBI India, Dehradun and other officials. The program ensured that the customers were well informed about various retail loan schemes offered by the bank, including home loans, vehicle loans, personal loans, and other banking facilities. Approximately 50 customers participated in the camp, & loans amounting to Rs. 40 Crore were sanctioned during the event. Kaushal Kumar, appreciated the bank's customer -centric initiatives.

NBCC: The commencement of two major development projects in Delhi-NCR marks a significant step in strengthening the strategic partnership between NBCC and HUDCO. Bhoomi Pujan ceremonies were held in the presence of HUDCO CMD Sanjay Kulshrestha, NBCC CMD Dr. K. P. Mahadevaswamy and senior officials. The larger project, an Integrated Office Complex at Sector-62, Noida, entails an investment of approximately Rs. 485.20 crore, with a built-up area of 82,617 sq. m. and a 4-Star GRIHA Rating target. The second project, a Commercial Development at Kaushambi, Ghaziabad, costs approximately Rs. 34.64 crore and covers 6,400 sq. m., targeting a 3-Star GRIHA Rating. The projects combine HUDCO's financial strength with NBCC's execution expertise to advance sustainable urban infrastructure.



URDU ACADEMY organised a Mushaira on Jashn-e-Azadi at Hindi Bhawan, ITO, New Delhi. Renowned poets from different parts of the country participated and presented their poetry before a large audience. The programme commenced with Secretary Lekhraj welcoming Chief Guest Atif Rashid, former Vice Chairman, National Commission for Minorities, GOI. Haroon Hussaini and Uzair Qudusii welcomed Firoz Bakht & Abdul Majid Nizami. The mushaira was presided over by renowned Hindi poet Dikshit Dankauri, while Ejaz Ansari conducted the proceedings. The poet presented verses on freedom, patriotism, love, brotherhood and national unity, receiving warm appreciation from the audience. The program concluded with Athar Saeed conducting the proceedings with thanking all the guests, poets, organisers and audience members.



PNB inaugurated its Dedicated Stock Broker Branch in Mumbai, located opposite the iconic Bombay Stock Exchange (BSE) Building. The ceremony was attended by PNB MD & CEO Shri Ashok Chandra, BSE MD & CEO Shri Sundararaman Ramamurthy, BSE Clearing Limited MD & CEO Smt. Vaishali Babu, and senior PNB officials, along with representatives

from BSE, NSE, MCX and key stakeholders. The branch aims to provide stock brokers with seamless, end-to-end financial services and state-of-the-art banking solutions. Its core offerings include e-FDR in collaboration with NSE Clearing Corporation, e-BG, overdraft against securities and Bank Guarantee limits, supported by efficient service and strong relationship management.

BOOK LAUCH: Award-winning bestselling author Kevin Missal celebrated the launch of his latest mythological novel, Parashurama, on August 14 at Refuge, Greater Kailash II, New Delhi. The launch coincided with his birthday, turning the evening into a double celebration attended by leading figures from India's publishing and book industry. The novel follows Rama, the sixth avatar of Lord Vishnu, and marks the beginning of the Parashurama Trilogy. The event featured an engaging pop quiz, the unveiling of the book and its cinematic trailer, along with a surprise birthday cake from the Prakash Books and Fingerprint teams.



ANONITA MEDICARE LTD has received in-principle approval from the National Stock Exchange of India (NSE) for its proposed Rights Issue of up to Rs. 109.78 crore. The fund raise will support manufacturing expansion, product diversification and growth across domestic and international markets. The company reported strong FY26 performance, with revenue of Rs. 1,374.16 crore, EBITDA of Rs.515.09 crore and net profit of Rs. 342.97 crore. Anonita Medicare, which manufactures male and female condoms under its flagship “COBRA” brand, has also secured MDSAP certification, strengthening its presence in regulated global markets. The proposed issue remains subject to applicable regulatory approvals and compliances.

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement System

Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

S. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
01	RC26-46550306A	JOINTLESS GROOVED COPPER CONTACT WIRE 107 SQ.MM	400 MT	21.09.2026
02	08265434	MSDAC	197 NOS	29.09.2026
03	19261686	CONTACT SEGMENT	491 NOS	30.09.2026
04	08265470	MOTORIZED BOOM REST LOCKING BOX	1073 NOS	06.10.2026

Note:- 1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for details. 2. No manual offer will be entertained.

Tender Notice No.: 39/2025-2026 Dated: 01.09.2026 3005/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

BIHAR STATE MILK CO-OPERATIVE FEDERATION LTD.
H.O.: Dairy Development Complex, Post - B.V. College, Patna-800014
Phone No. - 0612-222853, 2220397, 2224083, Fax - 0612-2228306
Web :- www.sudha.coop Email:-COMFED.patna@gmail.com
COMFED Delhi Unit, 1st Floor, 2151/9B, Opposite DTC Depot Sadipur, New Patel Nagar, New Delhi-110008 Email:-comfedindasmilk@gmail.com

Delhi-Mktgr: 87

Dated: 01.09.2026

TENDER NOTICE
For Appointing Transporter For SUDHA Brand Pouch Milk & Fresh Milk Products
BIHAR STATE MILK CO-OPERATIVE FEDERATION LTD (COMFED) UNIT- DELHI invites tender proposal from the interested and experienced individual / firm / agency / company for appointment of transporter for distribution of SUDHA Brand Pouch Milk & Fresh Milk Product in Delhi-NCR.
The interested bidder may download the Tender Document, and detailed terms & conditions from our website <http://comfed.bihar.gov.in> from 3.9.2026 and may submit their tender in sealed envelope/ cover super scribed as "Tender for appointment of Transporters for Delhi", through Speed Post/ Courier or by hand delivery to "COMFED Branch Office, Bihar State Milk Coop Fed Ltd. C/o Harpal Singh Narula, 1st Floor, 2151/9B, Opposite DTC Depot Sadipur, New Patel Nagar, New Delhi-110008 on and before 14.09.2026 till 5:30 P.M. , both technical and financial bids shall be in two separately sealed envelopes and then both bids shall be kept in third envelope super scribing "Tender for appointment of transporter for Zone _____".
The undersigned reserves the right to reject any or all the tenders without assigning any reason thereof.
Chief Executive

NORTHERN RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/Traction Distribution, DRM's Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi for & on behalf of President of India, invites open e-tender for the under noted work:

1	Name of Work with its location	Augmentation/Replacement of Catenary wire over Delhi Division (7th Phase).
2	Approx. Cost of work	Rs. 1,80,29,018.38/-
3	Earnest Money Deposit	Rs. 3,60,600/-
4	E-Tender Bid Online Submission Period	16.09.2026 (00.00 Hrs.) to 30.09.2026 (15.00 Hrs.)
5	E-Tender Bid Submission End Date & E-Tender Open Date & Time	30.09.2026 (15.00 hrs.)
6	Fund Allocation	Capital (PH-36)
7	Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen	www.ireps.gov.in

E-TENDER No.: 09D-TRD-NDLS-2026-27 Date: 01.09.2026 3011/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

"IMPORTANT"

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कार्यालय अधिशासी अभियन्ता, लघु सिंचाई खण्ड, बरेली।

पत्रांक 549/ल०सिं०/ तालाब ई-टेंडर/2026-27

दिनांक: 25.08.2026

अल्पकालीन ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या-08/ई०ई०/2026-27

महामहिम राज्यपाल महोदय, उत्तर प्रदेश की ओर से अधिशासी अभियन्ता, लघु सिंचाई खण्ड, बरेली द्वारा ई-टेंडर पर पंजीकृत निविदादाताओं से ई-टेंडरिंग के माध्यम से शासन स्तर से स्थलों के अनुमोदन एवं बजट आवंटन की प्रत्याशा में दर प्रतियुक्त दर पर निम्नलिखित कार्यों हेतु ई-निविदा आमन्त्रित की जाती है।

कार्य का विवरण

क्र० सं०	कार्य का नाम	अनुमानित लागत: (रु० में)	अधोहर राशि (रु० में)	निविदाप्रपत्र का मूल्य स्टेशनरी -जी०एस०टी०-सहित (रु० में)	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि
1.	ग्राम पिपरिया वीरपुर विकास खण्ड, रामनगर जनपद बरेली में बडावाला तालाब का जीर्णोद्धार एवं निर्माण कार्य	5662572.00	566260.00	300+54+2000=2354.00	3 माह
2.	ग्राम हिलवारी विकास खण्ड, रामनगर जनपद बरेली में हिलवारी तालाब का जीर्णोद्धार एवं निर्माण कार्य।	2326150.00	232615.00	300+54+2000=2354.00	3 माह
3.	ग्राम गिरा खानपुर विकास खण्ड, रामनगर जनपद बरेली में दक्षिण वाला तालाब का जीर्णोद्धार एवं निर्माण कार्य।	2342056.00	234210.00	300+54+2000=2354.00	3 माह
4.	ग्राम शाहबाजपुर विकास खण्ड, रामनगर जनपद बरेली में बडा तालाब का जीर्णोद्धार एवं निर्माण कार्य।	2415885.00	241590.00	300+54+2000=2354.00	3 माह
5.	ग्राम अटा उर्फ फुन्दापुर विकास खण्ड रामनगर जनपद बरेली में बडा तालाब का जीर्णोद्धार एवं निर्माण कार्य।	4945807.00	494585.00	300+54+2000=2354.00	3 माह
6.	ग्राम बनारा विकास खण्ड, आलमपुर जाफराबाद जनपद बरेली में मण्डट के पास वाला तालाब का जीर्णोद्धार एवं निर्माण कार्य।	1935151.00	193520.00	300 + 54 + 500 = 854	3 माह
7.	ग्राम इस्लामाबाद विकास खण्ड, आलमपुर जाफराबाद जनपद बरेली में मण्डिर के पास वाला तालाब का जीर्णोद्धार एवं निर्माण कार्य।	3995611.00	399565.00	300+54+2000=2354.00	3 माह
8.	ग्राम उन्नीला विकास खण्ड, जगत जनपद बदायूं में उन्नीला तालाब का जीर्णोद्धार एवं निर्माण कार्य।	2430501.00	243055.00	300+54+2000=2354.00	3 माह
9.	ग्राम अहमद नगर रुखाडा विकास खण्ड, म्यांडा जनपद बदायूं में अहमद नगर रुखाडा तालाब का जीर्णोद्धार एवं निर्माण कार्य।	2803846.00	280385.00	300+54+2000=2354.00	3 माह
10.	ग्राम डिरिया विकास खण्ड, आसफपुर जनपद बदायूं में तिरिया तालाब का जीर्णोद्धार एवं निर्माण कार्य।	2484803.00	248485.00	300+54+2000=2354.00	3 माह
11.	ग्राम नरखेडा विकास खण्ड, सालापुर जनपद बदायूं में उकरी का तालाब का जीर्णोद्धार एवं निर्माण कार्य।	4161220.00	416125.00	300+54+2000=2354.00	3 माह
12.	ग्राम सिरौली प्रथम विकास खण्ड, अम्बियापुर जनपद बदायूं में कटाव तालाब का जीर्णोद्धार एवं निर्माण कार्य।	3318542.00	331855.00	300+54+200=2354.00	3 माह
13.	ग्राम सिरौली द्वितीय विकास खण्ड, अम्बियापुर जनपद बदायूं में सिरौली तालाब का जीर्णोद्धार एवं निर्माण कार्य।	3226633.00	322665.00	300+54+200=2354.00	3 माह

बिड डाक्यूमेंट <http://etender.up.nic.in> पर दिनांक 16.09.2026 से दिनांक 26.09.2026 तक उपलब्ध रहेगी जो कि दिनांक 16.09.2026 को प्रातः 10:00 बजे से दिनांक 26.09.2026 के अपरान्ह 5:00 बजे तक अपलोड किये जा सकते हैं। इसकी तकनीकी बिड दिनांक 29.09.2026 को पूर्वाह्न 11:00 बजे से खोली जायेगी वदोपरान्त तकनीकी बिड में पात्र निविदादाताओं की फाईनेशियल बिड कायालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, लघु सिंचाई वृत्त, बी०डी०ए० कॉम्प्लेक्स, तृतीय तल, प्रियदर्शनी नगर, बरेली में निविदा समिति द्वारा उपस्थित निविदादाताओं अथवा उनके द्वारा अधिकृत प्रतिनिधियों के समक्ष अतिराल्धन खोली जायेगी। उक्त तिथि में अवकाश घोषित होने पर कार्यवाही अगले कार्य दिवस में तत्समय की जायेगी। ई०निविदा से सम्बन्धित अधिक जानकारी वेबसाइट <http://etender.up.nic.in> तथा अधोदस्तावेजों के कार्यालय से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

(मनोज अग्रवाल)
अधिशासी अभियन्ता,
लघु सिंचाई खण्ड,
बरेली।

UPID-255257 Date 31/08/2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

कार्यालय अधिशासी अभियन्ता, लघु सिंचाई खण्ड, बरेली।					
पत्रांक 555/ल०सिं०/रेन वाटर हार्वेस्टिंग/ई-निविदा/ 2026-27			दिनांक 25.08.2026		
अल्पकालीन ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या-11/2026-27					
महामहिम राज्यपाल महोदय, उत्तर प्रदेश की ओर से अधिशासी अभियन्ता, लघु सिंचाई खण्ड, बरेली द्वारा जनपद बरेली में रूफ टॉप रेन वाटर हार्वेस्टिंग प्रणाली की स्थापना के कार्य हेतु ई-टेंडर पर पंजीकृत निविदादाताओं से ई-टेंडरिंग के माध्यम से शासन स्तर से बजट एवं स्थलों के अनुमोदन की प्रत्याशा में दर प्रतिस्थित दर पर निम्नलिखित कार्यों हेतु ई-निविदा आमन्त्रित की जाती है।					
कार्य का विवरण					
क्र० सं०	कार्य का नाम	कार्य की लागत (रु० में)	धरोहर धनराशि (रु० में)	निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य जी०एस०टी० एवं स्टैम्पों सहित	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि
1.	कलस्टर-1 (सामान्य श्रेणी) 1. प्रा०वि० / उच्च प्रा०वि० ग्राम दिनारा वि०ख० फतेगंज पं०। 2. प्रा०वि० ग्राम नवीन नगर वि०ख० कपरा। 3. पंचायत पर ग्राम मानपुर चिकिटिया वि०ख० कपरा।	757722.00	75775.00	225 + 41 + 500 = 766.00	एक माह
2.	कलस्टर-2 (सामान्य श्रेणी) 1. प्रा०वि० ग्राम खनवाहा श्याम वि०ख० मंडगवा। 2. प्रा०वि० ग्राम खैलम देह जगह वि०ख० मंडगवा। 3. प्रा०वि० ग्राम मंठा कल्यानपुर वि०ख० मंडगवा। 4. प्रा० वि० ग्राम कसुगई वि०ख० मंडगवा।	943782.00	94380.00	225 + 41 + 500 = 766.00	एक माह
3.	कलस्टर-3 (सामान्य श्रेणी) 1. प्रा० वि० ग्राम सगरी वि०ख० आलमपुर जाफराबाद। 2. प्रा०वि० ग्राम हिम्मतपुर ताहपुर (डुमुकपुर) वि०ख० आलमपुर जाफराबाद। 3. प्रा०वि० ग्राम जाफराबाद। नौगंपुर (साकपुर) वि०ख० आलमपुर जाफराबाद। 4. प्रा०वि० उ०प्रा०वि० (कम्पोजिट) ग्राम मकन्दपुर वि०ख० आलमपुर जाफराबाद।	965337.00	96535.00	225 + 41 + 500 = 766.00	एक माह
4.	कलस्टर-4 (सामान्य श्रेणी) 1. प्रा०वि० ग्राम भूडा वि०ख० आलमपुर जाफराबाद। 2. प्रा०वि० ग्राम भरतना वि०ख० आलमपुर जाफराबाद। 3. प्रा०वि० ग्राम हरौमपुर वि०ख० आलमपुर जाफराबाद। 4. प्रा०वि० उ०प्रा०वि० (कम्पोजिट) ग्राम सिंघा वि०ख० आलमपुर जाफराबाद। 5. प्रा० वि० ग्राम ककरी वि०ख० आलमपुर जाफराबाद।	1221736.00	122175.00	225 + 41 + 500 = 766.00	एक माह
5.	कलस्टर-5 (सामान्य श्रेणी) 1. पंचायत पर ग्राम गुलडिया अलि वि०ख० रामनगर। 2. पंचायत पर ग्राम कल्यानपुर वि०ख० रामनगर। 3. पंचायत पर ग्राम पन्था वि०ख० रामनगर। 4. प्रा०वि० ग्राम पन्था वि०ख० रामनगर।	871513.00	87155.00	225 + 41 + 500 = 766.00	एक माह
6.	कलस्टर-6 (अनु०जा० श्रेणी) 1. पंचायत पर ग्राम राहपुर जागर वि०ख० फतेहगंज प०। 2. प्रा०वि० (कम्पोजिट वि०) ग्राम रास वि०ख० सेराइ। 3. उच्च प्रा० वि० ग्राम खैलि वि०ख० भोजपुर।	605415.00	605445.00	225 + 41 + 500 = 766.00	एक माह
7.	कलस्टर-7 (अनु०जा० श्रेणी) 1. उच्च प्रा० वि० ग्राम उदयपुर जसरतपुर वि०ख० बिधरीचैनपुर। 2. प्रा०वि० ग्राम श्यामनगर गौटिया वि०ख० बिधरी चैनपुर। 3. पूर्व मानवि० ग्राम बारोनाला वि०ख० कपरा। 4. प्रा०वि० ग्राम बारोनाला वि०ख० कपरा।	984167.00	98420.00	225 + 41 + 500 = 766.00	एक माह
8.	कलस्टर-8 (अनु०जा० श्रेणी) 1. पंचायत पर ग्राम भीखमपुर ईशिवपुरी वि०ख० फरीदपुर। 2. प्रा०वि० ग्राम सरैदा वि०ख० फरीदपुर।	442266.00	44230.00	150 + 27 + 500 = 677.00	एक माह
9.	कलस्टर-9 (अनु०जा० श्रेणी) 1. प्रा० वि० ग्राम पंचपुर (खनवाश्याम) वि०ख० मंडगवा 2. प्रा० वि० ग्राम ईचौर बुतानगर वि०ख० मंडगवा 3. पंचायत पर ग्राम हकिवा वि०० मंडगवा 4. उच्च प्रा० वि० ग्राम रुखाडा वि०ख० मंडगवा 5. प्रा० वि० ग्राम रुखाडा वि०ख० मंडगवा	1005145.00	100520.00	225 + 41 + 500 = 766.00	एक माह
10.	कलस्टर-10 (अनु०जा० श्रेणी) 1. प्रा० वि० ग्राम मकन्दपुर धाराजी वि०ख० आलमपुर जाफराबाद। 2. प्रा० वि० ग्राम कुण्डा वि०ख० आलमपुर जाफराबाद। 3. प्रा०वि० उ०प्रा०वि० (कम्पोजिट) ग्राम नाला वि०ख० आलमपुर जाफराबाद। 4. प्रा०वि० उ०प्रा०वि० (कम्पोजिट) ग्राम प्रेमराजपुर वि०ख० आलमपुर जाफराबाद। 5. प्रा० वि० ग्राम भोजपुर वि०ख० आलमपुर जाफराबाद।	1260882.00	126090.00	225 + 41 + 500 = 766.00	एक माह
11.	कलस्टर-11 (अनु०जा० श्रेणी) 1. प्रा० वि० ग्राम सारा वि०ख० आलमपुर जाफराबाद। 2. प्रा० वि० ग्राम बलिया वि०ख० आलमपुर जाफराबाद। 3. प्रा० वि० ग्राम अलीनगर वि०ख० आलमपुर जाफराबाद। 4. प्रा० वि० ग्राम महारा वि०ख० आलमपुर जाफराबाद। 5. प्रा० वि० ग्राम इस्लामाबाद वि०ख० आलमपुर जाफराबाद।	1193140.00	119315.00	225 + 41 + 500 = 766.00	एक माह
12.	कलस्टर-12 (अनु०जा० श्रेणी) 1. प्रा० वि० ग्राम कुसारी वि०ख० आलमपुर जाफराबाद। 2. प्रा० वि० ग्राम बाकनरगंज वि०ख० आलमपुर जाफराबाद। 3. प्रा० वि० ग्राम फिजजपुर वि०ख० आलमपुर जाफराबाद। 4. प्रा० वि० ग्राम बनारा वि०ख० आलमपुर जाफराबाद। 5. प्रा० वि० ग्राम फतेहपुर सततु वि०ख० आलमपुर जाफराबाद। 6. प्रा० वि० ग्राम नितोई वि०ख० आलमपुर जाफराबाद।	1387963.00	138800.00	225 + 41 + 500 = 766.00	एक माह
13.	कलस्टर-13 (अनु०जा० श्रेणी) 1. पंचायत पर ग्राम ताखा उर्फ सुकिटिया वि०ख० रामनगर 2. पंचायत पर ग्राम चकनपुर चही वि०ख० रामनगर 3. प्रा० वि० ग्राम इस्लामपुर दलीपुर वि०ख० रामनगर 4. उ०प्रा० वि० ग्राम इस्लामपुर दलीपुर वि०ख० रामनगर 5. पंचायत पर ग्राम जगतीरा वि०ख० रामनगर 6. जु०हाई स्कूल ग्राम खुईदलपनपुर वि०ख० मीरगंज	1269788.00	126980.00	225 + 41 + 500 = 766.00	एक माह

बिड डाक्यूमेंट <http://etender.up.nic.in> पर दिनांक 16.09.2026 से दिनांक 20.09.2026 तक उपलब्ध रहेगी, जो कि दिनांक 16.09.2026 को प्रातः 10:00 बजे से दिनांक 26.09.2026 के अपरान्ह 05:00 बजे तक अपलोड किये जा सकते हैं। इसकी तकनीकी बिड दिनांक 29.09.2026 को पूर्वाह्न 11:00 बजे से खोली जायेगी वदोपरान्त तकनीकी बिड में पात्र निविदादाताओं की फाईनेशियल बिड कायालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, लघु सिंचाई वृत्त, बी०डी०ए० कॉम्प्लेक्स, तृतीय तल, प्रियदर्शनी

‘Really excited’: Stokes joins BBL franchise



Ben Stokes. REUTERS

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 1

FORMER ENGLAND cricketer Ben Stokes has announced that he will play for the Big Bash League team Adelaide Strikers for the upcoming 2026/27 season. The 35-year-old, who has recently retired from the red-ball game, is reportedly going to become one of the highest-paid players at rupees 3,39,01,850 (£264,000).

“I’m really excited to be joining the Adelaide Strikers for BBL16,” Stokes said in a statement. “Adelaide Oval is an incredible place to play cricket, the Big Bash is a fantastic competition, and the Strikers have an exciting group, so I’m looking forward to meeting the players, getting stuck in and contributing to a successful season.”

Adelaide Strikers are coached by former Australian skipper Tim Paine, who was delighted about the addition of England’s all-rounder. “Ben is one of the greatest all-rounders the game has seen, a proven match-winner and a competitor who thrives under pressure,” Paine said. “We’re thrilled to have a player of his ability join our squad and can’t wait to see him put on a show in BBL16.”

Stokes shocked the cricketing world when he announced his retirement from international cricket in June, bringing an end to his storied career during the home series against New Zealand. He was in the eye of a storm before he announced his retirement after being involved in an altercation with a Saracens rugby player in a nightclub alongside teammate Gus Atkinson after the first Test at Lord’s.

While England team director Rob Key has recently suggested the door would remain open for Stokes to make a dramatic return ahead of next summer’s Ashes, the all-rounder made it clear he has no intention of reversing his decision.

THREE-MATCH T20I SERIES

Indian squad for Afghan series has many asterisks

Selectors pick Bumrah, Nitish, Washington and Harshit; none have passed fitness test

Shankar Narayan
Mumbai, September 1

FOUR ASTERISKS in India’s squad for the three-match T20I series against Afghanistan tell their own story. Jasprit Bumrah, Washington Sundar, Nitish Kumar Reddy and Harshit Rana have all been picked, but none is certain to play yet. All four will need fitness clearance.

Selectors have picked recovering players in the past when they were close to returning. But with four players still awaiting clearance, there is plenty of uncertainty around India’s squad for a three-match home series, especially when other options are available.

Bumrah is the biggest name on the list. He injured his left knee during the second ODI against England in Cardiff in July and has not played since. Washington suffered a hamstring injury during the same ODI series, while Nitish missed the UK and Zimbabwe tours with a quadriceps injury. Harshit’s injury troubles go further back. A knee injury required surgery and ruled him out of the T20 World Cup before he suffered another setback on the UK tour.

Encouragingly, Varun Chakaravathy, who suffered a hamstring injury during the T20I series in England in July and subsequently missed the Zimbabwe tour, has returned to the squad.

India play Afghanistan in Delhi on September 13, 15 and 17. Later in the month, they travel to Japan to defend their Asian Games gold medal, with the men’s cricket competition beginning on September 24. The Afghanistan series could therefore serve as useful preparation for players likely to be needed at the Asian Games.



Jasprit Bumrah last played a T20I match at the 2026 WC. CREIMAS

There is also a recent example of players picked subject to fitness clearance eventually missing a series. Bumrah and Sai Sudharsan were both named in India’s squad for the two-Test series in Sri Lanka, with their selection subject to fitness clearance. Neither recovered in time to make the tour.

Mayank misses out

That is what makes the latest selection interesting. It makes sense to wait for an established player to regain fitness for a major tournament. But for a bilateral T20I series, India have options to look elsewhere.

Mayank Yadav is one of them. The pacer had an encouraging tour of Zimbabwe in July, when India swept the T20I series 3-0. Mayank took five wickets in three matches. The numbers don’t tell the whole story. He bowled with high pace, troubled batsmen with his speed and finished with 3/29 in the final T20I.

For someone whose young career has repeatedly been interrupted by injuries, simply getting through three international matches was important. Zimbabwe gave Mayank a

Shreyas Iyer will make his home debut as India’s T20 captain, with Tilak Varma his deputy, while Vaibhav Sooryavanshi retains his place after an excellent Zimbabwe tour.

chance to return to the India side and show that his pace was still there.

Afghanistan could have been the next step. Another three matches would have given India a longer look at him while allowing Mayank to build on his return. There is no question over what Bumrah brings to the side. Washington, Nitish and Harshit also give India different options. The selectors may have received positive updates about their recovery and expect all four to be fit by September 13.

Iyer’s home debut

If they are cleared to play, there will be little reason for concern. But for now, four of the 15 players picked are not

certain to be available. If there is still doubt over their fitness, India could have used these three games to give someone like Mayank another opportunity. With other players available, the question is: why pick four players who are not yet certain to be fit?

The rest of the squad paints a familiar picture. Shreyas Iyer will make his home debut as India’s T20 captain, with Tilak Varma his deputy, while Vaibhav Sooryavanshi retains his place after an excellent Zimbabwe tour. Sanju Samson returns and is one of two wicket-keepers alongside Ishan Kishan. Abhishek Sharma, Shivam Dube, Axar Patel, Ravi Bishnoi and Arshdeep Singh make up the rest of the squad.

INDIA’S SQUAD: Shreyas Iyer [C], Abhishek Sharma, Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, Sanju Samson [WK], Ishan Kishan [WK], Tilak Varma [VC], Shivam Dube, Nitish Kumar Reddy*, Axar Patel, Washington Sundar*, Varun Chakaravathy, Ravi Bishnoi, Jasprit Bumrah*, Arshdeep Singh, Harshit Rana*
*SUBJECT TO FITNESS CLEARANCE

Pak cricket hits rock bottom: Chaos continues as selector Misbah resigns; ‘This is a social media team’

Express News Service
Mumbai, September 1

PAKISTAN HAVE sent seven players and two coaches home mid-series, ahead of the third and final Test against England at Edgbaston. It came after back-to-back defeats, an innings-and-103-run loss at Headingley and a 194-run surrender at Lord’s, handing England an unbeatable 2-0 lead.

Mohammad Rizwan, Imam-ul-Haq, Salman Ali Agha, Ali Usman, Aamer Jamal, Awaiz Zafar and Khuram Shahzad have all been released, alongside head coach Sarfaraz Ahmed and bowling coach Umar Gul. New Zealander Mike Hesson, already Pakistan’s white-ball head coach, takes over the Test side for the rest of the tour, with Ashley Noffke as his bowling coach. Five uncapped players have been added, along with Saim Ayub and Abdullah Fazal, whose combined Test experience runs to 10 matches.

Misbah-ul-Haq has since resigned from Pakistan’s selection committee, a day after the axings spree, and stepped down as batting consultant at the National Cricket Academy too. *Cricinfo* reports the PCB served the four-member panel a formal notice the same day, seeking an explanation within 24 hours for the selections of Rizwan and Imam on the West Indies and England tours.

20 games, 15 losses

Pakistan arrived in England already bottom of the WTC table. The Lord’s defeat was their 15th loss in 20 Tests, and their tenth away defeat in 11 games. They are yet to reach 200 in any innings this series; their closest attempt was Saud Shakeel’s 97 at Lord’s.

Usman’s axing has drawn particular scrutiny. He took a five-wicket haul at Headingley, the first visiting spinner to do so there since 1972, and his series average of 25.17 is still the second-lowest of any touring specialist spinner in England since Muttiah Muralitharan’s in 2006. Rizwan has faced criticism over a string of reckless dismissals through the tour. Imam suffered a low-grade calf tear at Lord’s, and was criticised both for not batting in either in-



Misbah-ul-Haq resigned from his post of selector. ICC/X

nings and for a painful, heavily strapped session of throwdowns on the outfield before Day 4.

Former captain Shahid Afridi called it “the most shocking decision ever by a selection committee which includes so many experienced selectors,” questioning both the timing and the logic of picking T20 specialists for an English Test. “Even the replacements make no sense,” he wrote. “What is this thinking and approach?”

On the Pakistan *YouTube* show *Game Plan*, former batter Basit Ali called the episode symptomatic of a dressing room now run by its own leaks. “*Ye social media ki team hai, yaar*” (This is a social media team, mate), he said.

He pointed to the panel’s own experience: “*Isse zyada matches khelne wali selection committee koi bhi nahi aayi*” (No selection committee with more combined match experience than this one has ever existed), before warning that if six players go and Pakistan still lose, critics would call it the worst selection committee in Pakistan’s history. On Abdullah Fazal, ruled unfit and sent home before the tour, Basit asked: “*Unfit hoke jo aaya hai, kya wo fit ho gaya? Kahan hai uski fitness report?*” (He came back after being ruled unfit, so has he become fit now? Where’s his fitness report?)

Kamran Akmal picked up from there, arguing the board should either overhaul the entire committee or make no changes at all. Basit named what he called Pakistan’s single biggest decision, predating this



“The most shocking decision ever by a selection committee which includes so many experienced selectors. Even the replacements make no sense. What is this thinking and approach?”

SHAHID AFRIDI,
ON EXPERIENCED SELECTORS
ASKING 7 PAK PLAYERS TO RETURN

tour entirely. “*Sabse bada faisla Pakistan ki cricket ki tabahki ka bataun aay? Jab Shaheen Shah Afridi aur Babar Azam mein daraar padi captaincy ki wajah se. Us din se Pakistan ki team kharab ho gayi*” (Let me tell you the single biggest decision behind the ruin of Pakistan cricket: when the rift developed between Shaheen Shah Afridi and Babar Azam over the captaincy. Pakistan’s team fell apart from that day), he said. Pakistan currently field three different captains: Babar in Tests, Shaheen in ODIs, Agha in T20Is.

Kamran was the one to say plainly what the selectors hadn’t. “*Bas itna keh de ki yeh hamari recommendation nahi hai. Hum is pe khush nahi hain*” (Just say plainly that this isn’t our recommendation, and that we’re not happy about it), he said. He traced what made Pakistan’s past captains, Imran Khan, Wasim Akram, and Waqar Younis among them, strong: a willingness to fight for the team over themselves. “*Ahmed Shehzad ko jaana tha, gaya. Kamran ko jaana tha, gaya*” (Ahmed Shehzad had to go, he went. I had to go, I went), he said, recalling his own axing among others dropped for the team’s sake.

The Edgbaston Test begins on September 9.

{ DULEEP TROPHY }

With Hamilton’s tattoo & Kohli’s advice, Sangwan makes the opportunity count

Shuvaditya Bose
New Delhi, September 1

COACH DEVENDRA Sharma seldom starts his day by sending WhatsApp messages. On Tuesday, though, he did.

“Today will be the most important innings of your career so far. *Lamba khelna hai* (play long),” read his message to his student, Sanat Sangwan.

Sharma had reason to invest such weight in a message. A year ago, his most famous protégé, Rishabh Pant, had wandered into the nets at Sonnet Cricket Club in Delhi and asked who the next big talent might be. The coach pointed to a left-hander.

“That’s Sanat Sangwan,” he said. “Remember the name. You’ll see him in the Indian team one day.”

Sanat has not disappointed his coach since. In the 2025-26 Ranji Trophy, Sanat finished third on the batting charts, with 828 runs. But no knock carried the weight of Tuesday’s assignment. South Zone held a 117-run first-innings lead in the Duleep Trophy semi-final. The result seemed a foregone conclusion, but Sanat’s 76 at least ensured that the game reached the fourth day.

He arrived with a tattoo on his left arm — ‘Still I rise’ — borrowed from the back of a Formula 1 driver he has never met, but has studied like scripture.

“I am a huge Lewis Hamilton fan,” Sanat had told *The Indian Express* during the Delhi Premier League. “I don’t



Sanat Sangwan scored 76 for North Zone on Tuesday. PTI

know him personally, but watching his interviews, you can figure out that he is calm yet focused. I have tried to emulate him.”

Slow and steady

The control was visible at the Centre of Excellence in Bengaluru. Sanat scored 21 off his first 49 deliveries. It was not until the 50th delivery that he hit an attacking shot.

“I have a few self-imposed rules. I don’t play any cover drives in the first hour of the game. I also leave all deliveries that are well outside off-stump. After five to six overs, the bowler inevitably gets frustrated and tries to experiment. That is when the loose balls start coming.”

His next 50 balls yielded 35 runs, proof that the theory works. Sharma was not surprised. “*Thehraav usme bachpan se hi hai* (he has been tranquil ever since he was a kid). When

his father first brought him to the academy, a couple of things stood out. Lefties always look graceful when in full flow, but there was something about his strokeplay that was so pleasing to the eye. He also worked extremely hard. We got him to play a tournament, and he scored seven or eight centuries in 10 matches. I knew immediately that *yeh lambi race ka ghoda hai* (he is in it for the long run),” Sharma tells this paper.

The longer format has long allured the 25-year-old.

“Red-ball cricket has always been my favourite format. This is the toughest format because it tests both skill and patience. From an opener’s perspective, there are so many challenges one has to deal with, both with the new and the older ball,” he had said.

The love, though, has come at a cost. “In Delhi, we mostly play

The control was visible at the CoE in Bengaluru. Sanat scored 21 off his first 49 deliveries. It was not until the 50th delivery that he hit an attacking shot.

40-over games, and you are expected to score quickly. Sanat would take his time, and whenever he played out a maiden over, someone would shout, *‘ya to maar, ya out hoja’* (either hit or get out). We had to take him to Jaipur, where they play more long-format games, and there’s no crowd pressure,” shares Sharma.

Two dreams have long occupied Sanat’s mind — an India Test cap, and a conversation with Hamilton. A third dream, once distant, has already come true.

“Virat Kohli has been my idol since childhood. As a child, I loved how he used to rescue India from precarious positions. It was a dream to meet him.”

Sanat got more than just a meeting. In February 2025, he batted alongside Kohli in a Ranji Trophy fixture, which remains the latter’s last tryst with the red ball.

“When I first met him, I had a picture in my mind of this ultra-aggressive cricketer. But the version that I got to see was totally different. He was so humble, so down to earth. I asked for his bat, and he was kind enough to give it to me.”

In tricky chase, Ishan shows his chops

Shankar Narayan
Mumbai, September 1

ISHAN KISHAN walked in with East Zone 93/3, needing another 66 runs to reach the Duleep Trophy final. Harsh Dubey was getting plenty of turn and bounce; Central Zone had sensed an opening, and the chase no longer looked straightforward.

Kishan responded by taking on the bowler who posed the biggest threat. In the 31st over, the East Zone captain reverse-swept the left-arm spinner for four before stepping down the pitch and launching him over long-on for six.

It stood out because the other batsmen had struggled against Dubey. Virat Singh had fallen trying to sweep him once too often, gloving a ball to leg slip, although replays showed the ball had struck the glove that was not holding the bat. Kumar Kushagra and Anukul Roy would soon fall to Dubey off successive deliveries.

Kishan, though, looked comfortable. He played well off both feet, stepped out when he saw the chance to attack and backed it up with solid defence. Against Aryan Pandey, he punished a short ball, pulling it firmly to the boundary.

Even as Kishan settled in, others around him struggled. Kushagra, on 22, got an edge while trying to work Dubey into the leg side, whereupon Yash Rathod took the catch at silly point. The next delivery was better. Dubey got one through Roy’s defence and onto the stumps. Suddenly, East were 124/5 and still needed 35.

Kishan’s innings was not a boundary-filled assault, but East did not need one. He fin-



East Zone skipper Ishan Kishan remained unbeaten on 39. PTI

ished unbeaten on 39 off 41 balls, with four fours and a six. With wickets falling around him, he kept the chase moving without allowing Dubey to take control. It was a captain’s innings on a day when Kishan had already overseen the bowling performance that gave East a target of only 159.

On Tuesday, with a place in the final at stake, he did exactly that. His innings helped East to a four-wicket win over Central at BCCI’s Centre of Excellence Ground 1 in Bengaluru and a place in the final.

Central resumed Day 3 at 45/3 and found themselves in trouble. Abhijit Sarkar struck first, finding nightwatchman Aryan Pandey’s edge for Abhimanyu Easwaran to take a good catch at slip.

Mohammed Shami followed in the next over, coming from around the wicket and getting one to move back into

Kishan’s innings was not a boundary-filled assault, but East did not need one. He finished unbeaten on 39 off 41 balls, with four fours and a six.

Yash Rathod, who shouldered arms and was trapped lbw for five.

Aman Mokhadde and Rinku Singh briefly steadied Central with a 32-run stand. Mukesh Kumar broke it by bringing the ball back into Mokhadde and trapping him lbw for 41. Off-spinner Kounain Quraishi struck with his first ball after the drinks break, finding extra bounce and turn to have Rinku caught behind for 20. Mukesh then got one to hold its line and found Saransh Jain’s outside edge, leaving Central 97/8.

Dubey provided the resistance Central needed. He made 24 from 51 balls and added 43 for the ninth wicket with Arshad Khan.

Shami eventually ended the stand with an excellent one-handed return catch, reacting quickly to a toe-ended shot from Dubey.

Arshad added useful runs at the end, including a six over long-on off Shami, before Anukul Roy took the final wicket of Yash Thakur.

Slow start

East’s chase began slowly. Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, who had smashed 92 in the first innings, made only 16 from his first 30 balls before taking 18 from the first four deliveries of

a Yash Thakur over. He went after the fifth as well but was caught by Patidar for 40.

Dubey removed Easwaran and Virat to keep Central in the game. He had taken 4/66 in the first innings and dragged Central back into the semifinal with another excellent spell of 4/53. He found turn and bounce, bowled mostly full or on a good length and kept asking questions of East’s batsmen.

Just as he had in the first innings, when he dismissed Sooryavanshi and Kushagra off successive deliveries, Dubey struck twice in two balls again. Kushagra’s leading edge was taken at silly point before he bowled Roy through the gate with the next delivery.

East, who had been 123/3, were suddenly 124/5. But Kishan had found a way to handle the one bowler threatening to turn the chase around.

Sudip Gharami’s dismissal at 150/6 gave Central a final opening, but it came too late. Shami hit the winning runs, cutting Jain for four as East reached the target in the 40th over.

BRIEF SCORES: Central Zone 266 and 158 all out in 50.2 overs (Aman Mokhadde 41; Mukesh Kumar 4/44, Mohammed Shami 3/56) lost to East Zone 266 and 162/6 in 39.3 overs (Vaibhav Sooryavanshi 40, Ishan Kishan 39 not out; Harsh Dubey 4/53) by four wickets.
AT COE GROUND 2: North Zone 195 and 256/7 in 66 overs (Sanat Sangwan 76; K Saiteja 2/34, MD Nidheesh 2/47) lead South Zone 312 all out in 100.3 overs (Tilak Varma 116 not out) by 139 runs.

Saka earns Arsenal narrow victory at troubled Villa



Bukayo Saka scored in the 59th minute for Arsenal. AP

Reuters
Birmingham, September 1

CHAMPIONS ARSENAL made it two wins out of two as Bukayo Saka's second-half goal earned them a workmanlike 1-0 victory at Aston Villa in the Premier League on Monday.

Saka bundled in from close range in the 59th minute to reward a patient Arsenal, who dominated without ever overwhelming a resolute Villa side. Villa, whose Europa League-winning side has disintegrated after a summer exodus, came closest in the first half when Emi Buendia struck a shot against the crossbar.

Victory lifted Arsenal to six points along with Manchester City, Hull City and Chelsea.

Villa remain pointless and without a goal and will be anxious to try and boost their squad ahead of the transfer window closing on Tuesday.

Arsenal enjoyed eight 1-0 wins en route to their first Premier League crown for 22 years last season and any suggestions that they might dispense with pragmatism and evolve a more free-flowing style were probably answered at Villa Park.

Just like on so many occasions last season, Arsenal were rock-solid through their spine and that solidity allowed them to wait for their moment to strike. Shortly after Saka had a penalty overturned by VAR, the England forward showed his predatory instinct to get on the end of Calafiori's low cross after he had been played in by substitute Eberechi Eze's astute pass.

'Massive win'

Once ahead, 1-0 always looked the likely result but despite the narrow margin of victory it was comfortable as Villa did not manage a shot on target for the second match running.

"Really happy, this was a massive win," Arsenal manager Mikel Arteta, who claimed his 151st win in 250 Premier League games in charge, said. "I think we deserved it. It was a great squad performance. I know how tough it is to win here."

The strength of Arsenal's squad was underlined as new signings Bruno Guimaraes and former Villa defender Ezri Konsa both came off the bench during the second half for their Premier League debuts for the club.

For Villa boss Unai Emery, who waved goodbye to Ollie Watkins and Emiliano Martinez this week following the earlier departures of Morgan Rogers, Youri Tielemans, Lucas Digne and Konsa, there were hopeful signs.

US OPEN

Flaming Wawrinka backhand blazes into the New York sunset

Stan hadn't won a Slam for a decade, but single-hander leaves a lasting legacy beyond his 2014-16 peak

Bhuvan Gupta
New Delhi, September 1

PETE SAMPRAS, the player Stanislas Wawrinka grew up idolising, handed him his maiden Grand Slam trophy at the 2014 Australian Open. If that wasn't gratifying enough, Sampras later said he wished he had Wawrinka's backhand. Cracking up in response, Wawrinka told the *Men's Journal*, "Yeah, and I want his trophies."

Though he couldn't match Sampras' trophy count, Wawrinka drew public admiration nevertheless for his fighting spirit, as also that graceful-yet-powerful one-handed backhand.

Twenty-one years after making his Majors debut at Roland Garros, 'Stan the Man' played his last Grand Slam match on Tuesday. The setting was Flushing Meadows, where he had won his third (and last) title in 2016.

Wawrinka very nearly didn't get a goodbye to the US Open. After arriving in New York, he learnt that the final men's singles wild card this year had gone to home hope Patrick Kypson. The former world number three returned to Switzerland, but Kypson soon withdrew with an injury. Wawrinka, offered a wild card as an eleventh-hour replacement, made the trip back to America.

He was rewarded with an outpouring of love as thousands lined up at the Grandstand court. Wawrinka lost to Matteo Berrettini 7-6 (7-4), 7-6 (7-3), 6-0 and received an emotional send-off. "I'm very grateful for this wild card. It was very



Stan Wawrinka lost to Matteo Berrettini in the US Open first round to end his Grand Slam journey. AP

E. EXPLAINED

Why one-handed backhands are rare

WITH COACHES increasingly being double-handed backhanders now, the players are also turning out to be double-handed, Roger Federer said at a US Open presser. He added that it's harder for young players to control one-handed backhand shots, and that technical changes take time which the modern-era game doesn't allow. Further, with a greater focus on baseline play than net play, being a one-hander is not naturally advantageous anymore. The double-hander is an easier shot to learn when you're younger.

important for me to finish here, where I won a Grand Slam 10 years ago. I want to thank you all for all these years," he said at the post-match ceremony.

Having made his US Open main draw debut in 2005, Wawrinka developed a special affinity towards the city over the years. "I remember the first time I came here. It was impressive for me to feel the New York vibe and the energy of this tournament."

"Because of you (the fans) I really enjoyed it and I found a way to play my best tennis here... One of the reasons I played until 41 was to live these moments," he added.

Rare stroke

Like Sampras, Wawrinka did not start off one-handed with his backhand as a kid. In both cases, it was the coach who intervened. "I was 11 years old, and my two-handed backhand was terrible. I couldn't put one ball in," Stan recalled to the

US Open website in 2024.

"At that time, my coach told me to try the one-handed backhand. It's not easy when you're young to play with a one hand because you don't have the same power, but it looks more natural, so I was happy with the change."

The stroke evolved to be counted among the most feared on tour. Besides the elegance with which he struck it, Wawrinka used it to virtually bully his opponents on court. His victims include the then Big Three — Roger Federer, Novak Djokovic and Rafael Nadal — leading to a golden run between 2014 and 2016 where 'Stanimal' scalped the reigning world number one for each of his three Major titles.

The one-handed backhand has become a rarity today. Only five players in the men's top 100 (Lorenzo Musetti, Denis Shapovalov, Stefanos Tsitsipas, Daniel Altmaier and Aleksandar Kovacevic) use it. If none of

them makes the semis at US Open 2026, it would be the first calendar year ever without at least one one-handed backhand in the last four of a Grand Slam. Wawrinka remains bullish about the endangered shot anyway. "There will always be one-handed backhands," he told presenter Prakash Amritraj on *Tennis Channel* during the Monte Carlo Masters this April. "Always."

The increasingly physical nature of the sport is why the shot is in a minority, he feels. "Players play really hard from both sides now. So, of course, it's easier to get the two-handed backhand." But he still expects some younger player or the other to always be "at the top of the game."

Self-effacing

Two days before Wawrinka's farewell, Federer was inducted into the International Tennis Hall of Fame. The Swiss duo had won an Olympic gold in Beijing together, and Stan said it was "really, really special" to watch his compatriot be honoured this way. Also present at the Federer induction was another famously elegant single-handed backhand of yore - Gabriela Sabatini.

But when asked about his own Hall of Fame chances, Wawrinka was typically self-effacing. "I absolutely don't decide for that. It's my last year. I'm trying to finish in the best way possible," he told reporters after his last Slam outing.

Wawrinka has lost 15 of the 22 matches he has played so far this season. He has not won any ATP title in the last eight years, and is unlikely to add to his 16-strong tally when he hangs up his racket. But that might not matter for the lad who grew up working on his parents' farm in Lausanne. He wants to be remembered for "always trying to give, always trying to fight, always showing up".

That, and his inimitable backhand.

• BRIEFLY



Unnati Hooda suffered a 21-10, 21-18 loss to Korea's Kim Ga-eun. PTI

China Masters: Unnati falters against Ga-eun; Hari-Arjun retire

UNNATI HOODA suffered from starting blues as she could not get past Korean World No 12 Kim Ga-eun to exit Super 750 China Masters. A 0-4 start in the opening set ended in a 21-10, 21-18 loss at Shenzhen as the Round 1 challenge proved too steep for the Indian World no 25. In the men's doubles, MR Arjun and Hariharan Amsakarunan retired at 11-8 down against Chinese Chen Bo Yang-Liu Yi. On Wednesday, Kidambi Srikanth plays Chi Yu Jen, while Dhruv Kapila-Tanisha Crasto play Tonkid-Tonrug (Saeheng). Lakshya Sen begins his campaign against Worlds twice-medallist Victor Lai, while Devika Sihag runs into gritty Kaloyana Nalbantova of Bulgaria. Tanvi Sharma has a good opportunity to defeat Danish Amali Schulz and move into WS2 position for the Asian Games. Satwiksairaj Rankireddy-Chirag Shetty play a Malaysian unit of Junaidi Arif and Kang Khai Xing. ENS

Man City to sign Fernandez from Chelsea: Report

MANCHESTER CITY have reached an agreement with Chelsea to sign midfielder Enzo Fernandez for £125 million, British media reported. The Athletic reported Fernandez was given permission by Chelsea to undergo a medical. The fee would equal the British transfer record set when Liverpool signed Swedish striker Alexander Isak from Newcastle United last year as City's close-season spend touches nearly £400 million. REUTERS

Rudiger retires from int'l football

GERMANY DEFENDER Antonio Rudiger announced his retirement from international football, ending a 12-year career with the national team to focus on his club career. The 33-year-old centre back earned 86 caps after making his senior debut in 2014, establishing himself as a mainstay of the Germany defence across three World Cups and multiple European Championships. REUTERS

South Korea name Moreno as interim coach

SOUTH KOREA appointed former Spain coach Robert Moreno as interim manager to lead the national team through November, the Korea Football Association (KFA) said. The 48-year-old will oversee South Korea's next six matches as the KFA continues its search for a permanent replacement for Hong Myung-bo, who stepped down in June after the team's group-stage exit at the World Cup. REUTERS

McTominay out for month due to heart problem

NAPOLI MIDFIELDER Scott McTominay will undergo a surgical procedure to treat an irregular heartbeat, the Serie A club announced. Napoli added that McTominay will be out until after the season's first international break, meaning he won't play again until October. "Following the development of a minor, benign arrhythmia, Scott McTominay over the coming days will undergo an operation a PFA (pulsed field ablation)," Napoli said. AP

Lad becomes Mumbai captain for Ranji Trophy

SEASONED MIDDLE-order batter Siddhesh Lad has replaced Shardul Thakur as Mumbai captain for the upcoming Ranji Trophy season. Thakur, 34, has been replaced to manage his workload since the Mumbai think tank aims to maximise his value as the premier bowler in the red-ball team. He has also contributed heavily with the bat in crunch situations in the past. PTI

India A to tour NZ for three 4-day matches

INDIA A will play three four-day matches against New Zealand A in Christchurch from October 24, New Zealand Cricket announced. The series will be part of India's build-up to the two-Test series against New Zealand, with the A side's matches preceding the senior team's red-ball assignment. The fixtures were announced as part of New Zealand Cricket's domestic red-ball schedule for the Plunket Shield. PTI

Alcaraz shines on return, breezes past Safiullin

Reuters
New York, September 1

DEFENDING CHAMPION Carlos Alcaraz needed only a New York minute to hit his stride after a nearly five-month injury layoff, beating Russian Roman Safiullin 6-4, 6-4, 6-4 in the first round of US Open.

Alcaraz arrived at Flushing Meadows as one of the tournament's biggest question marks, having not played since April due to a wrist injury, but he had his best weapon working for him in his first singles match in 139 days as he sent over 20 forehand winners.

He next plays Portugal's Jaime Faria in the second round. "It's been a really tough five months for me," said Alcaraz. "I missed it - I missed the crowd, the energy, I missed competition, I missed everything."



Carlos Alcaraz beat Russian Roman Safiullin 6-4, 6-4, 6-4. AP

Alcaraz got a brief U.S. Open warm-up in the mixed doubles with partner Serena Williams last week, and the crowd at Arthur Ashe Stadium was all too happy to see him return, with the twice champion greeted with deafening cheers as he

took to the court.

Alcaraz whacked a forehand winner out of Safiullin's reach for the break in the seventh game and looked to be back to his usual self as the Russian was unable to tame Alcaraz's lethal serve on set point.

The Spaniard went down an early break in the second set but Safiullin gave up the momentum immediately as he sent a volley out on break point in the third game, never getting a handle on the match.

Alcaraz painted the line to go up another break in the seventh and was in total control in the third set, where he converted a break point with his powerful forehand.

"I was playing pretty normal, and the arm, the wrist, everything felt great," said Alcaraz. "I'm going to still take care of it, these days and before the matches and everything, but I'm just really happy it's pain-free finally."

'Difficult day'

The youngest man to complete the career grand slam, 23-year-old Alcaraz has not been

immune to injury scares in his still-young career, giving fans a fright last year with a brief knee concern en route to the title.

But this year's drama has risen above the level he has seen before, after the wrist injury in his dominant arm forced him to pull out of the Barcelona Open and scuttled a large chunk of his season.

He looked healthy enough - if, perhaps, somewhat uninspired - playing in last week's mixed doubles but hit another gear on Monday as he debuted a flowing hairstyle in contrast to last year's accidental buzz cut. "It was a difficult day for me, but at the same time, a really beautiful one. Starting the day really nervous," said Alcaraz, who hopes to become the first man to successfully defend the title since Roger Federer won his fifth in a row 18 years ago.

• MANCHESTER'S MAGICIAN

Cherki, with his twinkling feet, keeping Man City slick in post-Pep era

Sandip G
New Delhi, September 1

SIX YEARS ago, Kylian Mbappe repoted on Rayan Cherki with a smiley and caption: "Don't talk to him about his age too much!" Cherki was only 16 then, and had netted a brace of goals and assists, for Lyon against Nantes, sending the first firm signals of his precocious gifts towards the world at large. He looked beyond his age; not so much by the stubble and defined facial features he then spotted, but by the wisdom he showed with the ball on his floating feet.

Mbappe, an early-bloomer himself, was not the first to positively wonder about his compatriot of Italian-Algerian descent raised in busy Lyon. He was only six years old and knocking the ball on an athletics track adjacent to the football pitch his elder brothers trained when a local coach

Roger Martinez saw him and stood transfixed with the tricks he performed.

"That's where I saw him for the first time," Martinez told *Bleacher Report*. "He was playing with a ball while he watched his brother train. And I asked myself, 'Who is this monster? How can a six-year-old kid do so much with the ball at his feet?' He told him to come and start training at his local amateur club AS Saint-Priest. More pleasurable shock followed: "There was nothing I could teach him about how to play football. He was a kid who knew how to do everything."

The only dilemma was where to play him. He could score and create goals; he was wondrously two-footed; could play on the flanks, at the centre, as a playmaker, winger and forward. He was so good everywhere that different managers would use him differently as his career soared. In

Lyon, jersey numbers could not signify his role. He wore 18, 10, 9 and then began to wear 18 again. He left even the unmatched tactical shape-shifter Pep Guardiola astounded.

The legendary manager would say: "There are moments that I just want to shout at him, and there are moments I want to kiss him." His flourishes and indulgences incensed him but his grandeur and outcome marvelled him. A system disruptor or a chaos agent, antithetical to the Guardiolsma ideals of positional and structural conformity. He admitted after Cherki's spectacular goal against Arsenal last season: "I have to allow him to express his incredible talent."

It's tempting to call him a throwback, a time-traveller to an era where structures had not suffocated displays of individual flash, even showboating at times, when football and foot-



Rayan Cherki scored twice in five minutes against Crystal Palace. AP

ballers could self-indulge a bit; when spontaneity trumped over rigorously-instilled patterns. To put it simply, Cherki is arguably the most watchable player on the planet, a thrillingly volatile footballer that makes even the

non-fan get hooked to the screen. Guardiola, Rodri and Bernardo Silva have gone, but Cherki makes watching City pleasurable again. He was clearly their most influential player in the first two games (two

“ There are moments that I just want to shout at him, and there are moments I want to kiss him.”
PEP GUARDIOLA
ON RAYAN CHERKI

game-changing assists with Bournemouth in the opener).

Watch those goals against Crystal Palace. Watch the run for his first goal. He gathers the pass with the shin of his right foot, then brushes aside three onrushing defenders, from three different sides without spreading a single crease on his shirt, slides past the fourth one and then pokes the ball with his left foot. He can walk on water; maybe even on air. Watch the ball past the goalkeeper, rolling without a scent of power.

Even when he stirs power, it does not look savage. He imparted incredible power onto the shot that led to his second goal, but the audience could trace its flight without pausing and re-winding. The whip and curl were gorgeous in its journey.

Between, before and after the two goals, there were moments his magical string strummed falsetto notes, when the tricks gloriously failed, and when City manager Enzo Maresca fumed. But that is part of the Cherki package, the flaws that make him even more fascinating. He is Maresca's most precious asset before the rejigged band settles down into a coherent firm. His manager at Lyon, Rudi Garcia once said: "He has a strong ability to beat players but uses it too much and not especially wisely." There will be days when Cherki would be painted as a raw, undisciplined maverick, just another cheeky kid

with jinking feet.

Cherki as a finished product is a daunting thought for defenders, but even a semi-finished product could embarrass them. The technical prowess with both feet apart, the Frenchman has a layered and subtle game.

He switches his tempo, quick pauses and sudden bursts of speed, which imbalances defenders; uses his lithe frame to spin and swerve past his markers and uses nearly every part of his body to conjure the unthinkable move or pass, and maintains supreme control in tight space. Garcia gushes over the weight of his passes to the final third and intelligence: "He is an excellent reader of game, sees three-four ahead. The touch, the turn, everything is smooth. He must be aware that he still has huge room for improvement."

And he is only 23. But just don't remind him of his age.